

RECORD OF A REGULAR MEETING OF THE BROOKLINE SCHOOL COMMITTEE ON **WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 16, 2026** AT 6:00 PM, BROOKLINE TOWN HALL, 333 WASHINGTON STREET. NOTICE OF THIS MEETING WAS FILED WITH THE TOWN CLERK.

School Committee members present: Bob Weintraub (Chair), Danna Perry (Vice Chair) (remote), Laura Baines-Walsh, Suzanne Federspiel, Valerie Frias (remote), Jesse Hefter, Faiza Khan, Sarah Moghtader (remote), and Carolyn Thall.

Staff present: Bella Wong, Superintendent of Schools; Robin Benoit, Deputy Superintendent for Teaching and Learning; Aaron Osborne, Deputy Superintendent for Administration and Finance; and Karen Shmukler, Deputy Superintendent for Student Services.

Dr. Weintraub noted the new table configuration for this evening's meeting. The tables were arranged in more of a workshop-style so as to facilitate easier collaboration and conversation among members. He announced that members Valerie Frias, Sarah Moghtader, and Danna Perry would be participating in this evening's meeting remotely. Finally, Dr. Weintraub announced that the School Committee will be participating in a Joint Meeting with the Select Board on Tuesday, September 29 at 5:00pm for a presentation on the Pierce School Building Project.

1. PSB MOMENTS OF INSPIRATION

Dr. Weintraub reminded members of this new addition to the meeting agenda: *PSB Moments of Inspiration*. Every meeting will kick-off with a brief moment of inspiration to provide opportunities for community members to learn more about the talent, creativity, and dedication that can be found throughout our schools.

Dr. Khan provided the inspiration this evening, sharing reflections based on the traditional Maasai greeting, "And how are the children?", which posits that the well-being of children is a measure of the health, safety, and priorities of the broader community. The reading encourages parents, community members, and public leaders alike to share responsibility for the care and protection of all children and to consider whether society can truly say that "all the children are well."

2. CONSENT AGENDA

Dr. Weintraub announced the consent agenda, sharing gratitude to the gift from Brookline's English Learner (EL) teachers in memory of Kay Polga, who previously served in the school district as the Director of English Learner Education. Dr. Hefter noted that items 2i (Acceptance of Gift) and 2j (Acceptance of Grant) were unanimously approved by the Finance and Capital Projects Subcommittee at their meeting on September 9.

ACTION 26-80

On a motion of Ms. Federspiel, and seconded by Dr. Hefter, the School Committee VOTED UNANIMOUSLY, by roll call, with 9 in favor (Dr. Weintraub, Ms. Perry, Dr. Baines-Walsh, Ms. Federspiel, Ms. Frias, Dr. Hefter, Dr. Khan, Ms. Moghtader, and

Ms. Thall), 0 opposed, and 0 abstentions, to approve the following consent agenda items:

- a. Past Records: August 26, 2026 School Committee Meeting
- b. Accounts Payable Reports: June 18, 2026; June 30, 2026; July 16, 2026; July 23, 2026; July 30, 2026; August 6, 2026; August 13, 2026; August 20, 2026; August 27, 2026; and September 3, 2026 (Attachment A)
- c. Pierce School Building Project: Change Order No. 24, Miller Dyer Spears, Inc., \$34,416.00 (Attachment B)
- d. Pierce School Building Project: Change Order No. 25, Miller Dyer Spears, Inc., \$9,504.00 (Attachment C)
- e. Student Trip: BHS Spanish Language Trip to Spain, April, 2027 (Attachment D)
- f. Student Trip: BHS Kyoto Gaidi Nishi Exchange Program Trip to Japan, April, 2027 (Attachment E)
- g. Student Trip: Lawrence School 7th Grade, Farm School Field Trip, October, 2026 (Attachment F)
- h. Student Trip: Pierce School 7th Grade, Nature's Classroom, New Hampshire, November, 2026 (Attachment G)
- i. Acceptance of Gift: Gift from English Learner (EL) Teachers, in honor of Kay Polga, \$140.00 (Attachment H)
- j. Acceptance of Grant: Massachusetts Department of Agriculture, Food Security Infrastructure Grant, \$460,631.00 (Attachment I)

3. STUDENT REPORT

The student representative to the School Committee, Annika Banerjee, provided her monthly report. She expressed enthusiasm about the new school year and her role with the School Committee. She noted that she will also be serving as an editor of the BHS student newspaper, *The Cypress*. She reported that BHS hosted the annual Club Fair, which allows 9th graders, and all students, to learn more about the various extracurricular clubs and activities available at the school. Ms. Banerjee also reported that students are adjusting to the new six-day schedule and 70-minute class periods. She said students are appreciative of the additional passing time in the schedule (time between blocks to get from one class to the next). She noted that some students have expressed concerns about larger class sizes, including some classes exceeding 30 students. Finally, she noted the introduction of the Seal of Biliteracy for students who meet language proficiency requirements.

4. PUBLIC COMMENT

There was no public comment.

5. SUPERINTENDENT'S REPORT

Superintendent Wong shared her report (Attachment J). She welcomed everyone to the new school year, and announced the administrative leaders new to the district this year including Aaron Osborne (Deputy Superintendent for Administration and Finance), Eris Dunn

(Principal at Runkle School), Jill Seaman-Chandler (Coordinator of Health Services), Julie Cullinane (Director of Human Resources), Kendall Jones (Director of Steps to Success), and McKenna Bush (Director of Data and Information Systems). The Superintendent highlighted some of changes in the 2026–2027 school year, including the Seal of Biliteracy, the new BHS six-day schedule with 70-minute blocks, the Developing Character and Leadership in Sports program, Parent Square, the Grade 9 “phones off and away” initiative, and an expanded district data team. She also summarized some of the extensive summer preparation undertaken by staff, including civil rights investigation training, administrator and staff orientations, and planning around the district’s goals for the year, all culminating in a successful opening day for students and staff.

Superintendent Wong discussed the district’s major priorities, which include emphasizing implementation of Multi-Tiered Systems of Support (MTSS), which involves stronger Tier 1 instruction, school-based support teams, data-driven decision-making, and improved use of student work and assessment data to guide instruction and interventions. She connected this work to recommendations from the District Review Report from the Department of Elementary and Secondary Education, including strengthening supervision and evaluation, developing a more visible professional development plan, and advancing equity and student belonging. She announced that Darnisa Amante-Jackson will consult with the district this year on development of its equity plan. The Superintendent described a coordinated “bridge plan” intended to integrate MTSS (moving from framework to practice), the Civil Rights Policy, equity planning, professional development, and supervision and evaluation.

The Superintendent provided an update on kindergarten class sizes across the district, and the decision made in June to reduce the kindergarten sections at Ridley School from five to four. She explained that the decision was based on projected enrollment, and the effect that reducing sections at various schools would have on class size. As of September 11, Ridley’s four kindergarten sections had 20 or 21 students each; retaining a fifth section would have resulted in an average of approximately 16.6 students. She noted that no K–8 section districtwide is currently above the district’s class-size guidance and explained that additional sections had been added at Runkle, Driscoll, and FRR in other grades where enrollment otherwise would have exceeded that guidance. Class size guidance is 22 students for K-2 classrooms, and 25 students in grade 3-8 classrooms. Finally, Superintendent Wong reported that she is preparing a school-calendar survey for distribution to staff and parents/guardians. The survey, which will present different school calendar options and their implications, is expected to be distributed shortly after October 1.

Members thanked Superintendent Wong for her report and expressed support for the planned survey of staff and families regarding the school calendar. Members shared their enthusiasm for the district’s increased focus on teaching and learning. The Superintendent was asked how district goals would connect with individual School Improvement Plans (SIPs), and suggested that school building administrators be provided

support to align their work. Superintendent Wong acknowledged this request, while noting that some schools are in the midst of a 2-year SIP so alignment might more clearly follow next year. Further, she noted that work to align goals took place during the course of summer planning meetings. Members discussed class-size guidance and the Superintendent's update on elementary enrollment. It was noted that the district does not have a formal policy concerning class sizes, but that operational guidance informs staff decisions with respect to class size. Superintendent Wong noted that the district added sections (that is, another homeroom/class to a specific grade in a particular school) in order to avoid having any sections above guidance, including Grade 1 at Runkle and Grade 4 at Driscoll. It was suggested, based on Ms. Banerjee's comments in the Student Report, that high school class sizes be a focus of examination at a future date. There were questions about the class size guidance for Pierce School, which is lower than the district-wide guidance. The Superintendent explained that during the school construction period, Pierce students are in temporary locations (Old Lincoln School and Fisher Hill). The limited/unique physical spaces at these two temporary locations require reduced class size guidance.

Members requested additional information about the newly established school-based Multi-Tiered Systems of Support (MTSS) teams. Staff explained that the district spent last year developing an MTSS framework and building district-level capacity, including a focused launch at Lawrence School. This year, implementation of MTSS is expanding across all schools. Building leaders completed readiness assessments to identify initial implementation steps, and each school has established an MTSS team to help lead and guide the work. These teams will meet monthly and focus on implementing the broader MTSS framework at the school level, while existing Student Intervention Teams (SITs) will continue to concentrate more specifically on the needs of individual students.

6. PRESENTATIONS AND DISCUSSIONS OF CURRENT ISSUES

a. Discussion of Driscoll School Rooftop Play Area Shading Options

Superintendent Wong presented an update on efforts to address excessive heat at the rooftop play area at the Driscoll School, which was designed adjacent to the BEEP preschool classrooms to provide younger students with a separate and easily accessible outdoor play space. Since the school opened, it has become apparent that both the play equipment and surrounding surface can become excessively hot in direct sunlight, limiting safe use of the area. The Superintendent thanked staff from the DPW, Parks, and the Building Department for the considerable time spent evaluating possible solutions. She noted that the Driscoll construction project budget has already closed, so any solution must address both design and a new funding source. Several alternatives have been explored. Umbrellas or other ground-mounted shade structures were determined not to be viable because their supports would create obstacles in an area used by young children and would not provide sufficient coverage of the surrounding play surface. The most effective option identified to date is a larger shade structure anchored directly to the building at multiple points. However, installation would require structural design and engineering, removal of portions of the brick façade, and attachment to structural elements of the building so that

the shade could safely withstand wind uplift. What had initially been hoped to be a relatively modest improvement has therefore developed into a project with a six-figure cost. Superintendent Wong said that, given the expense and the district's broader financial circumstances, the project could not simply be undertaken administratively and would require additional review and consideration as a possible future capital request. Staff from the Building Department are expected to provide additional information to the Finance and Capital Projects Subcommittee at their October 7 meeting. Superintendent Wong again emphasized the extensive collaborative effort by school staff and Town departments to identify a workable solution. Members expressed dismay that the problem was not identified during the design process, and asked that lessons learned from this experience be carried forward in planning future new school building projects.

b. FY28 Capital Improvements Program (CIP) Request, including Deferred Maintenance Items

Ms. Osborne directed members to the "FY28 CIP Recommendation" document (Attachment K). The request was presented to the Finance and Capital Projects Subcommittee at their September 9 meeting and recommended for approval. He highlighted the major components of the request, including the BEEP leases; a feasibility study for improvements to the Lawrence School cafeteria; ongoing deferred maintenance projects; climate-control improvements, including additional air conditioning and mini-splits at several schools; and a small kitchen renovation and oven replacement at Hayes School. The deferred maintenance projects are more fully described on page 3 of the attachment. Members asked about the status of climate control and air conditioning across district buildings. Mr. Osborne described the geothermal systems at Driscoll and the new Pierce School, as well as the incremental installation of mini-splits in areas with particular needs, including sun-exposed portions of BHS. He noted that the district must balance immediate climate-control needs with the age and anticipated future renovation or replacement of individual buildings. Hayes School, for example, received extensive mini-split installations and related electrical upgrades during the prior summer. Members suggested that increasingly sophisticated building systems often result in unanticipated long-term costs if the systems are costly to operate or difficult to troubleshoot and maintain. Design costs also impact operations and utility costs (by example, it was noted that large windows can lead to added heat gains and warm classrooms), so it is important to weigh design choices in view of long-term costs and operations.

Mr. Osborne described the process by which the CIP request (and the embedded deferred maintenance list) is created. He noted that the process is a collaborative one that includes school leaders and other building-level staff in an effort to address problems and identify priorities, emphasizing that school-based staff, such as custodians, will have the institutional knowledge regarding recurring problems, aging boilers, roof repairs, and other maintenance concerns that may not be apparent to others.

ACTION 26-81

On a motion of Dr. Hefter, and seconded by Ms. Thall, the School Committee VOTED UNANIMOUSLY, by roll call, with 8 in favor (Dr. Weintraub, Ms. Perry, Dr. Baines-Walsh, Ms. Federspiel, Ms. Frias, Dr. Hefter, Dr. Khan, and Ms. Thall), 0 opposed, and 0 abstentions, to approve the FY28 Capital Improvement Program (CIP) Request as shown on Attachment K. *Ms. Moghtader was not present for the vote.*

c. Proposal to Create a Revolving Fund for Career and Technical Education/Vocational Education Programs

Mr. Osborne presented a proposal to establish a new revolving fund for career and technical/vocational education programs (Attachment L). He noted that the immediate purpose of the fund is to support an EMT certification program offered through MassBay Community College. Under the arrangement, the district would collect individual tuition payments from participating families and make a single payment to the college, allowing MassBay to reserve a dedicated group of seats for Brookline students. The fund would essentially operate as a “zero-balance” account, with the amount collected from families matching the amount paid to the participating institution. Mr. Osborne noted that the fund was intentionally described broadly so it could support similar career and technical education opportunities with other institutions in the future. Members expressed appreciation for the expansion of opportunities available to BHS students. Members had questions about access and equity to the EMT course, and asked if the opportunity was open to all students. Staff confirmed that the course is open to all, though students must participate in the course on the MassBay campus (to access the specialized equipment). It was noted that BHS leaders are in a better position to answer detailed questions about this particular course offering.

ACTION 26-82

On a motion of Dr. Hefter, and seconded by Dr. Khan, the School Committee VOTED UNANIMOUSLY, by roll call, with 8 in favor (Dr. Weintraub, Ms. Perry, Dr. Baines-Walsh, Ms. Federspiel, Ms. Frias, Dr. Hefter, Dr. Khan, and Ms. Thall), 0 opposed, and 0 abstentions, to authorize the school district to work with the Town of Brookline toward establishment of a Vocational Education Revolving Fund, as further described on Attachment L. *Ms. Moghtader was not present for the vote.*

d. FY28 Budget Development Dates

Mr. Osborne shared the proposed FY28 Budget Development Dates document (Attachment M). The dates have been previously approved by the Finance and Capital Projects Subcommittee, and staff are in agreement with the dates.

ACTION 26-83

On a motion of Dr. Hefter, and seconded by Dr. Khan, the School Committee VOTED UNANIMOUSLY, by roll call, with 8 in favor (Dr. Weintraub, Ms. Perry, Dr. Baines-Walsh, Ms. Federspiel, Ms. Frias, Dr. Hefter, Dr. Khan, and Ms. Thall), 0 opposed, and 0

abstentions, to approve the FY28 Budget Development Dates as shown on Attachment M. *Ms. Moghtader was not present for the vote.*

e. Discussion and Possible Vote to Appoint Two Community Representatives to the Lincoln School Grounds Renovation Project Design Review Committee

Dr. Weintraub announced that, as part of the renovation project for the grounds of the Lincoln School, Brookline's Parks and Open Space Division has created a Design Review Committee (Attachment N). The DRC includes two School Committee members (Dr. Hefter and Ms. Federspiel), two Parks and Recreation Commission members, a school staff member, and two members of the community. Parks and Open Space solicited nominations for the two community seats and five residents expressed their interest in serving: Andrea Burns, Maria Jose Hurtado Ortiz, Sarah Pagliaccio, Sandra Wesemann, and Indira Yessimova. Dr. Weintraub and Ms. Perry reviewed the nomination forms and noted that all of the candidates have outstanding and unique qualifications. After a thorough review, Dr. Weintraub and Ms. Perry recommend that the School Committee appoint Sarah Pagliaccio and Sandra Wesemann (Attachment O).

ACTION 26-84

On a motion of Dr. Hefter, and seconded by Dr. Khan, the School Committee VOTED UNANIMOUSLY, by roll call, with 8 in favor (Dr. Weintraub, Ms. Perry, Dr. Baines-Walsh, Ms. Federspiel, Ms. Frias, Dr. Hefter, Dr. Khan, and Ms. Thall), 0 opposed, and 0 abstentions, to appoint Sarah Pagliaccio and Sandra Wesemann to the Design Review Committee for the Lincoln School Grounds Renovation Project. *Ms. Moghtader was not present for the vote.*

f. Discussion of School Committee Communications Norms

Ms. Perry directed members to Attachment P, *School Committee Communication Norms*, explaining that these norms were created to address three primary goals: making School Committee meetings more efficient, improving communication between meetings, and ensuring that members' questions and concerns are elevated effectively and directed through appropriate channels. Ms. Perry outlined several proposed practices for improving meetings. Whenever possible, meeting materials will be distributed sufficiently in advance to allow members to submit questions ahead of time, giving presenters an opportunity to research and prepare responses. Presentations will generally be kept concise - approximately eight to ten slides and 20 minutes - with more detailed information provided through pre-reading and supporting materials, thereby preserving meeting time for Committee questions and discussion. For communication between meetings, Ms. Perry emphasized the respective governance roles of the School Committee Chair and Superintendent. The New Business portion of the agenda will remain the principal opportunity for members to propose future agenda items. Members generally expressed support for the proposed norms and their emphasis on listening, efficiency, and clear communication.

As part of the discussion of meeting norms, members discussed compliance with the Massachusetts Open Meeting Law (OML), particularly when Committee members share articles or other information electronically. Members discussed the distinction between distributing general informational material and circulating information concerning a matter that the Committee could reasonably anticipate deliberating. Members also discussed whether another Open Meeting Law refresher or annual training would be useful. The discussion reinforced the broader principle that substantive deliberation on matters before the Committee should occur publicly rather than through email or other private communications. There were questions about how individual members can be involved in the docket preview process, including a possible idea of rotating School Committee members into the weekly docket meetings. Dr. Weintraub explained that the current practice of having the Chair and Vice Chair meet regularly with the Superintendent would continue, in part because those meetings can include confidential matters and topics beyond agenda planning. Ms. Perry explained that items raised by members during New Business are recorded on a running list maintained by staff and reviewed during docket discussions, along with a calendar of recurring Committee business. She emphasized that members should feel comfortable following up with the Chair regarding items they have proposed for future consideration.

7. SUBCOMMITTEE AND LIAISON REPORTS

a. Diversity, Equity, Inclusion, and Justice

The DEIJ Subcommittee will be meeting on Monday, September 28. Dr. Shmukler will be presenting the Annual Report for the Policy Against Discrimination, Harassment, Sexual Harassment, and Retaliation. The meeting will be simultaneously posted as a full School Committee meeting, so all members will be allowed to join and participate in the discussion.

b. Finance and Capital Projects

Dr. Hefter reported that the Finance and Capital Projects Subcommittee met on August 19 and September 9, 2026. Many of the items on this evening's agenda were previously reviewed in detail by the subcommittee at those meetings. Dr. Hefter also shared information about his work to improve communication with the broader community about the subcommittee's work. One component of this outreach is that he prepares a brief newsletter immediately following each subcommittee meeting. The newsletter is a highly condensed summary of the major topics covered during the meeting, with a link to the full meeting materials. He distributes this newsletter to about 400 community members.

c. Negotiations

Dr. Weintraub reported that the Negotiations Subcommittee has a collective bargaining session scheduled with the Brookline Educators Union tomorrow, September 17. All collective bargaining sessions are recorded, and are made available for public viewing on the School Committee webpage after each session. He noted that the School Committee has both a fiscal responsibility to the community, especially in view of the recent successful tax

override, and a responsibility to the district's deeply-appreciated educators to reach a fair contract that attracts and retains topnotch educators.

d. Policy Review

Ms. Federspiel reported that the Policy Review is meeting on Tuesday, September 22. The agenda includes a review of several timely and important policies.

e. Additional Liaisons and Updates

Dr. Baines-Walsh is the liaison to the Steps to Success program and she attended their recent board meeting. She reports that STS, a program partner of the Public Schools of Brookline, is actively engaged in strategic planning and work to broaden outreach efforts.

8. NEW BUSINESS

There was no new business to report.

9. PROPOSED EXECUTIVE SESSION

ACTION 26-85

In open session, on a motion of Dr. Hefter, and seconded by Dr. Khan, the School Committee VOTED UNANIMOUSLY, by roll call, with 9 in favor (Dr. Weintraub, Ms. Perry, Dr. Baines-Walsh, Ms. Federspiel, Ms. Frias, Dr. Hefter, Dr. Khan, Ms. Moghtader, and Ms. Thall), 0 opposed, and 0 abstentions, to meet in executive session pursuant to Massachusetts General Law chapter 30A, section 21(a), for the following purposes: purpose 3, to discuss strategy with respect to collective bargaining with the BEU Unit A, Unit B, and Paraprofessional Unit, because an open meeting will have a detrimental effect on the bargaining position of the Committee and the Chair so declared; purpose 3, to conduct a strategy session in preparation for negotiations with the BEU Unit A (Grievances), if an open meeting will have a detrimental effect on the bargaining or litigating position of the Committee and the Chair so declares; and purpose 7, to review and approve minutes from the August 26, 2026 executive session.

Dr. Weintraub announced that the School Committee would not be returning to open session following the executive session.

10. Adjournment

By unanimous consent, Dr. Weintraub adjourned the meeting at 8:15pm.

Respectfully submitted,
Betsy Fitzpatrick, Executive Assistant
Brookline School Committee

Town of Brookline - School Accounts Payable (AP) Report 6.18.26

Pay to each of the vendors named in the attached AP batches the sums set against their respective names, amounting in the aggregate to \$609,824.95

List of AP Batches		Amount	
1	7596	General Supplies	4,189.73
2	8169	Student Activities	828.00
3	8170	" "	1,896.00
4	8198	" "	896.19
5	8215	Ednc/ Train/ Conf	64.33
6	8219	Stud. Activities	500.00
7	8294	" "	2,720.28
8	8310	Mileage	29.00
9	8461	Gen. Supplies	7,377.63
10	8470	Ednc/ Train/ Conf	76.91
11	8521	" "	4,800.00
12	8585	Gen. Supplies	43.68
13	8597	Schd. Activities	5,225.13
14	8618	" "	135.00
15	8672	Gen. Supplies	49.40
16	8686	Stud. Activities	3,755.00
17	8699	Gen. Supplies	1,437.36
18	8821	" "	2,815.72
19	8824	Transportation	7,083.04
20	8903	Gen Stud. Act.	115.90
21	8947	Gen. Supp.	2,098.97
22	8974	Stud. Activities	5,413.70
23	8988	" "	383.75
24	9025	Gen. Supp.	2,102.33
25	9097	" "	5,184.70
26	9123	Prof / Tech Serv.	14,255.11
27	9125	Stud. Act.	118.20
28	9128	" "	3,891.00
29	9131	Gen. Supplies	487.55
30	9133	Stud. Activities	187.00
31	9161	Ednc/ Train/ Conf	540.00
32	9187	Transportation	6,777.08
33	9204	Gen. Supplies	50.11
34	9214	" "	5,147.81
35	9215	ODD	75,056.29
36	9221	Gen. Supplies	950.00
37	9223	" "	8,462.47

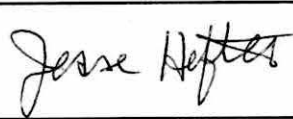
Town of Brookline - School Accounts Payable (AP) Report 6.18.26

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38	9228	Gen. Supplies	15,831.34
39	9233	" "	2,326.10
40	9234	" "	3,750.00
41	9236	" "	1,751.11
42	9239	" "	1,038.80
43	9243	Stud. Act.	2,900.00
44	9245	Gen. Supp	2,774.78
45	9252	Edur./Trans/Conf.	1,620.00
46	9253	Stud. Act.	553.00
47	9257	Gen. Supplies	48.72
48	9258	Legal Services	11,214.19
49	9259	Gen. Supplies	1,350.00
50	9262	" "	2,663.78
51	9264	" "	1,920.88
52	9270	Stud. Act/mt	2,651.00
53	9284	Gen. Supplies	918.23
54	9290	" "	283.23
55	9291	Stud. Act/mt	14,820.00
56	9296	" "	138.35
57	9309	" "	1,260.00
58	9312	" "	1,471.45
59	9319	" "	384.98
60	9339	Gen. Supplies	917.43
61	9341	Prof./Tech Servs	28,708.20
62	9345	OOD	255,195.34
63	9350	Edur./Trans/Conf.	540.00
64	9352	Textbooks/Print Material	46,687.88
65	9353	Prof./Tech Servs	4,000.00
66	9354	Gen. Supplies	912.41
67	9355	" "	74.72
68	9356	" "	769.67
69	9357	" "	4.99
70	9363	Edur./Trans/Conf.	25,200.00
			\$609,824.95

x 

Donna Chisholm, School Comptroller

x 

School Committee Member

Town of Brookline - School Accounts Payable (AP) Report 6.30.26

Pay to each of the vendors named in the attached AP batches the sums set against their respective names, amounting in the aggregate to \$1,302,051.41

List of AP Batches		Amount	
1	8532	Mileage	511.33
2	8968	Student Activities	1,040.00
3	9060	General Supplies	5,533.01
4	9066	"	596.64
5	9126	"	341.35
6	9162	Student Activities	900.00
7	9211	General Supplies	5,232.58
8	9317	Stud. Act. Textbooks + Print mat'l	29,935.86
9	9323	Gen. Supplies	226.80
10	9386	" "	11,512.57
11	9389	Stud. Act.	844.55
12	9391	Educ / Training Conf.	3,070.80
13	9393	OOD	106,727.82
14	9398	Gen. Supplies	51.97
15	9401	"	4,528.89
16	9402	Stud / Act.	105.44
17	9404	"	1,186.03
18	9406	Gen. Supplies	57.97
19	9415	Stud / Act.	6,251.40
20	9417	"	650.00
21	9418	"	14,901.40
22	9426	Legal	14,941.47
23	9431	Gen. Supplies	239.04
24	9433	"	125.00
25	9434	"	933.45
26	9441	"	5,645.94
27	9443	Education / Training / Conf.	3,500.00
28	9444	Stud. Act.	939.07
29	9449	Educ / Train / Conf.	10,500.00
30	9454	Stud. Act.	34.44
31	9461	"	150.00
32	9462	"	32,584.45
33	9466	Gen. Supplies	1,864.85
34	9473	"	2,610.88
35	9475	Prof / Tech Services	5,938.70
36	9479	Mileage	151.82
37	9484	Stud. Act.	801.68

Town of Brookline - School Accounts Payable (AP) Report 6.30.26

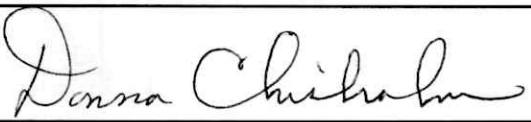
Pay to each of the vendors named in the attached AP batches the sums set against their respective names, amounting in the aggregate to \$1,302,051.41

38	9490	Gen. Supplies	1,683.87
39	9494	Stud. Act.	398.28
40	9496	"	401.00
41	9501	OOD	239,949.99
42	9505	Gen. Supplies	1,582.08
43	9506	Prof / Tech Services	687.00
44	9509	Gen. Supplies	1,869.30
45	9516	Stud. Act.	3,278.00
46	9517	Prof / Tech Serv.	35,706.33
47	9519	Gen. Supp	4,715.12
48	9521	"	2,663.63
49	9523	"	2,351.89
50	9524	Educ / Tran / Conf.	398.00
51	9526	Mileage	171.50
52	9528	Gen. Supp	31.85
53	9529	"	551.85
54	9530	"	637.12
55	9534	"	2,863.61
56	9536	Mileage	1,744.81
57	9539	Gen. Supp	5,439.79
58	9540	"	32,178.58
59	9541	"	13,817.73
60	9542	"	2,543.69
61	9562	"	284.75
62	9567	Transportation	33,426.00
63	9573	Prof / Tech Serv	37,055.59
64	9579	Gen Supp	6,591.63
65	9583	Transportation	11,775.32
66	9585	Educ / Tran / Conf.	200.00
67	9586	Textbooks / Print Matl	51,527.70
68	9587	Educ / Tran / Conf	4,000.00
69	9590	"	3,300.00
70	9592	Prof / Tech Serv	1,694.47
71	9595	Stud. Act.	13,917.73
72	9596	Gen. Supp	1,393.27
73	9599	Educ / Tran / Conf	1,530.68
74	9600	Transportation	46,173.56
75	9603	Prof / Tech Services	953.42
76	9604	Transportation	423,777.07

Town of Brookline - School Accounts Payable (AP) Report 6.30.26

Pay to each of the vendors named in the attached AP batches the sums set against their respective names, amounting in the aggregate to \$1,302,051.41

77	9607	Prof/Tech Serv.	29,998.00
78	9608	"	720.00
79	9610	"	2,900.00
80			
			\$1,302,051.41

x 

Donna Chisholm, School Comptroller

x 

School Committee Member

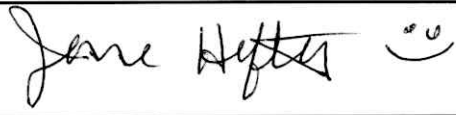
Town of Brookline - School Accounts Payable (AP) Report 7.16.26

Pay to each of the vendors named in the attached AP batches the sums set against their respective names, amounting in the aggregate to \$212,737.80

List of AP Batches		Amount	
1	9677	Legal (26)	21,828.23
2	9678	General Supplies (26)	2,006.65
3	9679	Educ/Train/Conf (26)	1,695.00
4	9680	" (27)	6,075.00
5	9681	Stud. Act. (26)	5,862.05
6	9682	Gen. Supplies (26)	1,308.56
7	9684	OOD Stud Act (26)	17,807.79
8	9687	OOD (26)	64,181.65
9	9716	OOD Stud. Act (26)	466.54
10	9723	Prof/Tech/Services (26)	4,515.37
11	9731	" (26)	38,952.95
12	9740	Online Books/Subscribe (27)	4,539.00
13	9761	Educ/Train/Conf (27)	7,000.00
14	9762	Prof/Tech Serv (26)	36,499.01
15			
16			
17			
18			
19			
20			
			\$212,737.80

x 

Donna Chisholm, School Comptroller

x 

School Committee Member

Town of Brookline - School Accounts Payable (AP) Report 7.23.26

Pay to each of the vendors named in the attached AP batches the sums set against their respective names, amounting in the aggregate to \$100,965.54

List of AP Batches		Amount	
1	9768	Prof. Dues/ members	14,625.00
2	9770	Student Act. 2026	11,322.15
3	9772	General Supplies 2026	145.94
4	9773	Educ/Train/Conf 2026	270.00
5	9774	General Supplies 2026	393.83
6	9780	Prof/Tech Serv. 2026	400.00
7	9817	Mileage 2026	909.44
8	9844	Online Books/subscriptions	41,144.33
9	9847	Student Acting	963.53
10	9848	Education/Train/Conf (scholar.)	27,712.00
11	9850	General Supplies	2,947.57
12	9855	General Supplies	131.75
13			
14			
15			
16			
17			
18			
19			
20			
			\$100,965.54

x 
Donna Chisholm, School Comptroller

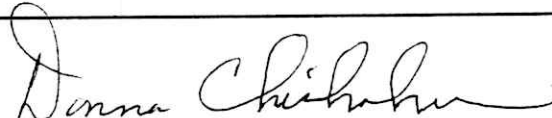
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School Committee Member

Town of Brookline - School Accounts Payable (AP) Report 7.30.26

Pay to each of the vendors named in the attached AP batches the sums set against their respective names, amounting in the aggregate to \$262,039.94

List of AP Batches		Amount	
1	9870	general supplies	✓ 10,187.40 2027
2	9871	" "	✓ 8,255.16 2026
3	9879	" "	✓ 6,711.98 2026
4	9880	" "	✓ 7,413.39 2027
5	9887	education	✓ 9,300.00 2027
6	9891	OOD	✓ 190,345.65 2027
7	9911	general supplies	✓ 468.96 2026
8	9915	" "	✓ 6,297.72 2027
9	9917	" "	✓ 6,739.80 2027
10	9938	education	✓ 8,000.00 2027
11	9944	Student activity	✓ 3,119.54 2026
12	9949	payment fee	✓ 306.87 2027
13	9951	IDEA grant	852.50 2026
14	9955	professional tech services	✓ 783.75 2026
15	9957	student activity	✓ 1,566.00 2026
16	9959	student activity	✓ 1,691.22 2026
17			
18			
19			
20			

\$262,039.94

x 

Donna Chisholm, School Comptroller

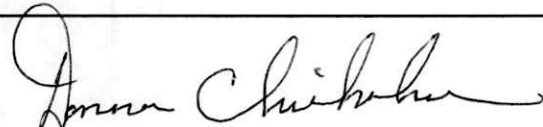
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School Committee Member

Town of Brookline - School Accounts Payable (AP) Report 8.6.26

Pay to each of the vendors named in the attached AP batches the sums set against their respective names, amounting in the aggregate to \$994,680.17

List of AP Batches		Amount	
1	9896	BCF GRANT	7,084.95 2026
2	9899	ZERO WASTE GRANT	2,456.95 2026
3	9904	REVOLVING FUND -FOOD	344.06 2026
4	9905	"	404.70 2026
5	9906	"	54.20 2026
6	9908	PROF/TECH SERVICE	8,668.96 2026
7	9962	OOD	177,288.75 2027
8	9965	FY25 IDEA GRANT	22,964.90 2027
9	9972	ONLINE BOOKS/SUBScrip	50,641.90 2027
10	9982	STUDENT ACTIVITIES	2,578.11 2027
11	9984	EDUC/TRAIN/CONF	4,437.83 2027
12	9986	GENERAL SUPPLIES	13,412.51 2027
13	9990	ONLINE BOOKS/SUBSCRIPT.	185,361.96 2027
14	9994	GENERAL SUPPLIES	5,769.22 2027
15	2	"	3,853.93 2026
16	20	EDUCATION/ TRAINING SVCS	162,640.00 2026
17	24	EDUCATION/SCHOLARSHIP	1,500.00 2027
18	36	STUDENT ACTIVITY	5,137.60 2026
19	46	TOWN EXPENSE	340,079.64 2027
20		CLASSROOM EXPANSION (REEP)	
		\$994,680.17	

x 

Donna Chisholm, School Comptroller

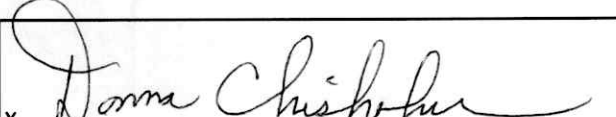
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School Committee Member

Town of Brookline - School Accounts Payable (AP) Report 8.13.26

Pay to each of the vendors named in the attached AP batches the sums set against their respective names, amounting in the aggregate to \$701,527.12

List of AP Batches		Amount	
1	9793	Grant Food	1,193.61 2026
2	9894	" "	419.00 2026
3	9998	General Supplies	2,134.83 2027
4	9999	Online Books...	16,396.10 2027
5	5	General Supplies	8,435.66 2027
6	6	Online Books	3,917.41 2027
7	9	Gen. Supplies	9,642.00 2027
8	55	Stud. Act.	2,778.00 2027
9	56	Gen. Supp.	952.47 2026
10	65	Online Books...	6,102.80 2027
11	69	Gen. Supp.	2,391.38 2026
12	70	OOD	107,282.55 2027
13	71	Prof Tech Services	817.64 2027
14	78	Revolving - Athletics	10,959.82 2026
15	\$ 997.76 ← 81 208,203 → Town	General Supplies *	209,120.76 2027
16	86	"	1,166.76 2026
17	88	Transportation	475.00 2027
18	90	Education	13,600.00 2027
19	93	Stud. Act.	111.43 2026
20	95	"	503.75 2027
21	96	Online Books	369.75 2026
22	104	Stud. Act.	438.01 2026
23	105	Online Books	20.00 2026
24	106 CREDIT	Stud. Act.	-44.61 2026
25	110	Revolving - Fund	9,697.13 2026
26	111	" "	25,382.14 2026
27	129	Gen. Supp.	3,682.42 2027
28	130	Stud. Act.	497.70 2026
29	131	"	47.88 2026
30	132	Gen. Supp.	174.26 2026
31	139	"	1,856.02 2027
32	142	OOD	191,158.05 2027
33	148	Rev. Fund	641.66 2026
34	151	Rev. Ath.	12,000.00 2027
35	157	Stud. Act.	60.83 2026
36	161	Online Books	56,745.00 2027
37	164	Gen. Supp.	399.91 2026
			\$701,527.12

x 

Donna Chisholm, School Comptroller

x  ☺

School Committee Member

Town of Brookline - School Accounts Payable (AP) Report 8.20.26

Pay to each of the vendors named in the attached AP batches the sums set against their respective names, amounting in the aggregate to \$292,243.23

List of AP Batches		Amount	
1	163	Education	2,009.34 2027
2	172	BCF Grant	550.00 2026
3	173	BCF Grant	357.57 2026
4	175	General Supplies	177,245.02 2027
5	177	Legal Services	7,676.88 2027
6	178	Instructional Supplies	REV 1,528.50 2026
7	179	BCF Grant	260.63 2026
8	182	General Supplies	2,222.53 2027
9	188	On line book and subscriptions	11,547.25 2027
10	191	General supplies	1,925.33 2027
11	199	Education/training	3,500.00 2027
12	203	Student activities	1,180.80 2027
13	208	On line books and subscription	19,521.55 2027
14	212	Grant Project bread	2,990.00 2027
15	213	Food service revolving fund	894.72 2026
16	214	Education training conference	1,048.00 2026
17	216	School lunch revolving	3,331.85 2026
18	224	Online books and subscriptions	32,275.00 2027
19	225	Revolving funds athletic	2,416.50 2027
20	228	Transportation	60.00 2027
21	255	Legal service	6,886.76 2026
22	258	Prob. tech service	6,660.00 2026
23	279	On line books + software tool	6,155.00 2027
24		and subscription	
25			

\$292,243.23

x 

Donna Chisholm, School Comptroller

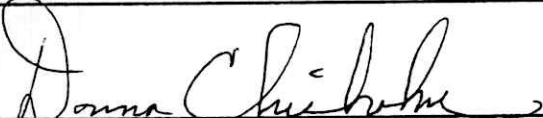
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School Committee Member

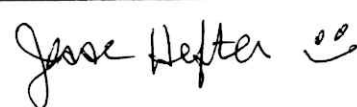
Town of Brookline - School Accounts Payable (AP) Report 8.27.26

Pay to each of the vendors named in the attached AP batches the sums set against their respective names, amounting in the aggregate to \$455,858.39

List of AP Batches		Amount	
1	73	Gen Supplies	434.99 2027
2	168	BCF Grant	3,000.00 2026
3	184	Gen Supplies	2,138.13 2027
4	195	Online Books	4,517.41 2027
5	226	Rev Fund - S/W licenses	31,766.75 2027
6	233	Online Books	457.35 2027
7	253	Gen Supplies	9,071.40 2027
8	278	"	498.18 2027
9	292	Rev Fund - S/W licenses	4,600.00 2027
10	297	Rev Fund - Food	639.10 2027
11	298	Education / Scholarships	7,600.00 2027
12	299	Gen. Supplies	38,277.60 2027
13	302	Rev Fund - Food	14,418.39 2027
14	304	"	16,429.45 2027
15	318	Gen. Supplies	1,182.60 2026
16	321	ODD	149,081.59 2027
17	325	FY26 - BCF - Grant	470.26 2027
18	328	Bank Fee	156.76 2027
19	330	Online Books etc.	157,396.00 2027
20	333	Gen Supplies	45.97 2027
21	334	Online Books etc.	4,755.00 2027
22	336	Student Activities	3,908.00 2027
23	339	Gen Supplies	4,670.47 2027
24	349	Student Act.	342.99 2027
25			
			\$455,858.39

x 

Donna Chisholm, School Comptroller

x 

School Committee Member

Town of Brookline - School Accounts Payable (AP) Report 9.3.26

Pay to each of the vendors named in the attached AP batches the sums set against their respective names, amounting in the aggregate to \$387,169.89

List of AP Batches		Amount	
1	361	Student Activities Gen. Supp.	707.34 2027
2	366	Online Books.	6,168.36 2027
3	371	Gen. Supp	532.67 2027
4	374	Online Books.	704.10 2027
5	376	Education/Training	1,958.88 2027
6	378	" /Scholarships	11,252.59 2027
7	388	Whipple	537.34 2027
8	389	School Lunch - Food	1,465.05 2027
9	394	Education /T/Conf	540.00 2026 *
10	406	Gen Supp	3,567.11 2027
11	412	Educators	2,861.02 2027
12	418	Online Books.	17,548.44 2027
13	423	Prof /Tech Title I Grant	289.17 2027
14	424	Gen Supp	940.00 2026 *
15	427	Prof /Tech Supp.	339.00 2027
16	428	Legal Services	5,272.50 2026 *
17	429	Ath. Revolving	3,552.64 2027
18	447	BHS School Rent /Rental	1,000.00 2027
19	448	ODD	118,997.57 2027
20	457	Transportation	196,351.00 2027
21	460	Gen. Supp	321.72 2027
22	466	"	12,263.39 2027
23			
24			
25			
		\$387,169.89	

x 
Donna Chisholm, School Comptroller

x 
School Committee Member

333 Washington Street, Brookline, Massachusetts 02146

INVOICE DATE; 13-Jul-26

TO: Miller Dyer Spears, Inc
99 Chauncy Street
Boston MA 02111

21201408

2060

\$34,416.00

FUND	ORGANIZATION	ACTIVITY	OBJECT
	2594C209		6B0142

Deputy Superintendent For Administration and Finance



July 14, 2026

Mr. Lap Yan
Project Manager
Building Department
333 Washington Street
Brookline, MA 02445

Re: John R. Pierce School Project
Designer Services Contract Amendment No. 24

Dear Mr. Yan,

LeftField has reviewed Designer Contract Amendment No. 24 presented by Miller Dyer Spears (MDS). The Amendment includes Sasaki's Proposal for \$34,416.00 for Pre-K and Kindergarten Playground Revisions and Added Shade Structures. The revisions to the Pre-K and Kindergarten playground equipment and the added shade structures were requested by the Town of Brookline for safety reasons. The scope of services is in the best interest of the Town and is therefore considered to be required. The Proposal includes MDS's fee and administrative costs.

The scope of services for this proposal is necessary, and the costs are fair and reasonable. LeftField recommends that the Town of Brookline accept Designer Contract Amendment No. 24 for the total amount of \$34,416.00.

Should you have any questions regarding this recommendation of approval, please contact me.

Sincerely,
LeftField Project Management

Lynn Stapleton, AIA, LEED AP B D + C

Attachment: MDS Designer Contract Amendment 24

Cc: Jim Rogers, LeftField, LLC
Adam Keane, LeftField, LLC
Andrew Deschenes, LeftField, LLC
Margret Clark, Miller Dyer Spears, Inc.

CONTRACT FOR DESIGNER SERVICES

AMENDMENT NO. 24

WHEREAS, the TOWN OF BROOKLINE (“Owner”) and MILLER DYER SPEARS, INC. (the “Designer”) (collectively, the “Parties”) entered into a Contract for Designer Services for the Feasibility Study and Schematic Design Phases for the John R. Pierce Elementary School Project (Project Number 201800460040) on January 26, 2021, (“Contract”). The John R. Pierce Elementary School is located at 50 School Street, Brookline, MA 02445; and

WHEREAS, the scope of this work is summarized in the attached Miller Dyer Spears’ (MDS) Proposal for Pre-K and Kindergarten Playground Revisions and Added Shade Structures, dated March 31, 2025, revised July 7, 2026, based on Sasaki’s Proposal, dated July 7, 2026.

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 1 was approved by the Town of Brookline on August 10, 2021; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 2 was approved by the Town of Brookline on September 14, 2021; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 3 was approved by the Town of Brookline on January 11, 2022; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 4 was approved by the Town of Brookline on June 29, 2022; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 5 was approved for approval by the Town of Brookline on July 11, 2023; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 6 was approved for approval by the Town of Brookline on July 11, 2023; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 7 was approved by the Town of Brookline on May 14, 2024 and on June 11, 2024; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 8 was approved by the Town of Brookline on June 11, 2024; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 9 was approved by the Town of Brookline on June 11, 2024; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 10 was approved by the Town of Brookline on June 11, 2024; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 11 was approved by the Town of Brookline on September 4, 2024; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 12 was approved by the Town of Brookline on October 8, 2024; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 13 was approved by the Town of Brookline on November 12, 2024; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 14 was approved by the Town of Brookline on February 11, 2025; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 15 was approved by the Town of Brookline on April 8, 2025; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 16 was approved by the Town of Brookline on May 13, 2025; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 17 was approved by the Town of Brookline on June 10, 2025; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 18 was approved by the Town of Brookline on July 8, 2025; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 19 was approved by the Town of Brookline on August 12, 2025; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 20 was approved by the Town of Brookline on October 15, 2025; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 21 was approved by the Town of Brookline on January 13, 2026; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 22 was approved by the Town of Brookline on February 10, 2026; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 23 was approved by the Town of Brookline on March 10, 2026; and

WHEREAS, effective as of July 14, 2026, the parties wish to amend the contract, as amended:

NOW, THEREFORE, in consideration of the promises and the mutual covenants contained in this Amendment, and other good and valuable consideration, the receipt and legal sufficiency of which are hereby acknowledged, the Parties, intending to be legally bound, hereby agree as follows:

1. The Owner hereby authorizes this Contract Amendment No. 24 for the total value of **\$34,416.00**. The Miller Dyer Spears' (MDS) Contract Amendment is comprised of the attached Sasaki's Proposal for Pre-K and Kindergarten Playground Revisions and Added Shade Structures for \$20,720.00 for Sasaki, \$4,990.00 for STP and \$8,706.00 for MDS' Fee and Mark-ups for a total of \$34,416.00. The Designer is herein authorized to commence the services outlined in this Amendment, pursuant to the terms and conditions set forth in the Contract, as amended.
2. For the performance of services required under the Contract, as amended, the Designer shall be compensated by the Owner in accordance with the following Fee for Basic Services:

Fee for Basic Services	Original Contract	Previous Amendments	Amount of This Amendment	Total of All Amendments
Feasibility Study/Schematic Design Phase	\$1,294,466	\$ 170,652.11	\$ 0	\$ 1,465,118.11
Design Development Phase	\$ 0	\$ 3,705,919	\$ 0	\$ 3,705,919
Construction Documents Phase	\$ 0	\$ 6,229,098	\$ 0	\$ 6,229,098
Bidding Phase	\$ 0	\$ 394,247	\$ 0	\$ 394,247
Construction Phase	\$ 0	\$ 5,164,912	\$ 0	\$ 5,164,912
Completion Phase	\$ 0	\$ 394,247	\$ 0	\$ 394,247
Printing (Over Min.)	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0
A/E Reimbursable Services	\$ 0	1,292,683.50	\$ 34,416.00	\$ 1,327,099.50
HAZMAT Services	\$ 0	\$ 275,083	\$ 0	\$ 275,083

John R. Pierce Elementary School

Designer Contract Amendment No. 24

Geotechnical/Geo- Environmental	\$ 0	\$ 661,270.50	\$ 0	\$ 661,270.50
Site Survey	\$ 0	\$ 63,311.60	\$ 0	\$ 63,311.60
Traffic Studies	\$ 0	\$ 78,473	\$ 0	\$ 78,473
Total Fee	\$1,294,466	\$18,429,902.71	\$ 34,416.00	\$19,758,784.71

This Amendment is for Pre-K and Kindergarten Playground Revisions by Sasaki.

3. The Construction Budget shall be as follows:

Original Budget: \$168,022,660
Amended Budget: _____

4. The Project Schedule shall be as follows:

Original Schedule: (based on 6/1/23 DD start) Substantial Completion – 7/21/27
Amended Schedule: _____

5. This Amendment contains all of the terms and conditions agreed upon by the Parties as amendments to the original Contract, as amended. No other understandings or representations, oral or otherwise, regarding amendments to the original Contract, as amended, shall be deemed to exist or bind the Parties, and all other terms and conditions of the Contract, as amended, remain in full force and effect.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, the Owner, with the prior approval of the Authority, and the Designer have caused this Amendment to be executed by their respective authorized officers.

OWNER:
TOWN OF BROOKLINE

DESIGNER:
MILLER DYER SPEARS, INC.

(print name)

Margaret Clark

(print name)

(print title)

Associate Principal

(print title)

By: _____
(signature)

Signed by:

A1C2DE8824F7470...
By: _____
(signature)

Date: _____

7/8/2026
Date: _____



March 31, 2026 (rev. 7/7/26)

Ms. Lynn Stapleton
101 Federal Street,
Boston, MA 02110

Re: Pierce School - Pre-K and Kindergarten Playground Revisions and Added Shade Structures

Dear Lynn,

As discussed, MDS is submitting this proposal for expenses to be incurred by MDS in the form of additional services for Pre-K and Kindergarten playground equipment revisions and added shade structures requested by the Town. See the following attachments:

- Sasaki proposal, dated July 7, 2026 and fee breakout
- Souza True proposed fee explanation
- MDS fee breakout

For the additional scope defined above, MDS proposes the fees below:

Fee Proposal:	
Sasaki	\$20,720
STP	\$4,990
MDS	\$8,706
Total Additional Service	\$34,416

Please do not hesitate to contact me if you have any questions.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "Margaret O. Clark", written over a light blue horizontal line.

MDS ARCHITECTS
Margaret O. Clark, AIA, LEED AP BD+C, WELL AP
Associate Principal

Cc: A. Mackrell



07 July 2026

Margaret Clark, RA, LEED AP BD+C, WELL AP, MCPPO
Associate Principal
Miller Dyer Spears, Inc.
40 Broad Street
Boston, MA 02109

Re: John R. Pierce School – Additional Service Proposal- Pre-K and Kindergarten Playground Revision

Sasaki Project Number: 08267.00U

Dear Margaret,

Sasaki is pleased to provide you with this proposal for additional services associated with Owner-requested changes to the PreK and Kindergarten Playground at the John R. Pierce School. Our scope of work is described in further detail below.

SCOPE OF ADDITIONAL SERVICES

This proposal includes two presentations to the client group and revisions to the Construction Documents related to Owner-requested changes to previously approved playground equipment at the Pierce School PreK and Kindergarten (PreK/K) Playground.

- Two (2) presentations to the client group to review and present alternative structures to the selected playground equipment in the PreK/K Playground:
 - Meeting 1: Pierce Playground Equipment Review (occurred February 9th, 2026)
 - Meeting 2: Pierce Playground Accessible Equipment Selection (**occurred March 18, 2026**)
 - The scope associated with Meeting 2 included:
 - Product and accessibility research,
 - Vendor coordination,
 - Equipment options and preliminary selection; and
 - Preparation of presentation materials. The format and scope of this presentation were requested during the February 9th meeting by the School and Town of Brookline.
- Per Town direction via email correspondence on March 25, 2026, Sasaki performed the following prior to this additional services request. This work was



completed to provide materials in a timely manner for the proposed follow-up meeting April 14th further discussing equipment selection and the proposed shade structure:

- Product research and design analysis
 - Vendor coordination and meetings discussing accessible design options for the playground
 - Shade studies evaluating the efficacy of the existing shade structure
- Based on the results of Meeting 2 and following final direction on the playground layout from the Town of Brookline, the following modifications to the Construction Documents are anticipated, to be provided in the form of a bulletin:
 - Replace the previously approved Kompan Balance Beam NR0887 with Kompan Balance Beam KPL819;
 - Replace the Baboon Trail (CRP250301) with equipment selected by the School and Town of Brookline;
 - Add one (1) Kompan Play Panel High 1, Communication Panel (PCM003721), or equivalent;
 - Replace the previously approved Landscape Structures Skyways 20x20x20 Triangle Sail Shade with 3x Skyways Cantilever Sail Shades; and
 - Revisions to the playground layout, grading, planting, and drainage to accommodate changes in equipment and fall protection zones.
- Plans impacted by the changes above and to be updated include:
 - C5-03, C5-05, C5-06 (Drainage Plan)
 - L2-00, L2-03 (Layout Plan)
 - L3-03 (Materials Plan)
 - L4-03 (Grading Plan)
 - L5-03, L5-11 (Planting Plan)
 - L6-13 (Soils Plan)
 - L7-03, L7-04 (Site Sections)
 - L8-01, L8-40, L8-41 (Site Details)
- Following the submission of the construction bulletin, Sasaki shall provide Construction Administration support including but not limited to submittal and shop drawing reviews, color/finish selection, and contractor coordination. ✓
- Additional coordination following Meeting 2 shall be limited to the following:
 - Up to one (1) meeting to review final shade structure and playground alignment;
 - Coordination with the Structural Engineer of Record for footing design;
 - Coordination with the playground manufacturer; and
 - Construction administration services as described above.

EXCLUSIONS TO SCOPE OF SERVICES

The following items are categorically excluded from the scope of services covered by this proposal for both Sasaki and any Sasaki-retained subconsultants. If required, these items could be provided as part of negotiated additional services.

SASAKI

- Professional renderings and animations
- Preparation or documentation of as-built conditions
- Architecture and architectural drawings
- Structural engineering
- Cost estimate of procurement and installation of proposed playground equipment revisions

ADDITIONAL SERVICES

The scope covered by this fee proposal does not include any of the following additional services listed below. These services, and others not defined by the base scope of the project above, can be provided on a time or cost basis with compensation negotiated, and with written notice to proceed, in advance of implementation.

- Public meetings and/or community workshops to review design alternatives otherwise not defined in the scope of services
- Coordination with playground manufacturers or additional equipment selection otherwise not defined in the scope of services.
- Additional graphics beyond what is defined in the scope of services
- Technical information gathering, including surveys, technical feasibility studies, and technical programming, egress, or security studies beyond what is defined in the scope of services
- Phases of design, design iterations, or schedule extension beyond what is defined in the scope of services
- Project extensions that are not the result of Sasaki's performance may be considered for additional services

COMPENSATION

Labor Fee

Sasaki proposes to perform this work on a fixed fee basis of \$20,720 (Twenty Thousand Seven Hundred Twenty dollars). Reimbursable Expenses are included in the fee.

Please feel free to reach out with any questions or comments. We look forward to continuing working with you on this exciting project for Brookline at Pierce School.

Sincerely,



Andrew Gutterman, ASLA
Principal

Add Services Request - PreK/K Playground Revisions

7/7/2026

	LACE Principal	LACE PM/Senior Associate	LACE Associate (Landscape)	LACE Staff (Civil)	Task Subtotal
	\$ 400.00	\$ 200.00	\$ 175.00	\$ 145.00	\$ -
Meeting 1- Equipment Submittal Review					
Meeting 2 - Climbing Structure Alternatives & Equipment Submittal Presentation*	1	16	4	8	\$ 5,460.00
Meeting 2 Follow-up: Product Research, Shade Studies, and Vendor Coordination*	1	8	8		\$ 3,400.00
Drawing Modifications/Bulletin Preparation	1	12	24	8	\$ 8,160.00
Shade and Play Coordination Meetings	1	4	8		\$ 2,600.00
Additional Submittal Reviews		2	4		\$ 1,100.00
Total hours	4	42	48	16	\$ 20,720.00

*Effort completed prior to the July ASR

From: Jerome Yurkoski <jyurkoski@souzatrue.com>
Sent: Monday, July 6, 2026 4:59 PM
To: Margaret Clark <mclark@mds-bos.com>
Subject: RE: Pierce added playground shades - add service fee?

Margaret: **Most up to date add service email for Playground shades**

For the Add Service work associated with the structural support of the **added playground shades and adjusted play structures**, we propose an Add Service fee in accordance with the estimated fee breakdown:

Structural Review / PDF Comments

Structural Designer	10 hours at \$160.00 per hour	\$1,600.00
Senior Principal	6 hours at 275.00 per hour	\$1,650.00
	Sub-Total Fee	\$3,250.00

Construction Administration Services

Structural Designer	7 hours at \$160.00 per hour	\$1,120.00
Senior Principal	2.25 hours at 275.00 per hour	\$ 618.75
	Sub-Total Fee	\$1,738.75

Estimated Total Add Service Fee \$4,988.75 (round

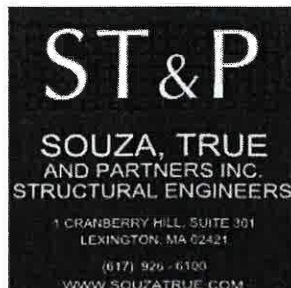
up to \$4,990.00)

Please call or email if you have any questions or comments. Thanks.

Jerome A. Yurkoski, PE, Senior Principal
SOUZA, TRUE & PARTNERS, INC.

(978) 852-6243 (cell)
 (781) 918-7790 (direct)
 (617) 926-6100, extension 101 (main)

Souza, True & Partners, Inc.
One Cranberry Hill, Suite 301
Lexington, MA 02421



From: Jerome Yurkoski
Sent: Monday, July 6, 2026 4:25 PM
To: 'Margaret Clark' <mclark@mds-bos.com>
Subject: RE: Pierce added playground shades - add service fee?

MDS Labor Breakout - PreK/K Playground Modifications and Shade Structures				
Labor to date				
	Hours	Rate	Total	
701 01057 Clark, Margaret 6/22/2026	.75	\$234.23	\$175.67	playground shade mtg time
701 01057 Clark, Margaret 6/23/2026	.50	\$234.24	\$117.12	Shade mtg w Sasaki
701 01057 Clark, Margaret 6/24/2026	.25	\$234.24	\$58.56	AK shade call
602 01033 Macrell, Amy 4/24/2026	.50	\$252.00	\$126.00	Meeting with Sasaki - Playground shade sail cloth
602 01057 Clark, Margaret 3/16/2026	.50	\$234.24	\$117.12	Playground shade sail chat meeting
612 01127 Holmes, Kelsey 4/24/2026	.50	\$203.08	\$101.54	Playground shade sail chat meeting
701 01057 Clark, Margaret 3/16/2026	.50	\$234.24	\$117.12	Playground equipment mtg prep
701 01057 Clark, Margaret 3/18/2026	1.25	\$234.23	\$292.79	Playground equipment meeting
701 01057 Clark, Margaret 3/20/2026	.50	\$234.24	\$117.12	Playground equipment scope discussion with Sasaki
701 01057 Clark, Margaret 4/17/2026	3.00	\$234.23	\$702.69	Playground equipment email with meetings, communications, etc. regarding program.
701 01057 Clark, Margaret 4/20/2026	.50	\$234.24	\$117.12	Playground email history search and call with Kompan rep.
701 01057 Clark, Margaret 5/6/2026	.50	\$234.24	\$117.12	calls with Andy and Jessie re: Playground equipment
701 01057 Clark, Margaret 5/6/2026	2.50	\$234.23	\$585.58	2 hrs Layout and meeting prep and 1/2 hr extended meeting for playground equipment
701 01057 Clark, Margaret 5/7/2026	2.25	\$234.23	\$527.02	Playground email and attachments and pricing requests
701 01057 Clark, Margaret 6/17/2026	.75	\$234.23	\$175.67	Shade mtg
701 01057 Clark, Margaret 6/18/2026	.50	\$234.24	\$117.12	shade markups and email
01 1 27 Holmes, Kelsey 6/23/2026	1.00	\$203.08	\$203.08	review options with MC & PO
01 1 27 Holmes, Kelsey 6/24/2026	2.00	\$203.08	\$406.16	FINALIZE SHEETS OF TWO OPTIONS to share at OAC
01 1 27 Holmes, Kelsey 6/25/2026	.50	\$203.08	\$101.54	get updated cost info from consigh and create ROM spreadsheet for Building commission meeting
01 1 27 Holmes, Kelsey 6/17/2026	.50	\$203.08	\$101.54	meeting on shade
01 1 27 Holmes, Kelsey 6/18/2026	3.00	\$203.08	\$609.24	get product info from rep, layout and shade study update, review with landscape and structural
01 219 Juine, Katelyn 6/18/2026	1.00	\$103.08	\$103.08	Shade Study
Total to Date			\$5,090.00	

Labor projected				
	MDS Principal	MDS Associate Principal	MDS Drafter	
Shade and Play Equipment Coordination/Meetings	\$252.00	\$234.24	\$103.08	Task Total
Bulletin Review and Distribution		8		\$1,873.92
PCO review		4	1	\$1,040.04
Additional Submittal Reviews		1		\$234.24
Total Projected		2		\$468.48
				\$3,616.68
Total MDS				\$8,706.68

TOWN OF BROOKLINE
333 Washington Street, Brookline, Massachusetts 02146

PURCHASE ORDER CHANGE FORM

INVOICE DATE: 13-Jul-26

TO:	Miller Dyer Spears, Inc 99 Chauncy Street Boston MA 02111
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Purchase Order Number:
21201408

Vendor Number:
2060

PAYMENT AMOUNT:
\$9,504.00

BUDGET \$18,732,557.11
BALANCE \$8,775,487.32

FUND	ORGANIZATION	ACTIVITY	OBJECT
	2594C209		6B0142

FOR: John R. Pierce School

Change Order	Date		AMOUNT
25	7/14/2026	Additional design services to structural steel due to low concrete strength. Sag along historic Bulg review	\$9,504.00

BUILDING COMMISSION

APPROVAL OF:

Janet Fierman, Chairman

George Cole

Nathan E. Peck

Brooke Duskin

Jason Bowers

SELECT BOARD

APPROVAL OF:

Bernard Greene, Chairman

David Pearlman

Michael Rubenstein

Amanda Zimmerman

Anthony Buono

SCHOOL COMMITTEE

APPROVAL OF:

Deputy Superintendent For Administration and Finance



July 14, 2026

Mr. Lap Yan
Project Manager
Building Department
333 Washington Street
Brookline, MA 02445

Re: John R. Pierce School Project
Designer Services Contract Amendment No. 25

Dear Mr. Yan,

LeftField has reviewed Designer Contract Amendment No. 25 presented by Miller Dyer Spears (MDS). The Amendment includes Souza True Partners' (STP) Proposal for \$8,640.00 for Structural Repairs of the Historic Building's Roof Trusses. The structural repairs are necessary and prudent and was directed by the Town to pursue for safety and asset maintenance reasons. The scope of services is in the best interest of the Town and is therefore considered to be required. The Proposal includes MDS's administrative costs of \$864.00.

The scope of services for this proposal is necessary, and the costs are fair and reasonable. LeftField recommends that the Town of Brookline accept Designer Contract Amendment No. 25 for the total amount of \$9,504.00.

Should you have any questions regarding this recommendation of approval, please contact me.

Sincerely,
LeftField



Lynn Stasiv

Attachment: Designer Contract Amendment No. 25

Cc: John R. Pierce School
Administration
Meeting

CONTRACT FOR DESIGNER SERVICES

AMENDMENT NO. 25

WHEREAS, the TOWN OF BROOKLINE (“Owner”) and MILLER DYER SPEARS, INC. (the “Designer”) (collectively, the “Parties”) entered into a Contract for Designer Services for the Feasibility Study and Schematic Design Phases for the John R. Pierce Elementary School Project (Project Number 201800460040) on January 26, 2021, (“Contract”). The John R. Pierce Elementary School is located at 50 School Street, Brookline, MA 02445; and

WHEREAS, the scope of this work is summarized in the attached Miller Dyer Spears’ (MDS) Proposal for Structural Repair of Historic Building Roof Trusses, dated July 6, 2025, based on Souza True Partners (STP)’s Proposal, dated July 6, 2026.

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 1 was approved by the Town of Brookline on August 10, 2021; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 2 was approved by the Town of Brookline on September 14, 2021; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 3 was approved by the Town of Brookline on January 11, 2022; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 4 was approved by the Town of Brookline on June 29, 2022; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 5 was approved for approval by the Town of Brookline on July 11, 2023; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 6 was approved for approval by the Town of Brookline on July 11, 2023; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 7 was approved by the Town of Brookline on May 14, 2024 and on June 11, 2024; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 8 was approved by the Town of Brookline on June 11, 2024; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 9 was approved by the Town of Brookline on June 11, 2024; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 10 was approved by the Town of Brookline on June 11, 2024; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 11 was approved by the Town of Brookline on September 4, 2024; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 12 was approved by the Town of Brookline on October 8, 2024; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 13 was approved by the Town of Brookline on November 12, 2024; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 14 was approved by the Town of Brookline on February 11, 2025; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 15 was approved by the Town of Brookline on April 8, 2025; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 16 was approved by the Town of Brookline on May 13, 2025; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 17 was approved by the Town of Brookline on June 10, 2025; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 18 was approved by the Town of Brookline on July 8, 2025; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 19 was approved by the Town of Brookline on August 12, 2025; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 20 was approved by the Town of Brookline on October 15, 2025; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 21 was approved by the Town of Brookline on January 13, 2026; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 22 was approved by the Town of Brookline on February 10, 2026; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 23 was approved by the Town of Brookline on March 10, 2026; and

WHEREAS, Contract Amendment No. 24 is to be approved by the Town of Brookline on July 14, 2026; and

WHEREAS, effective as of July 14, 2026, the parties wish to amend the contract, as amended:

NOW, THEREFORE, in consideration of the promises and the mutual covenants contained in this Amendment, and other good and valuable consideration. the receipt and legal sufficiency of which are hereby acknowledged, the Parties, intending to be legally bound, hereby agree as follows:

1. The Owner hereby authorizes this Contract Amendment No. 25 for the total value of **\$9,504.00**. The Miller Dyer Spears' (MDS) Contract Amendment is comprised of the attached STP's Proposal for Structural Repairs of the Historic Building's Roof Trusses for \$8,640.00 and MDS' Mark-ups for \$864.00 for a total of \$9,504.00. The Designer is herein authorized to commence the services outlined in this Amendment, pursuant to the terms and conditions set forth in the Contract, as amended.
2. For the performance of services required under the Contract, as amended, the Designer shall be compensated by the Owner in accordance with the following Fee for Basic Services:

Fee for Basic Services	Original Contract	Previous Amendments	Amount of This Amendment	Total of All Amendments
Feasibility Study/Schematic Design Phase	\$1,294,466	\$ 170,652.11	\$ 0	\$ 1,465,118.11
Design Development Phase	\$ 0	\$ 3,705,919	\$ 0	\$ 3,705,919
Construction Documents Phase	\$ 0	\$ 6,229,098	\$ 0	\$ 6,229,098
Bidding Phase	\$ 0	\$ 394,247	\$ 0	\$ 394,247
Construction Phase	\$ 0	\$ 5,164,912	\$ 0	\$ 5,164,912
Completion Phase	\$ 0	\$ 394,247	\$ 0	\$ 394,247
Printing (Over Min.)	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0
A/E Reimbursable Services	\$ 0	\$ 1,327,099.50	\$ 9,504.00	\$ 1,336,603.50



July 6, 2026

Ms. Lynn Stapleton
101 Federal Street,
Boston, MA 02110

Re: Pierce School - Structural Repair of Historic Building Roof Trusses

Dear Lynn,

As discussed with Adam Keane, MDS is submitting this proposal for expenses to be incurred by MDS in the form of additional services for Structural Repair of Historic Building Roof Trusses. See attached Souza, True and Partners proposed scope and fee.

For the additional scope defined above, MDS proposes the fees below:

Fee Proposal:	
STP	\$8,640
MDS x1.1 markup	864
Total Additional Service	\$9,504

Please do not hesitate to contact me if you have any questions.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "Margaret O. Clark", written in a cursive style.

MDS ARCHITECTS
Margaret O. Clark, AIA, LEED AP BD+C, WELL AP
Associate Principal

Cc: A. Mackrell

From: Jerome Yurkoski <jyurkoski@souzatrue.com>
Sent: Monday, July 6, 2026 5:08 PM
To: Margaret Clark <mclark@mds-bos.com>
Subject: RE: Pierce School Historic Building Roof Trusses

Margaret: **Latest email proposal for Historic Building Roof Trusses**

This email pertains to the structural analysis / review of the existing roof trusses at the original Historic Building.

As you may know, we have performed one site visit and a follow-up structural analysis of the existing roof trusses (based on our field measurements of the heavy timber roof trusses).

Based on the results of our structural analysis, the existing roof trusses should be reinforced (as the stresses are over the acceptable flexural limits, under full snow load and the existing dead loads).

We propose to be compensated for this additional service work in accordance with the estimated fee breakdown:

Site Visit & Structural Analysis:

Structural Designer	14 hours at \$160.00 per hour	\$2,240.00
Senior Principal	5 hours at 275.00 per hour	\$1,375.00
	Sub-Total Fee	\$3,615.00

Construction Documents / SKSs

Structural Designer	15.5 hours at \$160.00 per hour	\$2,480.00
Senior Principal	4 hours at 275.00 per hour	\$1,100.00
	Sub-Total Fee	\$3,580.00

Construction Administration Services

Structural Designer	6 hours at \$160.00 per hour	\$ 960.00
Senior Principal	1.75 hours at 275.00 per hour	\$ 481.25
	Sub-Total Fee	\$1,441.25

Estimated Total Added Fee	\$8,636.25
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(round up to \$8,640.00)

The above add service fee includes all anticipated expenses.

Please call or email if you have any questions or comments. Thanks.

Jerome A. Yurkoski, PE, Senior Principal
SOUZA, TRUE & PARTNERS, INC.

(978) 852-6243 (cell)
 (781) 918-7790 (direct)
 (617) 926-6100, extension 101 (main)

Souza, True & Partners, Inc.
One Cranberry Hill, Suite 301
Lexington, MA 02421



THE PUBLIC SCHOOLS OF BROOKLINE
OFFICE OF TEACHING AND LEARNING
BROOKLINE, MASSACHUSETTS 02445

PHONE: 617-730-2432
FAX: 617-264-6451

BELLA WONG
INTERIM SUPERINTENDENT OF SCHOOLS

ROBIN BENOIT, Ph.D.
DEPUTY SUPERINTEND OF TEACHING AND LEARNING

International Field Trip Application

Brookline High School- Spanish Language Trip to Spain

Madrid, Granada and Sevilla, Spain

April 14th-24th, 2027

For review and consideration by the
Brookline School Committee

Approval Route:	Approved	Denied	*Returned
Copies to:			
TEACHING & LEARNING	<u>RB</u>	<u></u>	<u></u>
SUPERINTENDENT	<u>PSM</u>	<u></u>	<u></u>
SCHOOL COMMITTEE	<u></u>	<u></u>	<u></u>
MEETING DATE	<u></u>	<u></u>	<u></u>
*REASON RETURNED:	<u></u>	<u></u>	<u></u>

PUBLIC SCHOOLS OF BROOKLINE

School Committee Proposal April 2027

Table of Contents

1. Statement of Purpose
2. Application for out of Country Field Trip
3. Projected Costs
4. Itinerary

Statement of Purpose

Spanish Language Trip to Spain April 14th-24th, 2027 Brookline High School

The goal of this trip is closely aligned with goal 2 of the Public Schools of Brookline's strategic plan to implement a *culturally responsive approach to community engagement [which] not only respects and acknowledges the diverse backgrounds of our stakeholders but actively seeks to integrate their perspectives and needs into our educational strategies*. This trip is also aligned with goal 3 of PSB's current strategic plan: *To partner with families and the community to create safe environments that promote belonging*.

This trip will give students an opportunity to experience Spanish language and culture first-hand outside of the classroom. This trip will allow students to better understand Spanish language, people, culture, and history. This experience will definitely contribute significantly to students' personal and educational development.

The trip consists of spending 2 days in Madrid, where students will visit cultural locations such as the Prado Museum, the Royal Palace, and other locations in the center of the city, such as the squares of Plaza Mayor and Puerta del Sol. After these 2 days in Madrid the group will travel to Granada, in the region of Anadafusia, where we will spend a week and participate in a 20 hour language course in the Center of Modern Languages of the University of Granada. In addition to the classes and cultural visits to some emblematic sights like the Alhambra Palace, students will also engage in hands-on cultural experiences, such as a baking class or a flamenco workshop. These opportunities will help students grow their language skills, and also learn more about the rich history, and cultural diversity of this area.

Purposes of the trip:

1. To develop Spanish fluency
2. To practice intercultural communication and adaptation skills in an immersion setting
3. To facilitate understanding of and exposure to another culture
4. To learn about Spanish culture and history

While students may be able to visit these places on their own/with their families, nothing can replace the experience of doing so together. One of the benefits of a trip abroad is that, undoubtedly, this experience will strengthen friendships and promote cooperation among classmates, as well as help students learn more about the culture of another country. Students will develop communication, teamwork, and leadership skills that extend beyond the classroom.

PUBLIC SCHOOLS OF BROOKLINE

Trip highlights include:

- Royal Palace of Madrid
- Museo del Prado
- Barrio de los Austrias
- The Alhambra Palace
- The Albayzín and Realejo's neighbourhoods
- Day trip to Sevilla
- Paella cooking workshop
- Flamenco workshop

APPLICATION FOR ALL OUT-OF-STATE, OVERNIGHT FIELD TRIPS

Before the trip is announced to students, please submit this form to the Superintendent of Schools:

- (a) three (3) months in advance if the trip is within the United States, or
- (b) six (6) months in advance if the trip is out-of-the country.

For clarity, all forms are to be word-processed, NOT handwritten. To maintain the formatting, delete the lines.

TRIP LOGISTICS:

1. Name of Field Trip: **BROOKLINE HIGH SCHOOL SPAIN TRIP**
2. Educator Requesting Field Trip Approval: **BROOKLINE HIGH SCHOOL TEACHERS**
Elena Cruz López, Marta Fuertes, Kristina Tobey
School: **BROOKLINE HIGH SCHOOL**
Grade Level: **10-12**
3. Have you reviewed the *School Committee Policy I 3 a. for School Sponsored Field Trips*? **YES**
5. Have you reviewed the document "*Administrative Procedures for School Sponsored Field Trips*"? **YES**
6. What is your destination? Destinations in Spain include:
 - **Madrid, Granada and Sevilla**
7. What is the date and time you are leaving school? **4/14/27**
8. What is the date and time you are returning to school? **4/24/27**
9. Do the dates of the trip conflict with any religious holidays or observances?

PUBLIC SCHOOLS OF BROOKLINE

Passover (begins at sundown on Wednesday, April 21, 2027)

We are committed to working with the tour company and our students/families to make any accommodations necessary for students observing this religious observance.

10. How many days will students miss from school? 2 days total (Thursday-Friday, April 15th-16, 2027)

11. How are students being transported (school bus, chartered bus, plane, rail, etc)?

- Each family will be responsible for transporting their student to the airport (Brookline-Logan Airport ; Logan Airport-Brookline)
- Students will be under the auspices of ACIS travel agency while in Spain.
 - Flight to and from Spain- TBD
 - Chartered bus from Madrid to Granada and Granada to Madrid.
 - Bus to Sevilla from Granada and back.

*If students are traveling via bus, please complete the
Requirements for Field Trip Transportation via Bus form.*

12. How many students will be participating in the field trip? Target is 25 (for 1:7 pricing and to satisfy chaperone ratio)

13. What members of the student body are eligible for the trip?

Students enrolled in a BHS Spanish course for the 2026-2027 academic year. Priority will be given to 10th and 11th graders; the trip will be opened to 12th graders if needed for enrollment purposes. If more than 25 students apply and are selected, a lottery will be held.

14. How are students selected to participate in this field trip?

- Successful completion of at least 1 year of Spanish.
- Good character and citizenship, as defined by the Deans, Counselors and PC's.
- Strong academic standing.
- Ability to serve as an ambassador of Brookline and the United States of America.
- Genuine interest in Spanish language, cultures and immersion experiences.
- A demonstrated sensitivity to other peoples and cultures.
- Successful completion of the application, including a brief essay stating why they're a good fit.

15. Where will students be staying?

Students will be staying at hotels pre-screened by the ACIS tour company in Madrid and in a supervised student residence in Granada.

16. What are the names and cell phone numbers of the primary staff chaperones on the trip?

- Elena Cruz López - BHS Spanish Teacher [REDACTED]
- Marta Fuertes-Rodríguez - BHS Spanish Teacher [REDACTED]
- Kristina Tobey - BHS Spanish Teacher [REDACTED]

PUBLIC SCHOOLS OF BROOKLINE

17. Other than those listed in #16 above, what are the names and roles (teacher, parent, etc) of other adult chaperones who will be on the trip?

In addition to BHS chaperones, we will be working with the ACIS Travel Company who'll be provided a tour guide throughout the trip.

EDUCATIONAL RELEVANCE

18. What is the purpose of the trip and how does it relate to Brookline's Learning Expectations (K-8) or BHS Course Syllabi?

The purpose of the trip is to develop student understanding of the Spanish language and culture.

1. This trip will expose students to experience authentic Spanish daily life and routines.
2. Students will use Spanish to communicate in shops, restaurants, cafés, museums, etc.
3. Students will have an opportunity to connect and learn directly from presenters, university professors, and tour guides.
4. Visit to cultural and historical sites that will expose BHS students to the importance of Spanish culture and history.

19. Describe activities planned before the trip to prepare students:

- Pre-departure orientation sessions, as well as group-building activities (ie, breakout rooms, etc.)
- Fundraising events
- Evening parent-teacher-chaperone-admin meetings to review itineraries, logistics and expectations, and sign forms

20. Describe activities planned after the trip for students to wrap-up/reflect:

Students will be asked to reflect in one final "circle" while abroad. Further, students will be asked to share out to their own Spanish classes once back from Spain.

ACCESSIBILITY AND STUDENT SAFETY

21. To what extent does the field trip group reflect the diversity of the school population? What efforts will be undertaken to ensure that, to the greatest extent possible, the participants in this field trip reflect the diversity of the school population?

We will make every effort to make sure that the participants in this trip represent the diversity of students in Brookline High School.

Acceptance to the trip is need-blind and we will make efforts to provide scholarship opportunities through group fundraising efforts. Once participants are chosen, the trip leaders will work closely with each family to assist in the procurement of necessary travel documents. Similarly, we will advertise the travel opportunity through Steps to Success, METCO, and the African American and Latino Scholars program.

PUBLIC SCHOOLS OF BROOKLINE

22. What measures are planned to ensure student safety on the trip, including chaperone coverage, student behavior contracts, etc?

Our chaperone team is highly experienced, the three chaperones have participated in several school trips to Spain, Mexico and Costa Rica since 2010.

ACIS will provide us with a tour director with experience in the area and access to many resources. Beyond this, ACIS has a round-the-clock network within the United States should a parent need to reach them. ACIS also provides various tiers of insurance plans, one of which will be required for travel.

Additionally, students and parents/guardians will fill out a behavioral contract which will clearly outline all the safety rules and consequences for breaking said rules. These will be reviewed together at a parent-student-administrator-chaperone pre-departure meeting.

While abroad, students will never go anywhere alone and will adhere to a strict curfew by which time they will not be allowed to leave their homestays. We encourage students to be reachable on a cell network, and if not, to spend their free time with someone who has international coverage.

23. What is the name and location of the medical facility closest to your destination?

Virgen de las Nieves University Hospital
Av. de las Fuerzas Armadas, 2, Beiro, 18014 Granada, Spain

24. Will students be swimming?

No

25. If traveling outside of the United States, please attach the appropriate Department of State Advisory Review and Notification and a copy of the Consular statement.

Spain is currently at the US State Department's Level 2 Risk ("Exercise Increased Caution") which is common in major tourist destinations within Western Europe.
<https://travel.state.gov/en/international-travel/travel-advisories/france.html>

Brookline High School

Rachel Bio, World Language Curriculum Coordinator
617-713-5094
rachel_eio@psbma.org

ACIS

Tom Heigham, Sales Representative
theigham@acis.com

PUBLIC SCHOOLS OF BROOKLINE

U.S. Embassy in Spain (Madrid)

Calle de Serrano, 75, Salamanca, 28006 Madrid, Spain

FUNDING

26. What is the total cost of the trip? Please detail the major components of the trip below and provide a total.

ACIS Program Cost	\$4900-5100
Administrative fees collected by BHS (phone plans, first aid kit, emergency spending)	\$150
Mandatory Trip Insurance	min. \$100
TOTAL:	\$5350

27. How will the field trip be funded?

The trip will be funded by families of participating students. Partial scholarships will be available. We will raise additional funds through T-shirt sales, bake sales, etc. Previous trips' fundraisers have been able to raise the equivalent of one full scholarship (\$3000-\$5000) through sales/fundraising.

28. What accommodations are made for students who cannot afford the expenses of this trip? Are partial and/or full scholarships available?

Opportunities for partial scholarships will be available based on student need and group fundraising efforts, as previously described.

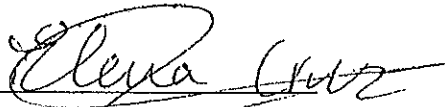
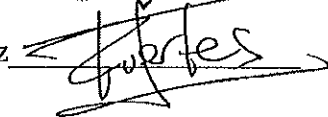
29. If fundraisers are planned to help lower the cost of the trip for all students, please describe those plans here:

We will raise funds at school through various fundraising activities, with particular emphasis on T-shirts/tote bags. Further we can contact local businesses outside for contributions.

PUBLIC SCHOOLS OF BROOKLINE

SIGNATURES:

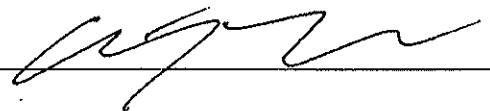
Educators Requesting Field Trip Approval

-
- Elena Cruz López 
-
- Kristina Tobey 
-
- Marta Fuentes-Rodriguez 

World Language Department Chair:

Rachel Eio  Date: 6/22/26

Head of School:

Anthony Meyer  Date: 6/22/26



THE PUBLIC SCHOOLS OF BROOKLINE

OFFICE OF TEACHING AND LEARNING
BROOKLINE, MASSACHUSETTS 02445

PHONE: 617-730-2432

FAX: 617-264-6451

BELLA WONG
SUPERINTENDENT OF SCHOOLS

ROBIN BENOIT, Ph.D.
DEPUTY SUPERINTEND OF TEACHING AND LEARNING

International Field Trip Application

Brookline High School - Kyoto Gaidai Nishi Exchange Program

Japan: Tokyo, Hida Takayama, Kiso Valley, and Kyoto

April 10th-23rd, 2027

For review and consideration by the

Brookline School Committee

Approval Route:	Approved	Denied	*Returned
Copies to:			
TEACHING & LEARNING	<u>RB</u>	_____	_____
SUPERINTENDENT	<u>BTW</u>	_____	_____
SCHOOL COMMITTEE	_____	_____	_____
MEETING DATE	_____	_____	_____
*REASON RETURNED:	_____	_____	_____

PUBLIC SCHOOLS OF BROOKLINE

School Committee BHS Japan Trip Proposal April 2027

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1. Statement of Purpose
2. Application for out of Country Field Trip
3. Projected Costs
4. Itinerary

STATEMENT OF PURPOSE

Japanese-American Exchange between Brookline High school and Kyoto Gaidai Nishi School:
April 10-23, 2027 (Brookline students in Japan)
March 2028-dates TBD (Japanese students in Brookline)

Brookline High School (BHS) Japanese program is continuing an exchange program with our partner school in Kyoto, Japan called Kyoto Gaidai Nishi School (<http://www.kufs.ac.jp/nishiko/>- the website is only in Japanese). This program is a bi-annual exchange. We have traveled to Japan eight times in the past twenty years: four visits to Kyoto Gaidai Nishi in 2014, 2016, 2018, and 2024 (the April 2020 trip was canceled due to Covid), three visits to Nagano High School in Osaka-fu, and we were also invited to participate in the Kizuna Project (a near-fully funded trip by the Japanese government for BHS students to visit Japan to learn about the March 2011 earthquake and tsunami). In addition, we have hosted ten groups of Japanese students from a variety of schools in Japan. We continue our bi-annual trips to Japan by visiting this coming spring and we are planning for students from Kyoto Gaidai Nishi to spend a week in Brookline in March 2028.

The goal of this trip is closely aligned with goal 2 of the Public Schools of Brookline's strategic plan to implement a *culturally responsive approach to community engagement [which] not only respects and acknowledges the diverse backgrounds of our stakeholders but actively seeks to integrate their perspectives and needs into our educational strategies*. This trip is also aligned with goal 3 of PSB's current strategic plan: *To partner with families and the community to create safe environments that promote belonging*.

Specifically, this trip will give students an opportunity to experience Japanese language and culture first-hand, in situations and scenarios that are impossible to create in a classroom. This trip will allow us to better understand the Japanese language, Japanese people, Japanese culture and Japanese history. BHS students will be interacting with their BHS Japanese teacher and host family in the target language, fostering a small, safe, close-knit community within the larger community of BHS.

The exchange will include approximately 16 BHS students. For the first part of the exchange, students will spend 6 days traveling to Tokyo and Takayama. Then, Brookline High School students will be hosted by the Kyoto Gaidai Nishi High School students' families for one week. The eligible students study Japanese, and are interested in Japanese culture, art, architecture, and/or history. Former BHS Japanese teacher Yukiyo Iida and World Language Curriculum Coordinator Rachel Eio will chaperone the trip. For the second part of the exchange, Brookline High School families will host

students from Kyoto Gaidai Nishi for one week in March 2028 as part of their travels in the US.

The goals of this trip are to experience life as a member of a Japanese family, to speak and interact in Japanese, to visit Kyoto and Tokyo, to learn about rural life and traditional arts in Japan, to eat food typical of these regions, and to expand students' knowledge of Japanese culture.

Highlights of the itinerary will include:

Tokyo Area (not an exhaustive list)

- Shibuya and Harajuku neighborhoods
- Teamlabs Borderless Digital Art Exhibit
- Cherry Blossom Viewing
- Akihabara electronics district
- Meiji Shrine
- Chopsticks making class

Hida Takayama & Kiso Valley

- Hida no Sato Folk Village
- Attend Takayama festival in the evening & learn about historic floats and traditional puppets
- Hands on activities making: coasters and embroidery
- Hiking at Matsukura Castle ruins
- Morning Market & Takayama crafts museum
- Guided walking tour of the Kiso Valley
- Stay overnight in a traditional Japanese ryokan (inn)

Kyoto and its surroundings:

- Live with a host family
- Participate in classes at Kyoto Gaidai Nishi High School
- Visit the numerous Buddhist temples, Shinto shrines and castles in the region (Kiyomizu-dera, Ginkaku-ji, Nijo-jo, Ryoan-ji, Fushimi Inari Jinja, etc.)
- Participate in hands on activities such as making Japanese traditional sweets

APPLICATION FOR ALL OUT-OF-STATE, OVERNIGHT FIELD TRIPS

Before the trip is announced to students, please submit this form to the Superintendent of Schools:

(a) three (3) months in advance if the trip is within the United States, or

(b) six (6) months in advance if the trip is out-of-the country.

For clarity, all forms are to be word-processed, NOT handwritten. To maintain the formatting, delete the lines.

TRIP LOGISTICS:

1. Name of Field Trip: Brookline High School-Kyoto Gaidai Nishi Exchange Program
2. Educator Requesting Field Trip Approval: Rachel Eio & Yukiyo Iida
3. School: Brookline High School Grade Level: 11-12
4. Have you reviewed the *School Committee Policy I 3 a. for School Sponsored Field Trips?*

yes

5. Have you reviewed the document “Administrative Procedures for School Sponsored Field Trips”? yes

*If you need copies of the documents for #4 and #5,
contact the Office of Teaching and Learning at 617-730-2432.*

- 6. What is your destination?** Japan: Tokyo, Hida Takayama, Kiso Valley, and Kyoto
7. What is the date and time you are leaving school? April 10, 2027
8. What is the date and time you are returning to school? April 23, 2027
9. Do the dates of the trip conflict with any religious holidays or observances? Passover
(Category 2)- starting the evening of April 21, 2027 (3 days of travel through our return on the 23rd).
All families of interested students will be notified of this date prior to the application deadline and every attempt possible to meet dietary restrictions for religious reasons will be met during the trip. Families will be encouraged to discuss any concerns with the chaperones so that the calendar does not preclude any student from participating.
10. How many days will students miss from school? 5
11. How are students being transported (school bus, chartered bus, plane, rail, etc)?
a. Boston-Tokyo: airplane
b. Tokyo: train, subway
c. Tokyo to Hida Takayama: bullet train and chartered bus
d. Takayama & Kiso Valley: chartered bus
e. Kiso Valley-Kyoto- high-speed train
f. Kyoto: city bus and subway
g. Kyoto-Boston: chartered bus and airplane

*If students are traveling via bus, please complete the
Requirements for Field Trip Transportation via Bus form.*

- 12. How many students will be participating in the field trip?** 16
13. What members of the student body are eligible for the trip? All 11-12th grade students who study Japanese are invited to participate. Priority is given to students in Japanese 3 or higher who are in 11th and 12th grade.
14. How are students selected to participate in this field trip?
Students will be selected based on the following criteria:
- Strong academic record (good study habits, participation, attendance)
- Interest in learning the Japanese language, history and culture
- Ability to serve as an ambassador from Brookline and the United States
- Sensitivity to other people and cultures
- Previous experiences away from home
- Successful completion of the application
- Perceived potential for personal growth as a result of this experience

15. Where will students be staying?

Our first stop will be Tokyo and we will stay in a medium-sized business hotel for 3 nights. Our next stop is in Hida Takayama where students will stay two nights in a traditional Japanese ryokan (inn). In Kyoto, students and chaperones will be staying with host families for seven nights.

16. What are the names and cell phone numbers of the primary staff chaperones on the trip?
BHS staff, Rachel Eio (World Language Curriculum Coordinator and Japanese teacher) and Yukiyo Iida (former BHS Japanese teacher) will accompany the students. Rachel Eio has native-like fluency in Japanese. Rachel Eio has led groups of BHS students seven different times to Japan and Yukiyo Iida was born and raised in Japan and chaperoned 3 prior BHS trips to Japan. Both teachers have travel experience around the world. Rachel Eio and Yukiyo Iida will be supervising the students and be available to them on a 24-hour basis. While in Japan, the two teacher-chaperones will have cell phones and pocket wifi routers. These numbers are listed below for the Office of Teaching and Learning (as well as to the families of participating students) so that they will be able to reach us abroad.

Rachel Eio: Japanese Teacher, BHS World Language Curriculum Coordinator

[REDACTED]
rachel_eio@psbma.org

Yukiyo Iida: former BHS Japanese Teacher

[REDACTED]
yukiyoIida@gmail.com

17. Other than those listed in #16 above, what are the names and roles (teacher, parent, etc) of other adult chaperones who will be on the trip?

The teachers in charge of our exchange program at Kyoto Gaidai Nishi School in Kyoto are:

Ms. Lisa Cross: lisamariexcross@gmail.com

Mr. Masakazu Osumi: m_osumi@kufs.ac.jp

When traveling in Tokyo and Hida Takayama, Rachel Eio and Yukiyo Iida will be the chaperones with the students. In Takayama, a full-time tour guide provided by JTB will be an additional adult with the student. In Kyoto, the teachers listed above will help with any issues arising with host families and school events.

EDUCATIONAL RELEVANCE

18. What is the purpose of the trip and how does it relate to Brookline's Learning Expectations (K-8) or BHS Course Syllabi?

The BHS-Kyoto Gaidai Nishi Exchange Program equips students with the intellectual and social skills necessary to thrive in an increasingly complex and diverse global society. This trip is a direct extension and enrichment to our BHS Japanese curriculum.

In addition, the purpose of the trip is to:

1. To develop communicative competence in Japanese
2. To practice intercultural communication and adaptation skills in an immersion setting
3. To foster long-term and ongoing interest in one another by providing firsthand experiences with another culture
4. To experience Japanese family life
5. To learn about Japanese culture and history
6. To encourage greater understanding between the youth of Japan and the United States

19. Describe activities planned before the trip to prepare students:

- Intensive Language Practice
- Directed study of Japanese history, culture, geography, art, and current events
- Student Meetings to build group cohesion
- Student and Caregiver meetings to review logistics and expectations, and to prepare students to be ambassadors of Brookline
- Fundraising activities to help with costs not covered and for student financial assistance.

20. Describe activities planned after the trip for students to wrap-up/reflect:

- Formal Presentations for Japanese classes (slide/ PPT presentations, photo collages, personal narratives) in the spring of 2027
- Continued correspondence (in Japanese) with host families and contacts made in the areas
- Flipgrid student videos to continue our virtual exchange with our partner school
- Written evaluations

ACCESSIBILITY AND STUDENT SAFETY

21. To what extent does the field trip group reflect the diversity of the school population? What efforts will be undertaken to ensure that, to the greatest extent possible, the participants in this field trip reflect the diversity of the school population?

We are making every effort to create a racially and socio-economically diverse group of students to attend this study abroad trip. This trip is open to all 11th and 12th grade students who have completed Japanese 2 at BHS and are enrolled in the Japanese program in the 2026-27 school year. Once the School Committee has approved the trip, we will make a concerted effort to encourage participation from a broad spectrum of BHS students so that the group reflects the make-up of the larger student body. The exchange will be widely advertised in class by teachers of Japanese, as well as through programs such as METCO, Steps to Success, and the African American & Latino Scholars Program. Acceptance to the trip is need-blind and we will make efforts to provide scholarship opportunities through group fundraising efforts. Historically, each trip has had a number of students accepted who received financial assistance and we have a healthy balance in our account to support these students. We also plan to work as a group to fundraise to help defray costs when possible for all.

We will make every effort to accommodate any physical and emotional disabilities that students may have. Many of the museums and tourist sites that we plan to visit are wheelchair accessible and offer audio tours, and the transportation we plan to utilize (plane, tour bus and public transportation) are generally handicap accessible.

22. What measures are planned to ensure student safety on the trip, including chaperone coverage, student behavior contracts, etc.

We have two BHS teachers chaperoning the trip who have experience in international travel, know the students well, and have chaperoned other BHS international trips. These chaperones will be available to the students 24-hours a day. Students will be expected to abide by all US & Japanese laws, as well as all Brookline High School rules throughout the duration of the trip. Students will be informed of these expectations in advance, sign a behavioral contract, and will meet with a Dean of Students reviewing all rules and expectations of the trip, as well as consequences for breaking said contract. We will meet with parents and students during the planning portion of the exchange to

outline our behavior expectations. Japan is one of the safest countries in the world and people are extremely hospitable to foreign exchange students. We will follow any State Department advisories in the unlikely event any are issued.

KGn (our partner school) takes student safety very seriously, and has a very high standard for host family oversight. They have many years of experience working with students from around the world and screen host families carefully to make safe, appropriate matches. They will provide BHS students and the host families with a thorough safety orientation and set of expectations for our exchange at their school.

23. What is the name and location of the medical facility closest to your destination?

These hospitals have been recommended by the U.S. Embassy in Tokyo as having English-speaking doctors:

- Keio University Hospital: 35 Shinanomachi, Shinjuku-ku, Tokyo
Telephone from the U.S.: 011-81-3-3353-1211
- Kyoto City Hospital: 1-2 Higashi Takada-cho, Mibu, Nakagyo-ku, Kyoto
Telephone from the U.S.: 011-81-75-311-5311
- Japanese Red Cross Takayama Hospital : 3-113-11 Tenman-machi, Takayama-shi
Telephone from the US: 011-81-577-32-1111

24. Will students be swimming? (please note: if swimming is planned, parents must give explicit written permission for their child to swim; students who do not have this express written permission will not be allowed to swim) No

25. If traveling outside of the United States, please attach the appropriate Department of State Advisory Review and Notification and a copy of Consular statement.

There are currently no State Department travel alerts or travel warnings for Japan. We will continually monitor the State Department website in the unlikely event of changing conditions. We are aware of the location of the nearest embassy, in the event of an emergency. We will enroll interested students and chaperones in the State Department's STEP program to keep updated on any changes concerning travel to Japan. Information from the Department of State about travel to Japan is regularly updated online and can be found at these links:

<http://travel.state.gov/content/passports/en/country/japan.html>

<https://travel.state.gov/content/passports/en/alertswarnings.html>

FUNDING

26. What is the total cost of the trip? Please detail the major components of the trip below and provide a total. (add/edit headings as necessary)

The projected cost for the trip is \$6950. This cost includes: round trip airfare on scheduled airlines, tour buses/airport transfers, food, and miscellaneous administrative expenses, as well as Travel Insurance.

Please note that we are aware that the costs of this trip are very high. We are working continuously with our travel agent to find ways to make the cost more affordable. We are trying to seek group rates for plane tickets from the airline companies directly, as well as funding from the Consulate General of Japan in Boston and The Japan Society. If this means a change in itinerary, we will communicate

those changes with the Head of School. This budget represents a maximum amount but is not ideal.

PER STUDENT:

Lodging	~\$800
Transportation (airfare/bus/trains)	~\$4700
Meals	~\$850
Admissions/Tickets	~\$300
Administrative Costs	~\$300
TOTAL:	~\$6950**

** The cost increases this year are due to high fuel costs, insurance cost increases, additional tariffs, and a sales tax increase in Japan. In addition, tourist costs for lodging and food expenses have gone up due to overtourism in Japan, as well as the increase in fuel costs due to international conflicts.

27. How will the field trip be funded?

The trip will be funded by the families of participants. As described in #28 and #29 below, we will actively engage in fundraising efforts to raise money for financial aid and students will be encouraged to assist their family by contributing to the cost through their own work.

28. What accommodations are made for students who cannot afford the expenses of this trip? Is there partial and/or full financial aid available?

Opportunities for partial scholarships will be available based on student need and group fundraising efforts, as previously described. As we did for the last seven exchange trips, we will advertise throughout the school: at Advisory Meetings, in Japanese classes, during "Info Time" and to students in BHS programs such as Steps to Success, METCO, and African American & Latino Scholars Program.

29. If fundraisers are planned to help lower the cost of the trip for all students, please describe those plans here:

Fundraising activities may include the bake sales, Japanese food/drink sales, t-shirt sales, Cherry Blossom Festival fundraising, and/or movie screenings. Families and friends will have the option of contributing financially to a travel financial aid fund. We will also solicit corporate/private donations from local Japanese businesses and US companies. All students involved are expected to participate actively in fund-raising activities.

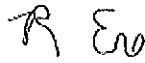
If you need any assistance as you complete this application, please contact the Office of Teaching and Learning at 617-730-2432.

Signatures:

Educators Requesting Field Trip Approval:

Date: 6/26/26

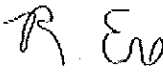
Rachel Eio:



Yukiyo Iida:

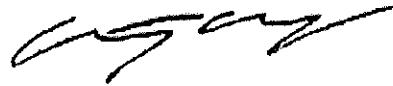
Date: 6/26/26

World Language Department Head: Rachel Eio

 _____

Date: 6/26/26

Head of School: Anthony Meyer



Date: 6/7/26



THE PUBLIC SCHOOLS OF BROOKLINE
OFFICE OF TEACHING AND LEARNING
BROOKLINE, MASSACHUSETTS 02445

PHONE: 617-730-2432
FAX: 617-264-6451

BELLA WONG
SUPERINTENDENT OF SCHOOLS

ROBIN BENOIT, Ph.D.
DEPUTY SUPERINTEND OF TEACHING AND LEARNING

In-State Field Trip Application
Lawrence School – Farm School Field Trip
Athol, MA

Group A - October 13th-14th, 2026

Group B - October 14th-15th, 2026

Group C - October 15th-16th, 2026

For review and consideration by the
Brookline School Committee

Approval Route:	Approved	Denied	*Returned
Copies to:			
TEACHING & LEARNING			
SUPERINTENDENT			
SCHOOL COMMITTEE			
MEETING DATE			
*REASON RETURNED:			

PUBLIC SCHOOLS OF BROOKLINE

APPLICATION FOR ALL IN-STATE, OVERNIGHT FIELD TRIPS

TRIP LOGISTICS:

1. Name of Field Trip: **Farm School Field Trip**
2. Educator Requesting Field Trip Approval: **Christine Moodie**
3. School: **Lawrence School** Grade Level: **7**
4. Have you reviewed the *School Committee Policy I 3 a. for School Sponsored Field Trips*? **YES**
5. Have you reviewed the document "*Administrative Procedures for School Sponsored Field Trips*"? **YES**
6. Have you reviewed the document "*Field Trip Planning Guide*"? **YES**

These documents can be found in the Staff Portal of the district website (www.brookline.k12.ma.us) in the Office of Teaching and Learning link.

7. What is your destination? **The Farm School 488 Moore Hill Rd, Athol, MA 01331**
8. What is the date and time you are leaving school? **Tuesday, October 13th - Thursday, October 16th**
Group A - Tuesday the 13th at 8am
Group B - Wednesday the 14th at 8am
Group C- Thursday the 15th at 8am
9. What is the date and time you are returning to school? **Wednesday, October 14th - Friday, October 16th**
Group A - Wednesday the 14th at 1pm
Group B - Thursday the 15th at 1pm
Group C- Friday the 16th at 1pm
10. Do the dates of the trip conflict with any religious holidays or observances? **NONE**
11. How many days will students miss from school? **students attend in groups, each group will miss 2 days of school**
12. How are students being transported (school bus, chartered bus, plane, rail, etc)? **bus**

*If students are traveling via bus, please complete the
Requirements for Field Trip Transportation via Bus form.*

- I filled this out but not sure if the rates will change for the 26-27 school year.

13. How many students will be participating in the field trip? **61 students (subject to change depending on 7th grade enrollment)**
14. What members of the student body are eligible for the trip? **7th grade**
15. How are students selected to participate in this field trip? **all of 7th grade**
16. Where will students be staying? **The Farm School 488 Moore Hill Rd, Athol, MA 01331**
17. What are the names and cell phone numbers of the primary staff chaperones on the trip?
Christine Moodie [REDACTED]
18. Other than those listed in #16 above, what are the names and roles (teacher, parent, etc) of other adult chaperones who will be on the trip?
Vanessa Bilello (Principal)
Charles Deily (7/8 math teacher)
Gabby Alvarez (8th science teacher)
Kevin Mackenzie (6/7 social studies teacher)
Lora Smid (6/7 math teacher)
Colin King (PE/Health teacher)

PUBLIC SCHOOLS OF BROOKLINE

EDUCATIONAL RELEVANCE

19. What is the purpose of the trip and how does it relate to Brookline's Learning Expectations (K-8) or BHS Course Syllabi? **The focus for 7th grade science is the study of systems and cycles in nature and a farm is the perfect place to experience the interaction and exchange of energy. At the Farm School, students will study the relationship between organisms in the farm ecosystem. Students will learn about the importance of composting, crop rotation, soil nutrients, and land stewardship. Additionally, this will serve as a social and emotional opportunity as students will be tasked with chores that require them to work collaboratively.**

20. Describe activities planned before the trip to prepare students: **Students will be studying how Earth's surface has changed over long periods of time. They will explore how matter cycles through the nonliving components of an ecosystem and use data and models to explain how Earth's surface has changed in the past, and predict how and where it might change in the future.**

21. Describe activities planned after the trip for students to wrap-up/reflect: **Students will conduct field studies of the soil in various places around Lawrence to see what makes "good" soil. Students will continue to study soil, essential plant nutrients, ecosystem relationships, and will eventually work collaboratively to create sustainable bottle ecosystems, incorporating how matter cycles through both the living and nonliving components of an ecosystem. Students will also engage in lessons around how biodiversity can be beneficial to protecting an ecosystem.**

ACCESSIBILITY AND STUDENT SAFETY

22. To what extent does the field trip group reflect the diversity of the school population? What efforts will be undertaken to ensure that, to the greatest extent possible, the participants in this field trip reflect the diversity of the school population? **All 7th graders are able to participate. All students will be working together to ensure that the farm chores are completed before making dinner and dining as a group. The students will play collaboratively as well as work collaboratively.**

23. What measures are planned to ensure student safety on the trip, including chaperone coverage, student behavior contracts, etc. **Students will have chaperones (and farmers) with their groups at all times and follow all school rules while on the trip.**

24. What is the name and location of the medical facility closest to your destination? **Athol Hospital, 2033 Main St, Athol, MA 01331**

25. Will students be swimming? (please note: if swimming is planned, parents must give explicit written permission for their child to swim; students who do not have this express written permission will not be allowed to swim) **NO, students will not be swimming.**

FUNDING

26. What is the total cost of the trip? Please detail the major components of the trip below and provide a total. *(add/edit headings as necessary)*

Lodging/ Farm School Admission	\$110 * 61 students = \$6,710
Travel	Bus for 4 days 14 hrs* 190/hour= \$2,850*
Meals	\$100 for snacks

PUBLIC SCHOOLS OF BROOKLINE

Nurse	\$2,000**
Admissions/Tickets	N/A
TOTAL:	\$11,660

*Note - I haven't received the bus confirmations yet so the bus amount is based on last year's trip/bus rates.

**Nurse Note: I reached out to confirm this trip with the School Nurse. A nurse will need to attend for one of the dates. The cost for the nurse to attend will vary depending on the nurse. We won't be able to secure a nurse until the fall, so this amount is subject to change.

27. How will the field trip be funded?

The Lawrence PTO has budgeted \$6,250 for the 2025 Farm School trip. The remaining money will be paid by each family.

28. What accommodations are made for students who cannot afford the expenses of this trip? Are partial and/or full scholarships available? **Students who cannot afford to attend will be covered in full by the Lawrence PTO.**

29. If fundraisers are planned to help lower the cost of the trip for all students, please describe those plans here: **None**

*If you need any assistance as you complete this application,
please contact the Office of Teaching and Learning at 617-730-2432.*

Signatures:

Educator Requesting Field Trip Approval: Christine Moodie Date: 6/25/26

Principal: Vanessa Bilello Vanni Date: 6/25/2026



THE PUBLIC SCHOOLS OF BROOKLINE

OFFICE OF TEACHING AND LEARNING
BROOKLINE, MASSACHUSETTS 02445

PHONE: 617-730-2432

FAX: 617-264-6451

BELLA WONG
INTERIM SUPERINTENDENT OF SCHOOLS

ROBIN BENOIT, Ph.D.
DEPUTY SUPERINTEND OF TEACHING AND LEARNING

Out-of-State Overnight Field Trip Application

Pierce School -7th Grade Nature's Classroom

Swanzey, NH

November 4-6, 2026

For review and consideration by the
Brookline School Committee

Approval Route:	Approved	Denied	*Returned
Copies to:			
TEACHING & LEARNING	<u>RB</u>	_____	_____
SUPERINTENDENT	<u>RB</u>	_____	_____
SCHOOL COMMITTEE	_____	_____	_____
MEETING DATE	_____	_____	_____
*REASON RETURNED:	_____	_____	_____

PUBLIC SCHOOLS OF BROOKLINE

APPLICATION FOR ALL OUT-OF-STATE, OVERNIGHT FIELD TRIPS

TRIP LOGISTICS:

1. Name of Field Trip: *NATURE'S CLASSROOM - SWANZEY, NEW HAMPSHIRE*
2. Educator Requesting Field Trip Approval: *Jim Stoddard, Eileen Pushee*
3. School: *PIERCE* Grade Level: *7*
4. Have you reviewed the *School Committee Policy 13 a. for School Sponsored Field Trips*? *YES*
5. Have you reviewed the document "*Administrative Procedures for School Sponsored Field Trips*"? *YES*
6. Have you reviewed the document "*Field Trip Planning Guide*"? *YES*

These documents can be found in the Staff Portal of the district website (www.brookline.k12.ma.us) in the Office of Teaching and Learning link.

7. What is your destination? *Nature's Classroom, Swanzey NH*
8. What is the date and time you are leaving school? *November 4, 2026 8:30 am*
9. What is the date and time you are returning to school? *November 6, 2026 1:00 pm*
10. Do the dates of the trip conflict with any religious holidays or observances? *NO*
11. How many days will students miss from school? *3*
12. How are students being transported (school bus, chartered bus, plane, rail, etc)? *SCHOOL BUS*
If students are traveling via bus, please complete the
Requirements for Field Trip Transportation via Bus form.
13. How many students will be participating in the field trip? *Approx 70 students*
14. What members of the student body are eligible for the trip? *All of grade 7*
15. How are students selected to participate in this field trip? *All of grade 7 is invited to participate*
16. Where will students be staying? *On-site in Nature's Classroom dormitories*
17. What are the names and cell phone numbers of the primary staff chaperones on the trip?
Jim Stoddard: [REDACTED] Eileen Pushee: [REDACTED]
18. Other than those listed in #16 above, what are the names and roles (teacher, parent, etc) of other adult chaperones who will be on the trip? *Marlie Goncalves, Emily Loum-Follett, other members of the Grade 7/ Pierce School staff TBD*

EDUCATIONAL RELEVANCE

19. What is the purpose of the trip and how does it relate to Brookline's Learning Expectations (K-8) or BHS Course Syllabi? *Students will engage in activities including but not limited to hands on study of the natural environment including ways in which producers, consumers and decomposers all depend on each other. Students will study and explore the dynamic interactions in the natural world, design and build a miniature community, compose woodland music, play Native American games and do all this while examining their own social interactions.*
20. Describe activities planned before the trip to prepare students: *Science teacher will preview the trip in each science class; homeroom teachers will do so as well.*
21. Describe activities planned after the trip for students to wrap-up/reflect: *Students will reflect upon the experience and have a better understanding of how they are interacting both with their environment and each other. This will take place in HHomerooms, Science class, and possible whole-class assembly.*

ACCESSIBILITY AND STUDENT SAFETY

22. To what extent does the field trip group reflect the diversity of the school population? What efforts will be undertaken to ensure that, to the greatest extent possible, the participants in this field trip reflect the diversity of the school population? Please confirm in your answer that students are selected for the trip on a

PUBLIC SCHOOLS OF BROOKLINE

need-blind basis and that the trip will be advertised to students as need-blind, so that it is accessible to all students. *All members of our 7th grade class are expected to attend providing an exact reflection of the diversity of our 7th grade population. Administration will work with different support personnel to ensure all students' ability to attend this trip.*

23. What measures are planned to ensure student safety on the trip, including chaperone coverage, student behavior contracts, etc. *Pierce staff and Nature's Classroom staff will provide the necessary chaperone coverage. Individual students requiring behavior contracts will be monitored directly by a Vice Principal while on the trip. Said students will also meet with VP and parents prior to trip to ensure all appropriate proactive interventions are in place.*

24. What is the name and location of the medical facility closest to your destination?

Cheshire Medical Center, 580 Court Street, Keene, NH

25. Will students be swimming? (please note: if swimming is planned, parents must give explicit written permission for their child to swim; students who do not have this express written permission will not be allowed to swim) *NO SWIMMING WILL OCCUR.*

26. If travelling outside of the United States, please attach the appropriate Department of State Advisory Review and Notification and a copy of Consular statement.

FUNDING

27. What is the total cost of the trip **per student**? Please detail the major components of the trip below and provide a total. *(add/edit headings as necessary)*

Lodging, Meals, Program	\$302 per student
Travel	\$32.60 per student
Meals	
Admissions/Tickets	
TOTAL per student:	\$334.60 per student

28. How will the field trip be funded? *Parent contribution/PTO*

29. What accommodations are made for students who cannot afford the expenses of this trip? Are partial and/or full scholarships available? *Partial and full scholarships will be provided for any student that is in need via Financial Aid Application or PTO contribution*

30. If fundraisers are planned to help lower the cost of the trip for all students, please describe those plans here:

*If you need any assistance as you complete this application,
please contact the Office of Teaching and Learning at 617-730-2432.*

Signatures:

Educator Requesting Field Trip Approval: *Jim Stoddard*

Date: June 25, 2026

Principal: *Jim Stoddard*, Vice Principal

Date: June 25, 2026

Bella Wong
Superintendent of Schools
bella_wong@psbma.org
(617) 730-2401

**PUBLIC SCHOOLS of
BROOKLINE**
Office of Administration & Finance
333 Washington Street, Brookline, MA 02445

Aaron Osborne
Deputy Superintendent, OAF
aaron_osborne@psbma.org
(617) 730-2425

MEMORANDUM

Date: August 19, 2026
To: The Public Schools Of Brookline School Committee
From: Aaron Osborne, Deputy Superintendent, Office of Administration & Finance
Re: Request for Gift Acceptance

Pursuant to district policy, District Administration requests that the School Committee approve the gifts summarized below:

<u>Donor</u>	<u>Amount</u>	<u>Recipient/Purpose</u>	<u>Account #/Name</u>
EL Teachers	\$140.00	Brookline High School Gift Account/ Honoring former ELE Director, Kathleen (Kay) Polga	3300SEF9/ BHS Gift Account

Recommendation:

That the School Committee accepts the gifts as described above.

Re: donations

Donna Chisholm <donna_chisholm@psbma.org>

Thu, Jul 2, 2026 at 8:31 AM

To: Mindy Paulo <mindy_paulo@psbma.org>

Cc: Kelli McDermott <kelli_mcdermott@psbma.org>, Robin Benoit <robin_benoit@psbma.org>, Ashley O'Sullivan <ashley_osullivan@psbma.org>

Hi Mindy,

This information should be presented in a memo to the SC Finance Subcommittee at their next meeting.

We will contact you once the schedule for FY27 is posted.

Thank you.

Donna

On Wed, Jul 1, 2026 at 7:32 PM Mindy Paulo <mindy_paulo@psbma.org> wrote:

Hi Donna,

I hope your summer is off to a great start.

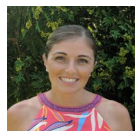
Earlier this year I connected with you about establishing a fund in honor of my predecessor, Kathleen (Kay) Polga, who passed away a couple of months ago. A number of former and current EL teachers along with some of Kay's family members have made a donation in her memory. They would like us to use these funds to support our English learners at the high school. They specifically would like the funds to go towards our ELE Awards each spring but are also open to using the funds to support English learners who are unable to cover the costs of field trips or other enrichment opportunities. Currently we use district funds to purchase books for the award recipients. They would like us to use their donations to purchase books and place a book plate in each book to honor Kay.

Ideally we'd like to call this the Kay Polga Memorial Fund. We would collect donations each spring from current and former EL staff and Kay's family. A retired EL teacher would take the lead on this. This month I have received \$140 in checks from staff. Checks were made payable to "Brookline High School Gift Fund." I estimate we will collect approximately this amount of money each year. It's not a lot of money but it will cover the costs of our ELE awards with funds left.

I understand that School Committee must approve all donations.

What should my next step be?

Many thanks for your help and guidance,
Mindy



Mindy Paulo

Director, Office of English Language Education

617-264-6413 | mindy_paulo@psbma.org

<https://www.brookline.k12.ma.us>



--

Donna Chisholm

School Comptroller

Public Schools of Brookline | Office of Administration and Finance

[333 Washington Street, 5th Floor](#)

Brookline, MA 02445
(617) 730-2423

Bella Wong
Superintendent of Schools
bella_wong@psbma.org
(617) 730-2401

**PUBLIC SCHOOLS of
BROOKLINE**
Office of Administration & Finance
333 Washington Street, Brookline, MA 02445

Aaron Osborne
Deputy Superintendent, OAF
aaron_osborne@psbma.org
(617) 730-2425

MEMORANDUM

Date: September 9, 2026
To: The Public Schools Of Brookline School Committee
From: Aaron Osborne, Deputy Superintendent, Office of Administration & Finance
Re: Request for Grant Acceptance

Pursuant to district policy, District Administration requests that the School Committee approve the grant awards summarized below:

<u>Source</u>	<u>Amount</u>	<u>Grant/Point Person/Purpose</u>	<u>Account #/Name</u>
Massachusetts Department of Agriculture	\$500,000.00 -Original Application \$460,631.00 -Award	Food Security Infrastructure Grant Point Person: Sasha Palmer To upgrade the Lincoln and BHS Greenough Cafeteria and replace outdated equipment. <u>Introduction</u> The Massachusetts Department of Agricultural Resources (MDAR) invites eligible applicants to apply for the FY27 Food Security Infrastructure Grant (FSIG). FSIG supports capital infrastructure and equipment projects that build a stronger, more resilient, and more equitable food system within Massachusetts. Funded projects may: • Increase local food production and consumption • Expand processing, storage, and distribution capacity • Improve food access in commercial and noncommercial settings • Strengthen food system resilience and emergency preparedness Projects that directly benefit underserved and under-resourced communities will receive priority consideration. Goals: The Food Security Infrastructure Grant Program (FSIG) supports initiatives that improve food security and ensure equitable access to locally grown, raised, harvested, and caught foods by strengthening Massachusetts' food supply chain. The program defines local food as products grown, raised, harvested, or produced and consumed within the Commonwealth, including food sourced from nearby states. This aligns with Strategic Plan Goal 3: Develop a climate and culture in which all students, staff, and caregivers experience a strong sense of belonging and safety.	TBD

Recommendation:

That the School Committee accepts the grant awards as described above.

ATTACHMENT A

FY27 FOOD SECURITY INFRASTRUCTURE GRANT (FSIG)

Scope of Services & Estimated Budget

PROJECT NAME	Brookline High School and Lincoln Cafeteria Expansion and Food Distribution Enhancement
OPERATION NAME	Public Schools of Brookline
PROJECT MANAGER	Sasha Palmer
PHONE	(617) 730-2499
EMAIL	sasha_palmer@psbma.org
MAILING ADDRESS	490 Heath St, Brookline, MA 02467
PROJECT LOCATION	490 Heath St, Brookline, MA 02467
MAXIMUM OBLIGATION / AWARD AMOUNT	\$460,631.00

PURPOSE

To ensure a clear understanding between the Massachusetts Department of Agricultural Resources ("Department") and the contractor, **Public Schools of Brookline** ("Contractor") regarding their respective responsibilities and performance expectations, the following Scope of Services and Estimated Budget ("Scope") sets forth a detailed description of all obligations, responsibilities, and additional terms and conditions agreed upon by both parties. This Scope does not modify or supersede the standard contract terms and conditions of the Commonwealth. All documents included in this contract package and incorporated herein by reference shall be collectively referred to herein as the "Contract."

SCOPE

The Contractor shall receive grant funds from the Department to carry out the project described as **Brookline High School and Lincoln Cafeteria Expansion and Food Distribution Enhancement** (the "Project"), as outlined more specifically in Attachment B- Approved Budget and further detailed in Attachment G: Response to RFR ("Attachment G"), incorporated herein by reference, on the property identified therein as **490 Heath St, Brookline, MA 02467** (the "Property").

The Contractor shall use the grant funds to purchase the equipment, materials, and/or services necessary to implement the Project in accordance with applicable manufacturer specifications (where relevant), all required federal, state, and local requirements set forth by law, and the scope and details described in Attachment G.

If there are any conflicts between language in this Scope and that contained in Attachment G, the language in this Scope shall apply.

CONTRACTOR RESPONSIBILITIES

- A. The Contractor shall purchase all approved equipment, materials, and, where applicable, contract labor necessary to complete the Project, as described in Attachment G, by June 30, 2027. The use of funds must align with the Project description and budget approved by the Department and set forth in this Scope, unless otherwise modified by this Contract or approved in writing by the Department prior to incurring the expenses. All equipment and materials must be new. Where applicable, they shall comply with relevant IEEE standards and be UL-listed.
- B. The Contractor shall ensure that all applicable manufacturer recommendations related to the use or installation of equipment and materials are followed. The Contractor shall also comply with any technical guidance or implementation recommendations provided by the Department in connection with the Project.
- C. The Contractor shall maintain and submit all original receipts, invoices, and supporting documentation for all equipment, materials, and services purchased with grant funds. Submission of these documents is required for reimbursement and must clearly demonstrate alignment with the approved Project and budget. The Contractor shall retain copies of all such records and make them available to the Department upon request for audit or review. The Department may, in its sole discretion, deny reimbursement for any costs not covered by this Contract.
- D. The Contractor shall ensure that any subcontractors or vendors engaged to perform work on the Project are properly licensed and insured, and that all work is performed in compliance with applicable federal, state, and local laws, including but not limited to, building codes, safety standards, permitting or other approval requirements, and other relevant laws and regulations.

- E. The Contractor shall take reasonable measures to ensure that all equipment and materials purchased with grant funds are used for the intended purposes described in the Project and remain in use for the useful life of the item or as otherwise specified by the Department.
- F. The Contractor shall comply with all applicable federal, state, and local laws, regulations, and policies governing procurement, environmental compliance, labor standards, accessibility, and any other requirements relevant to the Project.

TIMELINE

- A. Work performed or purchases made prior to the Project start date shall not be eligible for reimbursement. The start date is the date on which the Contract is executed by the Department's Authorized Signatory, not the date on which the Contractor executes the Contract.
- B. No grant funds shall be used for any work or purchases made after June 30, 2027.
- C. Contractors shall adhere to the timeline provided in Attachment G to ensure the timely completion of the Project.

COMPLIANCE AND REGULATIONS

The Contractor shall take sole responsibility for obtaining all necessary approvals and shall comply with all applicable local, state, and federal laws, regulations, and bylaws relevant to the implementation of the Project on the Property. This includes, but is not limited to, obtaining all approvals (i.e., permits, orders of conditions and certificates of compliance, variances, etc.) from the municipality in which the Project will take place.

COMMUNICATION AND REPORTING

- A. The Contractor is required to submit brief progress reports detailing the status of project tasks and deliverables. Additional reporting requirements may be outlined by the Department. The Contractor must comply with these progress report due dates, unless the Project is completed prior to the Contract's end date:

Progress Report	Period of Time	Submission Date by
#1	Contract Effective Date – December 31, 2026	January 15, 2027
#2	January 1, 2027 – April 30, 2027	May 15, 2027

- B. Upon request of the Department, the Contractor must submit a project impact report for program evaluation purposes within five (5) years of the contract end date. Failure to submit a project impact report may impact eligibility for future funding.
- C. The Contractor shall respond to all communications from the Department in a timely manner. If the Contractor determines that the Project cannot be completed due to unforeseen circumstances, the Contractor must notify the Department in writing within seventy-two (72) hours of the onset of such circumstances.
- D. Upon written request by the Department and with prior written approval, the Contractor shall display signage at the Project site indicating that the Project was funded in part by the Department. Any use of the Department's logo must be reviewed and approved by the Department and may require execution of a logo licensing agreement.

CHANGE MANAGEMENT

Any changes to the approved Project Scope must be submitted to the Department in writing in advance and may be approved if they meet the following criteria, in the Department's sole discretion:

1. The request is eligible within the RFR's guidelines.
2. The request does not include an item that was previously proposed in the application but explicitly not approved for funding;
3. The request does not include new items or activities that were not included in Attachment G or that fall outside the intent, scope, or objectives of the originally proposed Project; and
4. It is clear that the request can be accomplished within the time frame of the Contract and in accordance with the Contract requirements.

If the request meets the above criteria, a written change request must be submitted that includes the reason for the change and an updated budget. If approved, the Department will issue an amended contract, which must be signed by both parties prior to implementation.

The approved budget is an estimate based on the original proposal set forth in Attachment G. Reasonable variations within budget line items are allowable. Increases in one line item may be offset by savings in another, provided that the overall Project remains unchanged, the total reimbursement amount does not exceed the maximum obligation amount.

PAYMENT AND COMPENSATION

The Department shall reimburse the Contractor for the cost of approved equipment, materials, and associated labor necessary to complete the Project, as described in this Contract. The Contractor shall be responsible for any costs not approved or beyond the Department's maximum obligation or for any costs not approved under the terms of this Contract.

The Contractor shall be reimbursed for funds expended on this project. To receive reimbursement, the Contractor shall submit a written request ("Invoice") to the Department using the schedule below. If a project has not begun or no costs were incurred, the Contractor shall notify the Department in writing.

Contract Effective Date shall be the date the Department countersigns the Standard Contract Form. No prior expenses will be eligible for Payment.

Invoicing Schedule:

The Contractor may submit up to three (3) invoices, no more than once per expenditure period.

Invoice	Expenditure Period	Submission Date by
Invoice #1	Contract Effective Date – November 30, 2026	December 15, 2026
Invoice #2	December 1, 2026 – March 31, 2027	April 15, 2027
Invoice #3	April 1, 2027 – June 30, 2027	July 15, 2027

Required Documentation for Invoice Payment:

To receive reimbursement, the Contractor's submitted invoice must contain:

- Legal Name of the Contractor;
- Reference- FSIG Grant FY27'
- A Unique Invoice Number and Date Submitted;
- To and From period for which the expenses were incurred;
- The total amount being requested for reimbursement;
- Detail that clearly outlines the goods or services purchased;
- Itemized vendor or contractor invoices;

- Proof of payment, which may include canceled checks, bank statements, or other verifiable financial documentation;
- Photos of the goods or services purchased;
- Any additional supporting documentation as requested by the Department.

All expenses incurred shall show that the Contractor paid them. All transactions must be traceable through **formal, verifiable payment methods**, such as canceled checks, paid receipts etc. Additional documentation may be requested by the Department necessary to confirm payment of the expenses by the Contractor. Cash payments are not allowable for reimbursement purposes, as they cannot be adequately documented.

Payments are processed within a 45-day payment cycle through Electronic Funds Transfer (EFT), in accordance with the Standard Contract Form.

Financing Prohibited:

Equipment and vehicle purchases must be paid in full at the time of purchase. Financed purchases (e.g., loans, leases, or installment plans) are not eligible for reimbursement. The Contractor must retain full ownership of the equipment or vehicle in order to meet the completion and performance requirements of the Project.

Definition of Completed Project:

The Project is considered fully complete when all funded equipment and materials are delivered to the Contractor, on-site, installed (if applicable), and fully operational in accordance with the approved Scope. No final payment shall be issued until the Project reaches this state of completion. The Department reserves the right to conduct an inspection of the Project prior to making any payment.

Eligible and Ineligible Costs:

Only costs outlined in the Scope are eligible for reimbursement. Ineligible expenses as outlined in Attachment G must be removed prior to submission of any reimbursement request. The Department reserves the right to remove or deny reimbursement for any expenses deemed ineligible at its sole discretion.

ADDITIONAL PROJECT TERMS AND CONDITIONS

In addition to the Commonwealth's Terms & Conditions included as part of this Contract, the Contractor shall:

- Maintain the Project and its intended use for a minimum of five (5) years following Project completion. If the Project is discontinued because of a change of use of the Property, including but not limited to, the sale, lease, or transfer of the Property that includes the Project, or the sale, lease, or transfer of the whole or any part of the Project, or change of use of the Project in such a way that is inconsistent with this Contract, within five (5) years of the completion of the Project, the Contractor shall reimburse the Department for any and all payments received by the Contractor from the Department under this Contract.
- Permit representatives of the Department to enter the Property during the (5) five-year maintenance period to conduct field visits and surveys.
- The Contractor shall ensure compliance with all applicable federal, state, and local requirements, including but not limited to, statutes, regulations, bylaws, ordinances, or guidance for the duration of the Project and Contract.
- If the Contractor fails to satisfactorily perform all obligations of this Contract in the time period specified in this Contract, the Contractor agrees to return to the Department all funds received under this Contract.

ATTACHMENT B- APPROVED BUDGET

ESTIMATED BUDGET				
DESCRIPTION	COST	QUANTITY	TOTAL COST	MDAR CONTRIBUTION
Food Services Van	\$87,306	1	\$87,306	\$69,845
Cash Register Stand (BHS)	\$6,485	2	\$12,970	\$10,376
Cold Serving Counter (BHS)	\$14,204	1	\$14,204	\$11,363
Work Table, Stainless Steel (BHS)	\$1,156	1	\$1,156	\$925
Hot Serving Counters (BHS)	\$64,423	1	\$64,423	\$51,538
Condiment Counter (BHS)	\$13,659	1	\$13,659	\$10,927
Sneezeguards (BHS)	\$23,573	1	\$23,573	\$18,858
Gas Convection Oven (BHS)	\$12,648	2	\$25,296	\$20,237
Electric Convection Oven (BHS)	\$12,403	1	\$12,403	\$9,922
Open Display Merchandisers (BHS)	\$21,467	1	\$21,467	\$17,174
Planetary Mixer (BHS)	\$16,143	1	\$16,143	\$12,914
Mobile Heated Cabinet (BHS)	\$7,284	3	\$21,852	\$17,482
Electric Conveyor Oven (BHS)	\$19,038	1	\$19,038	\$15,230
Dishwasher (BHS)	\$111,241	1	\$111,241	\$88,993
Gas Convection Oven (Lincoln)	\$12,648	2	\$25,296	\$20,237
Electric Combi Oven (Lincoln)	\$31,267	1	\$31,267	\$25,014
Tilting Skillet (Lincoln)	\$27,938	1	\$27,938	\$22,350
36" Range, 6 French Hot Plates (Lincoln)	\$12,526	1	\$12,526	\$10,021
Hot Serving Counter (Lincoln)	\$11,987	1	\$11,987	\$9,590
Sneezeguards (Lincoln)	\$4,525	1	\$4,525	\$3,620
Open Display Merchandisers (Lincoln)	\$10,948	1	\$10,948	\$8,758
Mobile Heated Cabinet (Lincoln)	\$6,571	1	\$6,571	\$5,257
TOTAL			\$575,789	\$460,631

Please note that vehicle registration/title fees and documentation preparation are not reimbursable expenses



Food Security Infrastructure Grant (FSIG)

Fiscal Year 2027

(July 1, 2026 – June 30, 2027)

Request for Responses (RFR)

RFR File: AGR-FSIG-FY27

To support strategic capital investments that increase food security, improve resilience across the Commonwealth's food supply chain, and prioritize increased food security for underserved and under-resourced communities.

Application Deadline

Responses must be received no later than
4:00 PM, Monday, May 4, 2026

Submission Instructions

All proposals must be submitted online as listed in Section 4:

www.mass.gov/ApplytoFSIG

Contact Information

Program Contact: Holly Velleca

Email: FSIGGrant@mass.gov



GRANT OPPORTUNITY

FOOD SECURITY INFRASTRUCTURE GRANT

Executive Office of Energy & Environmental Affairs
 Rebecca L. Tepper, Secretary
 RFR ID: AGR-FSIG-FY27

Proposals Sought For	The Massachusetts Department of Agricultural Resources ("MDAR" or "Department") invites responses from eligible applicants for participation in the Food Security Infrastructure Grant ("FSIG" or "Program"). For this grant round, the Program will prioritize capital infrastructure and equipment projects that strengthen the Commonwealth's food supply chain while increasing access and affordability of nutritious, healthy, and preferably locally grown, raised, harvested, and caught foods for underserved and under-resourced communities. Projects that demonstrate measurable improvements that support food security for residents of the Commonwealth will be prioritized in FY27. Food security is defined by the United Nations Food and Agriculture Organization as a condition in which all people, at all times, have physical, social, and economic access to sufficient, safe, and nutritious food that meets their dietary needs and food preferences for an active and healthy life.
Overview & Goals	The Program supports projects that strengthen the Commonwealth's food supply chain and expand equitable access to nutritious, health, and preferably locally grown, raised, harvested, and caught foods for Massachusetts residents. The program can fund infrastructure projects that increase local food production and consumption, enhance mid-supply chain capacity for processing, storage, and distribution for local markets, and build ensure a more safe, resilient and accessible food supply, especially during periods of widespread food insecurity and supply chain disruptions.
Eligible Applicants	Eligible applicants must be located and operating in Massachusetts, have been in operation for at least three (3) consecutive years, and operate or support a commercial or noncommercial food operation that contributes to the Commonwealth's food system and serves Massachusetts residents. (See Section 2A)
Eligible Projects	Projects must be capital improvements that create durable, functional infrastructure supporting production, processing, aggregation, storage, distribution, access, or resilience/emergency preparedness. Applicants must select one primary project type. (See Section 2B)
Application Deadline	Applications must be received by 4:00pm on Monday, May 4, 2026 via the online portal. (see Section 4A)
Funding Availability	Depending on available funding, selected participants may receive an award ranging from \$10,000 to \$500,000 on a reimbursement basis, subject to Department approval. Applicants must choose to apply for a Simplified Project grant (requests ranging from \$10,000 - \$150,000) or Standard Project grant (requests ranging from \$151,000 - \$500,000). (see Section 3B)
Match Requirement	Participants are required to provide a minimum 20% cash match of eligible project costs. (See Section 3D)
Duration of Contract	The contract end date is June 30, 2027, with no options for extensions.
Contact Information	Holly Velleca Email: FSIGgrant@mass.gov

DEFINITIONS

Agricultural Business: A business, cooperative, nonprofit, municipal, Tribal government or entity, Native-led non-profit, or other entity engaged in the growing, raising, cultivating, harvesting, marketing, storing, processing, or distribution of agricultural, aquacultural, horticultural, or livestock products within the Commonwealth. Activities that constitute “farming” and “agriculture” are interpreted consistent with M.G.L. c. 128, § 1A. No commercial profit objective is required.

Applicant: A business, municipality, state agency, Tribal government, nonprofit, or organization submitting a proposal to the Department. Where the Applicant does not own the property associated with a proposed project, the term includes any co-applicant landowner(s), as applicable.

Capital Improvement / Capital Project / Capital Expenditure: A non-recurring investment in land, buildings, infrastructure, technology, systems, or durable equipment that improves, creates, or extends the capacity, safety, or efficiency of agricultural or food system operations and has an expected useful life of at least five (5) years. Capital improvements do not include routine operating costs, maintenance, consumables, repairs, or short-term equipment. Land acquisition is not eligible unless expressly permitted by the Program.

Commercial Food Entity: A for-profit entity engaged in the production, processing, distribution, sale, or service of food, including farming, fishing, food manufacturing, wholesaling, retail, or food service, where food-related activities are conducted primarily for commercial sale or revenue generation. The primary purpose of commercial entities is to sell food to earn income.

Department: The Massachusetts Department of Agricultural Resources (MDAR).

Direct-to-Consumer: Refers to a market channel in which producers sell food or agricultural products directly to individual consumers without intermediaries. Examples include farmers markets, farm stands, CSAs (Community Supported Agriculture), and/or on-farm pick-up.

Eligible Expenditures: Project costs that meet the definition of a Capital Improvement, are directly tied to the Department-approved Scope of Services and Budget, and are incurred and paid within the active contract period.

Emergency Food Provider: A nonprofit or public organization that offers free food assistance to people in crisis such as low-income, unemployed, or disaster-affected individuals, acting as a critical part of the nutrition safety net. Examples include food pantries, food banks, soup kitchens, and/or other community-based organizations

Farmer / Farm Operator: An individual who owns or exercises legal authority to make operational decisions for an agricultural business or commercial agricultural business engaged in activities defined in M.G.L. c. 128, § 1A.

Food Enterprise: A commercial, nonprofit, cooperative, municipal, Tribal, or institutional entity that grows, harvests, manufactures, aggregates, stores, processes, distributes, retails, or provides food products or services. Food enterprises may include agricultural producers, fisheries, food hubs, processors, distributors, or market access organizations.

Food Hub: Local or regional organizations that aggregate, distribute, and market food from local and small-to-mid-sized farmers, connecting them to larger markets such as schools, nonprofits, grocery stores, and restaurants while supporting local economies and community access to fresh, local food.

Food Security: A condition in which all people, at all times, have physical, social, and economic access to sufficient, safe, and nutritious food that meets their dietary needs and food preferences for an active and healthy life-

Gross Income: The total revenue earned by a business or organization from the sale of goods or services before deducting expenses such as labor, materials, overhead, taxes, or any other operating costs.

Institution: A large, formally-established organization designed to fulfill a specific social function through structured rules, roles, and authority. More broadly, institutions are enduring systems that provide stability and order in a society. Examples include schools, hospitals, correctional facilities, and/or early childhood education centers.

Legal Site Control: The documented right to use property through ownership, recorded deed, lease, license, or other legally binding agreement that expressly authorizes the proposed project activities for the full contract duration and any applicable retention or covenant periods. Site control must authorize construction, installation, and use of infrastructure or equipment funded under the Program.

Local Food: For this Program, local food is defined as edible food products primarily grown, raised, harvested, or wild caught within the Commonwealth.

Local Food System: For this Program, the local food system refers to the interconnected network of people, businesses, and organizations involved in producing, processing, distributing, selling, and providing food, including food assistance and donation within the New England region.

Markets: Refers to the institutions, channels, and infrastructure through which food and agricultural products are sold, purchased, and accessed by consumers and buyers. This includes outlets and systems that connect products from the mid-supply chain to end users.

Match / Cash Match: The portion of eligible project costs paid by the Applicant in cash, not funded by the Department and not sourced from other state or federal grants. In-kind contributions, owner labor, donated materials, or other non-cash resources do not qualify as match unless expressly permitted by the Program.

Mid-Supply Chain: Refers to the infrastructure, facilities, and distribution channels which connect food production to end consumers by aggregating, processing, storing, and/or distributing products. Examples include value-added processing, cold/frozen storage units, coolers and regional aggregation hubs, loading docks, technology systems for product tracking/food safety, and/or equipment for meat, seafood, or dairy processing/labeling

Noncommercial Food Entity: A nonprofit, governmental, Tribal government or entity, Native-led nonprofit, or community-based organization engaged in food-related activities primarily for charitable, educational, public service, or subsistence purposes rather than for profit. Examples include food banks and pantries, nonprofits farms, schools, health care institutions, and correctional facilities. The primary purpose of noncommercial food entities is to serve the public or a community need.

Production: Refers to the systems, infrastructure, and activities involved in growing, raising, harvesting, and preparing food and agricultural or seafood products. Its investments include season-extension and climate adaptation structures, on-farm or on-vessel improvements for safety and efficiency, and/or facility construction and upgrades.

Scope of Services (Scope & Budget): The contract document defines allowable activities, deliverables, expenditures, infrastructure and equipment, budget, and timeline under the Program.

Simplified Project: A Simplified Project is a project that involves smaller equipment purchases that may include minor contractor services (no more than 20% of the total project budget) necessary to make the equipment operational, such as installation and/or electrical work. The minimum request is \$10,000 and the maximum request is \$150,000.

Standard Project: For the purpose of this grant, a Standard Project is a project that involves major construction or facility improvements, and/or larger equipment purchases. The minimum request is \$151,000 and the maximum request is \$500,000.

Underserved or under-resourced: Communities or populations that face persistent barriers to accessing sufficient, affordable, nutritious, and culturally appropriate food due to limited financial, infrastructural, geographical, or institutional resources, as well as constraints related to food availability, distribution, transportation, or local food systems capacity.

1. INTRODUCTION

MDAR is pleased to announce the opening of the application period for the Program. The Program supports capital projects that strengthen the Commonwealth's food security and improves access to affordable, nutritious, and locally grown, raised, harvested, and caught foods.

The Program prioritizes investments that increase food system resilience, strengthen supply chain capacity, and improve food access, particularly in underserved and under-resourced communities that face barriers to obtaining affordable, nutritious food. It invests in durable infrastructure that supports a more secure, equitable, and reliable food system across Massachusetts, including during periods of supply chain disruption or emergency.

For FY27, the Program will prioritize projects that seek to achieve the following:

- (1) increase the supply or availability of affordable, nutritious, and/or locally produced foods for underserved and under-resourced Massachusetts communities;
- (2) address food supply system vulnerabilities that could lead to shortages during extreme weather events or other disruptions; and
- (3) expand capacity for aggregation, processing, manufacturing, and/or distribution of locally grown, raised, or caught foods to Massachusetts consumers.

Funding is subject to appropriation and awarded at the discretion of the Department.

2. ELIGIBILITY

A. Applicants

A1. Eligible Applicants

Eligible applicants must:

- Be located and operating within the Commonwealth of Massachusetts;
- Have been in operation for a minimum of three (3) consecutive years at the time of the application deadline; and
- Operate or support a commercial or noncommercial food enterprise that contributes to the Commonwealth's food system and serves Massachusetts residents.

Eligible applicants may include, but are not limited to:

- Agricultural operations as defined in M.G.L. c. 128, § 1A;
- Seafood and aquaculture businesses, including commercial fishermen, seafood dealers, and processors as defined in M.G.L. c. 130;
- Food hubs, aggregators, processors, and distributors;
- Food access and emergency food organizations, including food banks, pantries, and food recovery organizations;
- Schools, early childhood education centers, colleges and universities, healthcare facilities, and other institutions that procure, prepare, or serve food;
- Food retail and market access organizations, including grocery stores, and farmer's markets;
- Municipalities, public entities, and Tribal government or entity, Native-led non-profit.

This list provides examples and does not include every type of eligible applicant. The Department will determine eligibility based on the applicant's demonstrated role in the Commonwealth's food system. If an applicant believes they are eligible it is recommended they submit a proposal as MDAR cannot pre-determine the eligibility of potential applicants.

A2. Ineligible Applicants

The following applicants are not eligible to participate in FSIG Program:

- Applicants that do not contribute to the Commonwealth's food system or food supply chain.
- Applicants that do not maintain a principal place of business within the Commonwealth of Massachusetts.
- Applicants that have been in operation for fewer than three (3) years at the time of application deadline.
- Applicants that are not engaged in activities that support food production, processing, aggregation, distribution, retail access, or food access services benefiting Massachusetts residents.
- Entities with a current FSIG contract which will not be completed prior to the application submission date.
- Entities and/or individuals that own multiple businesses cannot submit applications for each business.
- Applications for projects that are currently being funded through another state or federal grant program, whether in whole or in part.

A3. Size of Operation

There is no minimum acreage or gross income requirement under the Program.

A4. Property Ownership or Lease

If the proposed project is located on property not owned by the applicant, a written lease agreement must provide a long-term, legal right to use the property for the project and contract duration. This typically requires a lease term of no fewer than five (5) years from the date of submission. The lease must expressly authorize the construction, installation, or operation of the proposed improvements. The Department may request a copy of the lease agreement.

A5. Previous Applicants

Proposals from applicants or entities previously funded through the Program are eligible to apply, **provided that all prior FSIG funded projects have been fully completed and all required reporting has been submitted and approved by the Department and all final reimbursement have been made.** The Department may require returning applicants to submit documentation demonstrating completion, outcomes, and benefits of any previously funded FSIG project as part of its review of any application under the Program.

A6. Agricultural Preservation Restriction (APR) Properties

Before applying to this Program, applicants who own Agricultural Preservation Restriction ("APR") land must consult with the APR Program to determine whether requirements apply to the proposed project under the terms of their APR. Applicants must be in compliance with the terms of their APR or must resolve any outstanding compliance or legal issues with the Department prior to submitting a proposal. Applicants must obtain, or be in the advanced stages of obtaining, all required approvals under their APR before a contract may be executed.

A7. Produce Farm Registration

All produce operations submitting responses under this RFR are subject to registration under the Produce Safety & Market Access regulation as set forth in 330 CMR 34.00, regardless of whether the farm is classified as a Covered Farm or a Non-Covered Farm as defined in the regulation. Registration will be required as a condition of funding under any contract issued through this Program. For more information on MDAR's Produce Safety Program, visit: www.mass.gov/produce-safety-program.

A8. Environmental Justice

For the purposes of this RFR, "Environmental Justice" includes the equal protection and meaningful involvement of all people and communities in the development, implementation, and enforcement of energy, climate change, and environmental laws, regulations, and policies, as well as the equitable distribution of environmental and energy benefits and burdens. MDAR is committed to Environmental Justice and, in doing so, we are working to ensure communities across the state have the capacity to advance environmental, energy, and food justice, engage in meaningful ways, and help shape policies and programs with equity at the center. Through our programs and services, we aim to support applicants working directly with communities most impacted by environmental, energy, and food injustice, and the disproportionate impacts of climate change.

For more information, please refer to [EEA's Environmental Justice Program Webpage](#).

A9. Legal Compliance

Eligible applicants must demonstrate compliance with all applicable federal, state, and local requirements, including, but not limited to, statutes, regulations, bylaws, and ordinances in effect at the time of application and throughout the duration of the project. Applicants are responsible for obtaining, maintaining, and complying with any applicable license, permit, approval, or authorization required by law for the proposed project. The Department may request proof of such licensure, permitting, approvals, or other permissions at any time during the RFR process or contract period.

All records submitted to the Department under this RFR are subject to the Massachusetts Public Records Law, M.G.L. c. 66, § 10, and may be disclosed unless exempt under M.G.L. c. 4, § 7(26).

B. Projects

B1. Eligible Project Types/Areas

Eligible projects must be capital improvement investments, including the purchase of new equipment and, where necessary, contracted labor for installation or construction, that strengthen the Commonwealth's food supply chain and improve equitable access to nutritious and preferably locally grown, raised, harvested, and caught foods.

Eligible projects must result in durable, functional infrastructure that supports food production, processing, aggregation, storage, distribution, or access. Projects must fall primarily within one of the project types listed below. **Applicants must select one primary project type when applying.**

The table below describes the eligible project types and provides examples of the kinds of infrastructure and equipment that may be supported. Projects may range in scale from smaller equipment-focused investments to larger, more complex facility or system improvements. Funding ranges, project tracks, and documentation requirements based on project scale are described in Section 3 (Budget Guidelines & Grant Levels) and Section 4 (Application Instructions).

The examples listed are illustrative and not exhaustive. MDAR encourages innovative proposals, provided the project is consistent with the purpose of the Program and meets all eligibility requirements.

Project Type	Description	Examples
Expansion of Agriculture or Seafood Production	Supports farms, fisheries, aquaculture, and community-based food production to expand or enhance local food output and supply for Massachusetts residents.	• On-farm or on-vessel equipment • Season extension or climate adaptation structures (greenhouses, high tunnels, shade systems) which enhance resilience • Livestock and poultry biosecurity improvements • Aquaculture or mariculture systems • Slaughter or processing facility upgrades • Infrastructure supporting community or urban farming for projects over \$50,000 (projects under this amount should refer to MDAR's Urban Agriculture Program). • Infrastructure supporting culturally relevant food production
Local and Regional Mid-Supply Chain Expansion	Develops mid-supply chain capacity that connects local producers to Massachusetts consumers and institutions and supports food system resilience.	• Value-added processing and packaging facilities • Cold or frozen storage, coolers, or aggregation hubs • Shared-use cold chain facilities • Loading docks and staging areas • Food distribution vehicles • Product tracking and inventory systems • Meat, seafood, or dairy processing equipment
Noncommercial Food Access & Availability Infrastructure	Develop or enhance programs that increase the consumption of healthy, nutritious, and preferable local food at a free or reduced costs. This includes emergency food assistance providers, food delivery services, and institutions providing vulnerable and low-access populations such as early childhood centers, schools, elder care facilities, hospitals, and correction facilities.	• Refrigeration and cold storage • commercial kitchen upgrades • Receiving, storage, and prep infrastructure • Food recovery and redistribution equipment • Facility upgrades to expand meal production

Commercial Food Access & Availability Infrastructure	Develop or enhance programs that increase the consumption of locally grown, raised or harvested food through retail outlets at market rates. This includes farm stands, farm stores, CSAs, online retail, and small to mid-size grocery stores. However, projects under \$150,000 should be directed to MDAR's Food Ventures Program .	• Refrigeration and cold storage • Retail display and handling equipment • Commercial kitchen or prep space upgrades • Facility improvements for farm stands, CSAs, farm stores, and small grocery
Food System Resilience & Emergency Preparedness	(For municipalities and Tribal entities, or collaborative and/or public-private partnerships) Increases resilience of local food systems against disruptions such as power loss, climate events, or supply chain shocks. (see ResilientMass Plan for more information)	• Backup power systems • Flood or storm adaptation infrastructure • Port or coastal infrastructure • Shared community storage or distribution hubs for emergency use

B2. Eligible Expenditures

Eligible expenditures must support capital improvements that strengthen the Commonwealth's food supply chain and expand equitable access to local food, including facilities, equipment, or systems that improve food production, processing, storage, or distribution. See examples in the project types table under B1.

B3. Ineligible Expenditures

Operational Costs

- **Routine Operating Expenses:** Day-to-day operating costs such as fuel, utilities, supplies, or other recurring expenses necessary for normal business or organizational activities.
- **Operational Salaries:** Salaries or wages for ongoing work related to operations, including non-labor costs (management) and fees for project oversight, consultations, and administration.
- **Labor Performed by the Applicant or Organization:** Labor performed by the applicant, its owners, employees, family members, affiliates, or any business in which the applicant holds an interest in completing the proposed project.
- **Proposals for Establishing a New Organization/Business:** Proposals related to the establishment of a new organization or business.

Maintenance and Equipment

- **Routine Maintenance and Repairs:** Costs for ongoing maintenance, repairs, or replacements that do not represent a capital improvement.
- **Short-Term or Non-Durable Equipment:** Expenditures for equipment with a short lifespan or non-capital nature, such as disposable goods, packaging materials, or consumables.
- **Used Equipment & Materials:** Costs associated with purchasing used, refurbished, or reconditioned equipment or materials.

Ineligible Operational or Program Costs

- **Non-Program Infrastructure:** Infrastructure not directly related to the applicant's mission or food system operations (e.g., recreational, residential, or other non-production spaces).
- **Marketing or Promotional Materials:** Costs related to advertising, marketing campaigns, branding, signage, or promotional events, including vehicle graphics.
- **Planning or Feasibility Studies:** Costs for feasibility analyses, audits, or other studies that do not result in tangible capital improvements.
- **Subscription-Based Services:** Costs for ongoing or recurring fees such as software subscriptions, digital services, or cloud-based tools.
- **Extended Warranties:** Costs associated with extended warranties or service plans beyond the standard manufacturer coverage.
- **Office or Administrative Equipment:** General business equipment such as office furniture, computers, or electronics not directly tied to project infrastructure.
- **Vehicles:** Vehicles not intended for food distribution. Registration, inspection, and licensing fees are also ineligible.
- **Food Purchases:** Costs for purchasing food or food products for resale, donation, or consumption.
- **Seed Purchases:** Costs for purchasing seeds, including aquaculture seed.
- **Administrative and Management Expenses:** Costs and fees associated with project oversight, consultations, and administrative costs.

Financial and Legal Costs

- **Interest on Loans or Financing Fees:** Interest payments or any fees related to securing loans, financing, or credit.
- **Land Acquisition or Lease Payments:** Funding cannot be used for purchasing land or paying for ongoing lease payments.
- **Permitting or Approval Fees:** Costs of obtaining permits, licenses, or approvals required for the project.
- **Pre-Existing Work or Purchases:** Costs for work started, equipment purchased, or construction completed before a fully executed contract is in place with the Department.
- **Deposits:** Deposits are not eligible for reimbursement if they are outside of the contract start date.
- **Legal Fees:** Costs related to legal representation, contract review, or other legal services.
- **Tariffs:** Costs associated with tariffs, customs duties, or fees imposed on imported or exported goods.

Miscellaneous

- **Urban Agriculture Projects requesting \$50,000 or less,** which may otherwise be eligible for funding under MDAR's [Urban Agriculture Program](#).
- **Food Venture Projects requesting \$150,000 or less:** Commercial projects related to improving economic opportunities in low- to moderate-income communities and increasing access to healthy, affordable food, which may otherwise be eligible to apply for funding under [MDAR's Food Ventures Program](#).

Eligibility and Compliance

- **Non-Compliance and Ineligibility Costs:** Costs associated with proposals from applicants whose operation is out of compliance with any laws or regulations, or proposals from applicants that do not meet eligibility requirements listed in Section 2A. Compliance is required at the time of application and throughout the duration of any award. Failure to maintain compliance may result in the loss of funding.
- **Energy Efficiency and Renewable Energy Projects on Farms:** Projects such as solar photovoltaics, wind, or geothermal systems on farms are not eligible for FSIG.

3. FUNDING & BUDGET GUIDELINES

3A. Funding Availability / Maximum Funding

Reimbursement grants from \$10,000 up to \$500,000 will be awarded competitively.

3B. Budget Guidelines & Grant Levels

Proposals must include an adequate budget for the proposed project, including the total project cost, the applicant's cash match, and the total funding request. Use of grant funds is limited to costs identified in the approved budget. The total project cost may not include any ineligible expenses as listed in Section B3.

Funding requests may be for components of a larger project; however, applicants must demonstrate financial sustainability and that the proposed request will result in a complete, functional, and operable system.

Project Tracks:

The FSIG Program supports projects of different scales and complexity under two project tracks based on **total funding request**:

Simplified Project Track (requests ranging from \$10,000–\$150,000):

For smaller-scale or lower-complexity capital projects, including equipment, systems, or limited infrastructure improvements that do not require extensive construction or technical documentation.

Standard Project Track (requests ranging from \$151,000–\$500,000):

For larger-scale or higher-complexity capital projects, including major equipment systems and/or substantial facility or infrastructure improvements that require more extensive planning, coordination, or technical documentation.

Applicants must select the appropriate project track based on the total scope and cost of the proposed project. Documentation requirements by project track are described in Section 4B.

3C. Appropriation

All contracts shall be subject to available funding, whether through the appropriation and authorization of sufficient funds or the receipt of sufficient revenues. If available funding ceases for any reason, a contract shall be deemed under suspension and contract performance must halt. A contractor will not be entitled to compensation for any performance provided during the period of contract suspension. The Department may lift the suspension if available funding is received. In the absence of foreseeable available funding, the Department may terminate the contract.

3D. Match Requirement

Participants are required to contribute a minimum of 20% cash-match to the total eligible project costs. MDAR will not fund more than 80% of the total eligible project cost, up to a maximum award of \$500,000. The applicant's cash match and the FSIG request must together equal the total eligible project cost.

All matching funds must be in cash; in-kind contributions, including but not limited to owner or employee labor, donated materials, or expenditures incurred prior to the execution of the grant agreement, shall not be accepted as an eligible match. Matching funds may not originate from other state or federal grant programs or funding source already awarded or anticipated.

3E. Multiple Program Applications

Applicants may submit proposals to more than one Department grant program within the same fiscal year; however, the Department will not issue funding from multiple programs for the same or substantially similar project activities. If an applicant applies to multiple department programs for the same project, the Department reserves the right, at its sole discretion, to determine under which program, if any, the project will be funded. The Department's determination shall be final and binding. The Department cannot, however, take an application from one program and fund it through a different program to which the applicant did not already separately apply.

Applicants should carefully consider whether their proposed project is best aligned with FSIG or another MDAR grant program. Projects focused primarily on farm business viability, on-farm improvements, or on-farm energy and climate-related investments may be more appropriately suited to other MDAR programs, including the Farm Viability Enhancement Program (FVEP), APR Improvement Program (AIP), Stewardship Assistance and Restoration on APRs (SARA), the Matching Enterprise Grants for Agriculture (MEGA) Program, and the Climate Smart Agriculture Program (CSAP). Applicants are encouraged to review program purposes and eligibility requirements before applying.

4. APPLICATION INSTRUCTIONS & EVALUATION

4A. Application Submission Instructions

Applicants must complete and submit all required materials as outlined below.

Applications must be submitted through the online application available at: www.mass.gov/ApplytoFSIG. All attachments must be in **Word or PDF formats**. Submissions exceeding **25 MB** will not be accepted

This RFR does not allow for the submission of hard copy or emails of the application, including attachments.

Incomplete or late applications will not be considered.

Applicants may submit questions regarding this RFR and application process. Questions must be submitted by email to FSIGGrant@mass.gov.

The deadline for questions is 4:00PM on Monday April 20th, 2026. All questions and answers will be posted at www.mass.gov/ApplytoFSIG so that all applicants can review.

Submission Deadline:

Applications must be **received by 4:00 PM, Monday, May 4, 2026**. Late submissions, including those delayed by technical issues, will not be accepted.

Important Notes

- Applicants are strongly encouraged to retain a copy of their entire submission.
- All applicants/Bidders are advised to allow adequate time for submission of their proposal by considering delays online impediments like Internet traffic, internet connection speed, file size, and file volume.
- The Department is not responsible for delays encountered by Bidders or their agents, or for a Bidder's local hardware failures, such as computers or related networks, associated with bid compilation or submission.

4B. Supporting Documentation

Applicants must submit the supporting documentation listed below based on the project track under which they are applying.

Document	Simplified Project (\$10,000 - \$150,000)	Standard Project (\$151,000 - \$500,000)	Description or Instructions
Budget	Required	Required	Template is provided (Attachment B). The budget should include all project costs, the applicant's cash match, and the total amount requested from the program. Failure to submit a complete budget will result in the application being ineligible.
Quotes	Required	Required	Applicants must submit two (2) quotes for each expenditure/line item in the budget that costs \$50,000 or more. Applicants must submit one (1) quote for each expenditure/line item in the budget that costs less than \$50,000. Quotes should be from qualified vendors or contractors and reflect accurate cost estimates. Failure to submit quotes will result in the application being ineligible.
Demonstration of Project Need and Feasibility	Recommended	Required	May include organizational planning and feasibility documents created or updated within the last three (3) years that demonstrate the applicant's operational readiness and strategic direction. Examples include a business plan, strategic plan, or SWOT analysis, as well as a project feasibility study, market analysis, or a recent report identifying a gap within the food system. Applicants may submit one (1) to three (3) documents for this category.
Demonstration of Project Benefit to Underserved and Under-Resourced Communities	Optional	Recommended	May include letters of commitment or MOUs from partners demonstrating planned and specific food security impacts, and/or supporting documentation that provides contextual or descriptive evidence of need and feasibility (e.g., demographic data of the clientele or service area, participant or beneficiary information, SNAP sales data, a list of partners, or a

			project plan). Applicants may submit one (1) to three (3) documents for this category.
Letters of Support	Optional	Recommended	Non-binding letters of support from partners, community organizations, or stakeholders demonstrating community benefit, endorsement, or alignment with the project's goals without committing specific resources or actions. Applicants may submit one (1) to three (3) documents for this category.
Letter of Match	Optional	Recommended	A signed letter from an authorized signatory confirming the applicant's cash match commitment and identifying the funding source(s).

4C. Additional Contract Documentation

If selected, the applicant will be required to submit the following forms to complete the contract:

- Commonwealth Standard Contract Form with Commonwealth Terms & Conditions
- Completed Contractor Authorized Signature Verification Form
- Completed Commonwealth W-9 tax information form
- Completed Electronic Funds Transfer Form

These forms do not need to be completed as part of the response. Assistance to complete these forms will be provided to Respondents selected to participate in the Program. These forms are available for review at www.mass.gov/osd or by request.

4D. Review Process / Evaluation Timeline

The Department cannot assist in the preparation of grant applications. In order to maintain integrity of the competitive grant process, the Department is unable to advise and/or provide individuals with any information regarding specific applications during the solicitation process. Scoring will be performed by a grant review committee led by the Department and which may include staff from other state agencies with relevant knowledge and oversight of the proposals' subject matter.

There will be three steps of review following the grant application period.

Step I: Applications will be reviewed for completeness, eligibility, and compliance with the requirements of this RFR. Applications that are incomplete, ineligible, or otherwise not in compliance with the requirements of this RFR will not advance to further review.

Step II: Applications that pass the administrative and eligibility review will be evaluated and scored based on the Evaluation Criteria in Section 4E.

Step III: All projects which are favorably reviewed may require a site visit prior to final award determinations being made. A favorable initial evaluation and field visit DOES NOT guarantee funding for a proposed project. The purposes of the site visit are as follows:

- To verify the information presented in the proposal;

- To view operation and assess the project request;
- To determine the appropriateness of the practice proposed;
- To confirm the ability to implement and maintain the practice;
- To explore other items deemed necessary; and
- To develop a basis for future 'before and after' comparisons.

The Department staff may modify the scope of the proposed project to more effectively achieve program goals. The Department may request additional project information.

Final recommendations will be conveyed to the Commissioner of Agricultural Resources and the Secretary of the Executive Office of Energy and Environmental Affairs for final decisions. All acceptances shall be conditional upon the availability of funding. Once the review period has ended and award decisions are finalized, applicants will be notified via the primary email address listed on the application if they were selected for funding or not.

4E. Evaluation Criteria

Each eligible response will be reviewed and receive a point score based on the assigned values to Very Good, Good, Fair, Poor, and No Evidence as defined.

Very Good - The application is specified and comprehensive. There is complete, detailed, and clearly articulated information as to how the criteria are met. The ideas presented are innovative, well-conceived, and thoroughly developed.

Good - The application is reasonably comprehensive and includes sufficient detail. It contains many of the characteristics of a response that is very good even though it may require additional specificity, support, or elaboration in places.

Fair - The application is non-specific, and lacks focus and detail. The response addresses some of the selection criteria, but not all. Some ideas presented are sound, but others are not responsive to the purpose of the grant. Additional information is needed in order to be reasonably comprehensive and meet the criteria of a response that is good.

Poor - The application does not meet many criteria; provides inaccurate information or provides information that requires substantial clarification as to how the criteria are met; lacks meaningful detail; demonstrates lack of preparation; or otherwise raises substantial concerns about the applicant's understanding of the issue in concept and/or ability to meet the requirement in practice.

No Evidence - The application does not address the criteria or simply re-states the criteria.

Proposals will be evaluated based on the criteria listed below. The evaluation will assess the proposal's alignment with program goals, feasibility, budget, and anticipated outcomes.

1. Project Need & Alignment – 30%

The extent to which the applicant clearly describes the organization/operation, identifies the problem or capacity gap the project addresses, and explains why the proposed project is the right solution. Applications should show clear alignment between the proposed project and the selected project type in Section B1 and describe who will benefit from the project.

If applicable, the extent to which the applicant describes how the project is incorporating, or will allow, multi-sector collaborations/partnerships, and how the collaborations/partnerships will strengthen the Massachusetts food system.

Additional consideration will be given to applicants that have not previously received FSIG funding.

2. Food Security Outcomes & Impacts – 35%

Applicant clearly identifies 2-5 expected performance impacts (see Attachment C) that best align with the proposed project. Applicant describes how the project will achieve each expected outcome measure within 1-3 years of project completion and provide realistic, project appropriate estimated metrics expressed as whole numbers. Reasonable estimates may be used when baseline data is unavailable.

Extent to which the applicant demonstrates how the project will increase equitable access to nutritious—preferably local and culturally relevant—food for **under-resourced and underserved residents of the Commonwealth**. For the purposes of this Program, under-resourced and underserved refers to communities or populations that face persistent barriers to accessing sufficient, affordable, nutritious, and culturally appropriate food due to limited financial, infrastructural, geographical, or institutional resources, as well as constraints related to food availability, distribution, transportation, or local food system capacity. Applicants are strongly encouraged to review community-level data and research, which may include, but are not limited, to:

- [Food Bank Coalition of MA Impact Report: FY24](#)
- [SNAP Clients by Municipality in Massachusetts](#)
- [The Cost of Hunger in Massachusetts](#)
- [MA Community Health Assessment & Data on Social Determinants of Health](#)
- [Medicaid Nutrition Supports Lower Hospital and ER Visits](#)
- [The Impact of Recent SNAP Policy Changes](#)
- [Climate Change, Global Food Security, and the U.S. Food System](#)
- [Understanding the Intersection of Climate Risk, Food System Resilience, and Racial Equity](#)
- [Policy Basics: The Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program](#)
- [USDA Food Access Research Atlas](#)
- [SNAP: Estimated Eligibility and Receipt among Food Insecure College Students](#)
- [Environmental Justice and Social Determinants of Health | Mass.gov](#)
- **Health Impact Assessment** is a tool to identify potential health impacts and benefits of a proposed project, program, or policy decision and recommend strategies that best protect and promote health. [Health Impact Assessment | Mass.gov](#)
- [MassGIS Data Hub](#) to find, map and download GIS open data for the Commonwealth of Massachusetts
- [SDOH Screening Tools - Environmental Justice - Resource Guides at University of Massachusetts Medical School](#)

To receive full consideration, applicant should:

- Reference relevant community-level data to document need.
- Describe key characteristics of the population served (e.g., income, socioeconomic conditions, food access, English isolation).
- Explain the geographic relationship between the community served and the project site.
- Describe how the project will reach the intended population(s) and provide evidence of that pathway (e.g., distribution plans, partner commitments, service area descriptions, procurement agreements, or program participation data).
- Demonstrate meaningful support from or participation by the intended population(s) (e.g., letters of support, community partnerships).
- Where applicable, describe direct benefits to farmers, ranchers, or small businesses within the food supply chain that face barriers to market access.

Applicants could also share if their organization or business itself will have any direct benefits for groups such as [historically underserved farmers and/or ranchers](#) and middle-of-the-supply chain small businesses owned by [socially disadvantaged individuals](#) (as defined by the Small Business Administration). Please provide information about any barriers you have faced accessing funding if applicable.

If applicable, applicants may describe how the project incorporates resilience measures (e.g., backup power, flood protection, waste reduction) that protect food access during disruptions. If the project aligns with any of the objectives outlined in [ResilientMass](#), please demonstrate.

3. Feasibility – 15%

The extent to which the project scope, budget, timeline, and implementation plan are realistic and achievable within the grant period. Applications should demonstrate readiness to implement (including permits if applicable), capacity to manage the project, and financial ability to cover upfront costs and the required match. Quotes and supporting documentation should be consistent with the proposed budget and scope.

4. Sustainability & Maintenance – 10%

The extent to which the applicant demonstrates that the investment will be maintained and continue to provide benefits beyond the contract period. Applications should describe who will maintain the equipment/infrastructure, how ongoing costs will be covered, and how benefits (food access, distribution, or resilience outcomes) will be sustained over time.

5. Overall Compatibility – 10%

Reviewers will consider the applicant's overall operations alongside the proposed project details, including whether the project's benefits are proportional to the amount requested relative to the organization's size and budget. They will consider how well the proposed project aligns with the FY27 RFR priorities (improving food access for under-resourced and underserved communities, enhancing resilience to disruptions, or expanding mid-supply chain capacity for local foods). Letters of support from community members or partners will also be considered. For applicants who received previous FSIG funding, reviewers will take past project outcomes and impact into account.

5. PROJECT TERMS & COMPLIANCE

5A. Contract Terms

If awarded, all projects will be required to execute and comply with the standard Commonwealth of Massachusetts Terms and Conditions. All final contracts are subject to successful negotiation of a final Scope of Services and Budget. No project may commence until a contract has been fully executed by the Department and the award recipient.

The Department does not guarantee that any contract will result from this RFR or that any particular funding level will be awarded. MDAR reserves the right to offer an award amount different from the

amount requested and may fund only a portion of a proposed project if such funding is determined to be in the best interest of the Commonwealth.

The Department reserves the right to negotiate the project scope, budget, and award amount prior to entering into a contract.

All projects funded under this Program must be maintained by the applicant for the duration specified in the contract. Projects and rights under any contract may not be assigned or transferred. If a funded project is sold or discontinued during the contract term, the Department may require repayment of grant funds, as specified in the contract.

The Department reserves the right to interpret, clarify, modify, or supplement the terms and conditions of this RFR and any resulting contract to ensure proper administration of the Program and compliance with applicable state and federal requirements. All determinations made by the Department, including but not limited to eligibility, allowable expenditures, compliance actions, and award amounts, shall be final and binding.

5B. Duration of Contracts

All projects must be completed by June 30, 2027, with no options for extensions.

5C. Installation Standards & Permits

All work funded under this Program must be completed in accordance with all applicable federal, state, and local laws, regulations, codes, ordinances, and permitting requirements.

Award recipients are responsible for obtaining and maintaining all permits, licenses, and approvals required for the project. Failure to obtain or remain in compliance with any required approvals may result in termination of the contract.

All equipment purchased must be new and covered under the manufacturer's warranty. All construction and installation work must meet applicable codes and standards and be completed in a professional manner, consistent with the approved project scope.

6. DELIVERABLES, REPORTING & INVOICING

6A. Project Deliverables

Award recipients must complete all capital improvements and associated project activities in accordance with the approved Scope of Services and Budget.

Deliverables include, at a minimum, the purchase, installation, and operational readiness of approved equipment or infrastructure, as well as submission of required progress and final reports, as specified in the contract.

6B. Reporting Requirements

All award recipients will be required to collect and provide programmatic and project-specific data as required under their grant contract. Due to the range of eligible project types, reporting and data requirements will be defined on a project-specific basis during contracting.

Award recipients may be required to submit progress reports upon request by the Department. The Department will provide reporting templates if applicable.

The Department reserves the right to conduct site visits and inspections at any reasonable time during the contract period and after project completion to verify project implementation, compliance, and ongoing maintenance of funded assets. Whenever practicable, reasonable notice will be provided prior to a site visit.

Failure to comply with reporting, monitoring, or access requirements may be considered a breach of contract and may result in enforcement actions as specified in the contract.

6C. Invoicing & Payment

All grants under this Program are reimbursed on a **reimbursement basis only**. Award recipients must submit acceptable documentation to the Department prior to any payment.

Only eligible expenses incurred during the contract period are eligible for reimbursement. Any costs incurred prior to the full execution of the contract are not eligible.

The number and timing of reimbursements will be specified in the contract Scope of Services.

Equipment and vehicles must be purchased outright and may not be financed or leased. All equipment and vehicles must be fully owned by the award recipient by the contract end date to be eligible for reimbursement.

Project modifications or substitutions of approved items, activities, or objectives are not permitted without prior written approval by the Department. Unauthorized changes or noncompliance may result in termination of funding and/or recovery of funds.

7. DEADLINES & PROCUREMENT CALENDAR

Release of RFR	Monday March 23, 2026
Question Deadline	Applicants may submit questions regarding this RFR and application process. Questions must be submitted by email to FSIGGrant@mass.gov. The deadline for questions is 4:00PM on Monday April 20, 2026. All questions and answers will be posted at www.mass.gov/ApplytoFSIG so that all applicants can review. A prerecorded informational webinar has been made publicly available for interested applicants on the FSIG webpage.
Application Due Date	Monday May 4, 2026 at 4:00PM
Estimated Award Date	Summer 2026
Estimated Contract Start Date	The effective start date of a contract shall be the latest of the following dates: the date the Standard Contract Form has been executed by an authorized signatory of the contractor and the procuring department; the date of secretariat or other approval(s) required by law or regulation; or a later date specified in the Standard Contract Form.

8. MISCELLANEOUS

Type of Procurement	Grant
Use of This Procurement by Single or Multiple Departments	This RFR is a single department procurement. All contracts awarded under this RFR will be utilized only by MDAR.
Request for Single or Multiple Contractors	Multiple Contractors
RFR Distribution Method	This RFR has been distributed by MDAR's Farm and Market Newsletter, posted to the program's website at www.mass.gov/agr, and by a distribution list of requested applicants. This RFR has been distributed electronically via COMMBUYS. It is the responsibility of every applicant to check COMMBUYS for any addenda or modifications to an RFR to which they intend to respond. The Commonwealth of Massachusetts and its subdivisions accept no liability and will provide no accommodations to applicants who fail to check for amended RFRs and submit inadequate or incorrect responses. Potential Respondents are advised to check the "last change" field on the summary page of RFRs for which they intend to submit a response to ensure they have the most recent RFR files. Respondents may not alter RFR language or any RFR component files. Those submitting a proposal must respond in accordance to the RFR directions and complete only those sections that prompt a Respondent for a response. Modifications to the body of this RFR, specifications, terms and conditions, or which change the intent of this RFR are prohibited. Any unauthorized alterations will disqualify response.
List of Attachments	A. *Application Form- (This is a copy for reference only. PROPOSALS MUST BE SUBMITTED ONLINE. See Section 4 of the RFR for instructions). B. Budget Template C. Expected Performance Outcomes and Measures D. RFR Required Specifications

ATTACHMENT A

THIS IS A COPY FOR REFERENCE – ALL PROPOSALS MUST BE SUBMITTED ONLINE. SEE SECTION 4 OF THE RFR.

FOOD SECURITY INFRASTRUCTURE GRANT (FSIG) FY27 RESPONSE FORM

Project Overview

ORGANIZATION OR BUSINESS NAME:

PROJECT TITLE

PROJECT TYPE (select one)

☐ Expansion of
agriculture or
seafood production

☐ Local and regional
mid-supply chain
expansion

☐ Noncommercial
food access &
availability

☐ Commercial
food access
& availability

☐ Food system
resilience and
emergency
preparedness

PROJECT OVERVIEW:

A project overview is a summary of three sentences or less, suitable for dissemination to the public. It should be a very brief description of your project, the expected deliverables/outcomes, and a description of the general tasks/activities to be completed during the project period.

PARTNER ORGANIZATIONS: If there are any partner organizations contributing to the project, please list them.

TOTAL PROJECT BUDGET

REQUESTED AMOUNT

I have applied to another grant program for costs associated with this project: ☐ Yes ☐ No

If yes, name of
grant(s):

Have you received notification of award: ☐ Yes ☐ No

MDAR has the option to negotiate the requested amount before entering into a contract with the applicant. Any costs incurred prior to an executed contract with MDAR are not eligible for reimbursement from MDAR.

Applicant Information

MAIN CONTACT (FIRST NAME)	MAIN CONTACT (LAST NAME)
TITLE/ROLE:	
MAILING ADDRESS	CITY, STATE, ZIP
COUNTY	LEGAL STRUCTURE
	☐ Sole Proprietor ☐ Corporation ☐ Partnership ☐ LLC ☐ Other ☐ 501 (C)(3) ☐ Government
PHONE NUMBER	
E-MAIL	WEBSITE (optional)
SITE ADDRESS (if different)	SITE CITY, STATE, ZIP
Have you received any of the MDAR grants listed below in the past five years? Check all that apply.	
☐ Climate Smart Agriculture Program (CSAP) ☐ Resilient Food Systems Infrastructure Program (RFSI) ☐ Agricultural Food Safety Improvement Program (AFSIP) ☐ Matching Enterprise Grants for Agriculture Program (MEGA) ☐ Farm Viability Enhancement Program (FVER) ☐ Massachusetts Food Trust Program ☐ APR Improvement Program (AIP) ☐ Massachusetts Food Ventures Program ☐ Urban Agriculture Program ☐ Food Security Infrastructure Grant (FSIG)	

Operation background/Context

PRIMARY OPERATION TYPE			
☐ Farm	☐ Municipality	☐ Food Bank or Pantry	☐ Grocery Store
☐ Seafood Business or Commercial Fisherman	☐ Local Food Hub/Aggregator	☐ Farmers Market	☐ Commercial Kitchen
☐ Aquaculture	☐ School K-12	☐ Food Recovery Organization	☐ Value-Added Processor
☐ Seafood Dealer or Processor	☐ University or College	☐ Meat Processing or slaughterhouse	☐ Distributor or Wholesaler
☐ Other	☐ Early Childhood Education Center	☐ Healthcare or Medical Facility	☐ Medically Tailored Meal Service

OPERATION ENTITY

☐ For Profit Business
 ☐ Nonprofit Organization
 ☐ Public
 ☐ Tribal Entity
 ☐ Other: _____

OPERATION'S PRIMARY SUPPLY CHAIN ROLE

☐ Production
 ☐ Middle of Supply Chain
 ☐ Markets/Retail

MISSION STATEMENT (optional)

Provide a brief (2-3 sentences) overview of your operation and its role in the Commonwealth's food system:

YEARS IN OPERATION

ANNUAL OPERATING BUDGET/REVENUE (2025)

ESTIMATED FOOD SALES IN 2025 (if applicable):

ESTIMATED FOOD PURCHASES IN 2025 (if applicable):

☐ \$0 - \$24,999
 ☐ \$25,000 - \$249,999
 ☐ \$250,000 - \$499,999
 ☐ \$500,000 +

☐ \$0 - \$24,999
 ☐ \$25,000 - \$249,999
 ☐ \$250,000 - \$499,999
 ☐ \$500,000 +

TOTAL FULL TIME STAFF

TOTAL PART TIME STAFF

LIST ANY LOANS OR OTHER DEBT, TO WHOM MONEY IS OWED, AND \$ AMOUNTS:

Is the site address for the proposed project leased? If yes, when does the lease end?

☐ Yes
 ☐ No

Document Upload: Project Need or Feasibility - Applicants may upload up to three (3) documents

Applicants will be asked to upload documentation demonstrating project need or feasibility.

Eligible documentation may include created or updated within the last three (3) years):

- Business plan or strategic plan
- SWOT analysis
- Project feasibility study
- Market analysis
- Report identifying a gap within the food system

Requirements:

- Required for funding requests over \$151,000
- Recommended for funding requests \$150,000 or less

The following questions are only for operations that primarily sell food products (such as farms, seafood businesses, and other producers or distributors). Please complete the section as best as you can and provide estimates when necessary. This will help us better understand where food products are being sold.

Does your operation sell food products: ☐ Yes ☐ No (if no, skip to next section)

What is the current % breakdown between wholesale (sales to distributor, restaurants, stores) and retail sales (directly to customers) of your products:

Wholesale

Retail

WHERE PRODUCTS ARE SOLD or DONATED: (check all that apply)

- ☐ Grocery Store – Commercial
- ☐ Grocery Store – Independent
- ☐ Schools – K-12
- ☐ Schools – University/College
- ☐ Early Childhood Education Centers

- ☐ Healthcare or Medical Facilities
- ☐ Other Institutions
- ☐ Restaurants
- ☐ Direct to Consumers (farmer's market, CSA, online store, etc.)
- ☐ Emergency Food Assistance Programs (food banks, pantries, etc.)
- ☐ Other: (LIST) _____

What is the current breakdown of food products sold locally, regionally, nationally, and internationally:

	%	Massachusetts		%	Nationally
	%	Regionally (nearby states)		%	Internationally

Describe how your proposed project will change or improve your local food sales.

The following questions are only for operations that primarily buy/source food products (such as retail outlets, food service providers, emergency food providers, etc.). Please complete the section as best as you can and provide estimates when necessary. This will help us better understand where food products are being bought/sourced from.

Does your operation buy/source food products: ☐ Yes ☐ No (if no, skip to next section)

What is the current breakdown of food products bought/sourced locally, regionally, nationally, and internationally:

	%	Massachusetts		%	Nationally
	%	Regionally (nearby states)		%	Internationally

How many people do you provide food for annually?

Describe how your proposed project will change or improve your local food buying/sourcing habits.

Agricultural Operations Details Only

I am a farmer as identified in MGL Chapter 128, Sec. 1A: ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A (skip to next section)

Is the majority of the applicant's sales from their own agricultural products? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Type of Operation: ☐ Produce ☐ Livestock ☐ Dairy ☐ Greenhouse ☐ Nursery ☐ Cranberry ☐ Maple
☐ Vineyard ☐ Aquaculture ☐ Other: _____

Acreage: Owned Leased In Production

My operation has an Agricultural Preservation Restriction (APR): ☐ Yes ☐ No

APR Contact Person:

This project will be implemented on APR Restricted Land: ☐ Yes ☐ No

I have contacted the APR Program to determine if this proposal needs a Certificate of Approval (COA): ☐ Yes ☐ No

This project needs an approval from the APR Program: ☐ Yes ☐ No

Year the APR was recorded: Name on APR:

Seafood Operations Details Only

I am a permitted Massachusetts commercial fisherman or seafood dealer: ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A (skip to next section)

List the top 5 species by volume that this grant-funded equipment would handle, starting with highest:

Length of Vessel: Year vessel was built:

Typical number of on-board crew members:

Project Information

Capital infrastructure included in budget (check all that apply):

- | | | | |
|--|--|--|--|
| ☐ Construction/Renovation | ☐ Contracted Labor | ☐ Technology/Software | ☐ Boat Upgrades (engines, trawl nets, etc.) |
| ☐ Food Storage (non-perishable) | ☐ Food Storage (perishable) | ☐ Food Safety Improvement | ☐ Canning, Preserving, or Pasteurization |
| ☐ Kitchen/Cooking | ☐ Production, Harvest, or Cultivation Equipment | ☐ Pest Control | ☐ Other |
| ☐ Vehicle | ☐ Season Extension | ☐ Packaging | |

Stage of food supply chain the **proposed project** will most directly impact (refers to specific project, not entire operation):

☐ Production ☐ Middle of Supply Chain ☐ Markets/Retail

Project Need & Alignment

Describe the problem or capacity gap your project addresses and explain why your proposed project is the right solution. Be sure to show clear alignment with the selected project type (Section B1) and identify who will benefit from the project.

If applicable, describe how the project is incorporating, or will allow, multi-sector collaborations/partnerships, and how the collaborations/partnerships will strengthen the Massachusetts food system.

What goals that have been identified in [Massachusetts Local Food Plan](#) does your project align with? Check all that apply.

- | | |
|--------------------------|--|
| ☐ | Goal 1: Increase production, sales and consumption of Massachusetts-grown foods. |
| ☐ | Goal 2: Create jobs and economic opportunity in food and farming and improve the wages and skills of food system workers. |
| ☐ | Goal 3: Protect the land and water needed to produce food, maximize environmental benefits from agriculture and fishing, and ensure food safety. |
| ☐ | Goal 4: Reduce hunger and food insecurity, increase the availability of healthy food to all residents, and reduce food waste. |

FOOD SECURITY OUTCOMES & IMPACTS

Clearly identify (by indicator number and description title) 2-5 expected performance outcomes (see Attachment C) that best align with the proposed project. Describe how the project will achieve each expected outcome measure within 1-3 years of project completion and provide realistic, project appropriate estimated metrics expressed as whole numbers. Reasonable estimates may be used when baseline data is unavailable.

THIS IS A COPY FOR REFERENCE ONLY –
ALL PROPOSALS MUST BE SUBMITTED ONLINE.
SEE SECTION 4 OF THE RFR.

Demonstrate how the project will increase equitable access to nutritious—preferably local and culturally relevant—food for under-resourced and underserved residents of the Commonwealth. For the purposes of this Program, under-resourced and underserved refers to communities or populations that face persistent barriers to accessing sufficient, affordable, nutritious, and culturally appropriate food due to limited financial, infrastructural, geographical, or institutional resources, as well as constraints related to food availability, distribution, transportation, or local food system capacity. Applicants are strongly encouraged to review community-level data and research, which is referenced in Section 4E of the RFR.

To receive full consideration, applicant should:

- Reference relevant community-level data and research to document need.
- Describe key characteristics of the population served (e.g., income, socioeconomic conditions, food access, English isolation).
- Explain the geographic relationship between the community served and the project site.
- Describe how the project will reach the intended population(s) and provide evidence of that pathway (e.g., distribution plans, partner commitments, service area descriptions, procurement agreements, or program participation data).

Applicants could also share if their organization or business itself will have any direct benefits for groups such as [historically underserved farmers and/or ranchers](#) and middle-of-the-supply chain small businesses owned by [socially disadvantaged individuals](#) (as defined by the Small Business Administration). Please provide information about any barriers you have faced accessing funding if applicable.

Document Upload: Project benefit to Underserved and Under-Resourced Communities – Applicants may upload up to three (3) Documents

Applicants will be asked to upload documentation demonstrating how the proposed project benefits underserved and under-resourced communities.

- Letters of commitment or MOUs from partners demonstrating planned and specific food security impacts
- Demographic data for the clientele or service area
- Participant or beneficiary information
- SNAP or nutrition incentive sales data
- List of partners
- Project plan or other documentation demonstrating need or feasibility

Requirements:

- Recommended for funding requests over \$151,000
- Optional for funding requests \$150,000 or less

If applicable, describe how the project incorporates resilience measures (e.g., backup power, flood protection, waste reduction) that protect food access during disruptions. If the project aligns with any of the objectives outlined in [ResilientMass](#), please demonstrate.

FEASIBILITY OF PROJECT PLAN

Describe your operations' capacity and ability to administer the project. Please include details about key personnel, their responsibilities, and qualifications.

Provide a comprehensive timeline of the tasks/activities associated with the project, including any local or state permitting required. Be sure to demonstrate that the project can be completed within the grant period time frame.

This is a reimbursement grant program with a 20% cash match component. Describe how the project will be funded up-front and how a cash match will be provided.

Document Upload: Letter of Match – Applicants may upload one (1) document

Applicants will be asked to upload a letter of match confirming the applicant's cash match commitment.

A letter of match must:

- Be signed by an authorized signatory
- Confirm the cash match amount
- Identify the funding source(s) of the match

Requirements:

- Recommended for funding requests over \$151,000
- Optional for funding requests \$150,000 or less

SUSTAINABILITY & MAINTENANCE

Demonstrate how the investment will be maintained and continue to provide benefits beyond the contract period. Response should describe who will maintain the equipment/infrastructure, how ongoing costs will be covered, and how benefits (food access, distribution, or resilience outcomes) will be sustained over time.

Previous Funding

If your operation received any funding from the Food Security Infrastructure Grant before, provide the total amount of funding received and a brief (2-3 sentences) summary of the project's impact.

Total amount of funding received:

Project Impacts:

Required Documentation

1. Project budget. Make sure it includes the project total, match, and total funding request from the Food Security Infrastructure Grant. There is a budget template provided in Attachment B of the RFR. Failure to provide a project budget will result in the application being ineligible.
2. Vendor quotes. Applicants must submit two (2) quotes for each expenditure/line item in the budget that costs \$50,000 or more. Applicants must submit one (1) quote for each expenditure/line item in the budget that costs less than \$50,000. Quotes should be from qualified vendors or contractors and reflect accurate cost estimates. Failure to submit quotes will result in the application being ineligible.

Optional Documentation

1. Additional Letters of support. Applicants may submit up to three (3).

These documents are not required but applicants who supply them may receive additional points – especially when considering larger projects.

ATTESTATION

By signing this application, you attest all statements herein are accurate and true. By signing this application, you give permission to have a site visit by MDAR staff which may be necessary before a funding decision is made. All site visits will be arranged with you in advance.

Signature

Date

Print Name

FY27 Food Security Infrastructure Grant – Budget Template

Applicant Name: First Name Last Name

Operation Name:

Project Title:

Materials				
	Description	Amount	Qty	Total Costs
1				
2				
3				
4				
Contractual Costs/Labor (expenses for services performed by someone other than the applicant)				
	Description	Rate	Hours	Total Costs
1				
2				
3				
Equipment (Equipment to be purchased under the FSIG grant)				
	Description	Amount	Qty	Total Costs
1				
2				
3				
Equipment Rental (Rented equipment required to complete the project)				
	Description	Rate	Hours	Total Costs
1				
2				
Other Costs				
	Description	Amount	Qty	Total Costs
1				
2				
3				
4				
Total FSIG Project Cost*:				\$
Applicant Match (see Match Requirements in Section 3D of the RFR):				\$
FSIG Request (Total Project Costs minus Applicant Match):				\$

*The applicant match and FSIG request should equal the total FSIG project cost. A 20% minimum cash contribution towards the project must come from the applicant.

Attachment C

Expected Performance Outcomes & Measures for FY27 Food Security Infrastructure Grants

Instructions for Applicants

In your response to the first question under the *Food Security Impacts and Outcomes* section of the application, select **a minimum of two (2) and a maximum of five (5)** expected performance outcomes that best align with the proposed project.

In your response, you must:

- Clearly identify the performance outcomes you selected (by indicator number and description title), and
- Describe **how the project will achieve each selected outcomes within 1-3 years of project completion** and provide **estimated metrics** expressed as **whole numbers**. Please ensure your targets are realistic and project appropriate.

Applicants may use reasonable estimates when baseline data is unavailable.

Awarded applicants will be required to track and report on selected performance outcomes within 1-3 years after the project is completed.

OUTCOME 1: Increase local and/or nutritious food access and availability		
Indicator	Description	Metric <i>Ex: 200 new SNAP customers served; 5,000 additional square feet of cold storage)</i>
1.1	Number of new customers served from underserved or/and under-resourced populations (e.g. clients of WIC, SNAP, HIP, food pantries, medically tailored meals, etc.)	
1.2	Number of new or strengthened partnerships with food access organizations or institutions (e.g. schools, hospitals, etc.)	
1.3	Number of additional pounds of food or dollars of food purchased or sold for emergency food assistance/donation (e.g. food pantry, meal site, food bank, etc.)	
1.4	Number of additional pounds of food recovered and/or diverted to the emergency feeding system	
1.5	Number of new institutional food service accounts serving underserved and/or under-resourced populations	

Attachment C**Expected Performance Outcomes & Measures for FY27 Food Security Infrastructure Grants**

1.6	Number of additional scratch-cooked meals prepared on-site serving underserved and/or under-resourced populations	
OUTCOME 2: Increase economic viability of local food producers, processors, farmers and/or fishermen		
2.1	Number of new full or part-time jobs created	
2.2	Number of new local/regional products processed, aggregated, stored or distributed for Massachusetts residents	
2.3	Number of local food producers, farmers or fishers who benefited from new or improved processing/aggregation/storage or distribution infrastructure	
2.4	Number of new Massachusetts market outlets established due to improved infrastructure or equipment	
2.5	Number of increased local food sales or purchases serving Massachusetts residents	
2.6	Number of increased acres of food production due to new or improved infrastructure/equipment	
OUTCOME 3: Strengthened food supply chain resilience for local and/or nutritious food products		
3.1	Increased capacity of food storage and/or preservation (e.g. square footage of new capacity; additional storage units)	
3.2	Number of increased square footage of local food production/aggregation/processing capacity due to new or improved infrastructure	
3.3	Number of new sourcing relationships with local buyers or local farmers/fishers	
3.4	Number of new pounds or dollars of food purchased from local farmers and/or fishers	
3.5	Number of additional days of reliable food storage and/or distribution during times of emergency	



RFR - Required Specifications for Commodities and Services

Revision Date: July 10, 2024

In general, most of the required contractual stipulations are referenced in the *Standard Contract Form and Instructions* and the *Commonwealth Terms and Conditions*. However, the following RFR provisions must appear in all Commonwealth departmental competitive procurements conducted under 801 CMR 21.00.

The terms of 801 CMR 21.00: *Procurement of Commodities and Services* are incorporated by reference into this RFR. Words used in this RFR shall have the meanings defined in 801 CMR 21.00. Additional definitions also may be identified in this RFR. Other terms not defined elsewhere in this document may be defined in OSD's [Glossary of Terms](#). Unless otherwise specified in this RFR, all communications, responses, and documentation must be in English, all measurements must be provided in feet, inches, and pounds and all cost proposals or figures in U.S. currency. All responses must be submitted in accordance with the specific terms of this RFR.

1. COMMBUYS Market Center. COMMBUYS is the official source of information for this Bid and is publicly accessible at no charge at www.commbuys.com. Information contained in this document and in COMMBUYS, including file attachments, and information contained in the related Bid Questions and Answers (Q&A), are components of the Bid, as referenced in COMMBUYS, and are incorporated into the Bid and any resulting contract.

Bidders are solely responsible for obtaining all information distributed for this Bid via COMMBUYS. Bid Q&A supports Bidder submission of written questions associated with a Bid and publication of official answers.

It is each Bidder's responsibility to check COMMBUYS for:

- Any amendments, addenda, or modifications to this Bid, and
- Any Bid Q&A records related to this Bid.

The Commonwealth accepts no responsibility and will provide no accommodation to Bidders who submit a Quote based on an out-of-date Bid or on information received from a source other than COMMBUYS.

2. COMMBUYS Registration. Bidders may elect to register for a free COMMBUYS Seller account which provides value-added features, including automated email notification associated with postings and modifications to COMMBUYS records. However, to respond to a Bid, Bidders must register and maintain an active COMMBUYS Seller account.

All Bidders submitting a Quote (previously referred to as Response) in response to this Bid (previously referred to as Solicitation) agree that, if awarded a contract: 1) they will maintain an active seller account in COMMBUYS; 2) they will, when directed to do so by the procuring entity, activate and maintain a COMMBUYS-enabled catalog using Commonwealth Commodity Codes; 3) they will comply with all requests by the procuring entity to utilize COMMBUYS for the purposes of conducting all aspects of purchasing and invoicing with the Commonwealth, as added functionality for the COMMBUYS system is activated; and 4) in the event the Commonwealth adopts an alternate e-procurement platform, successful Bidders will be required to utilize such system, as directed by the procuring entity. Commonwealth Commodity Codes are based on the United Nations Standard Products and Services Code (UNSPSC).

COMMBUYS uses terminology with which bidders must be familiar to conduct business with the Commonwealth. To view this terminology and to learn more about COMMBUYS, please visit the [Learn about COMMBUYS Resources](#) page on mass.gov.

3. Multiple Quotes. Bidders may not submit Multiple Quotes in response to a Bid unless the RFR authorizes them to do so. If a Bidder submits multiple quotes in response to an RFR that does not authorize multiple responses, only the latest dated quote submitted prior to the bid opening date will be evaluated.

4. Quote Content. Bid specifications for delivery, shipping, billing, and payment will prevail over any proposed Bidder terms entered as part of the Quote, unless otherwise specified in the Bid.

5. Supplier Diversity Office (SDO) Programs. Pursuant to [Executive Order 599](#), the Commonwealth supports the use of diverse and small businesses through the Small Business Purchasing Program (SBPP) and the Supplier Diversity

RFR - Required Specifications for Commodities and Services

Program (SDP). Based on the estimated value of the procurement, one of the above-mentioned programs shall be applicable to this RFR. For more information on the program that applies to this solicitation, see the body of this RFR.

6. Small Business Purchasing Program (SBPP)

Program Background. The Massachusetts [Small Business Purchasing Program](#) (SBPP) was established pursuant to [Executive Order 599](#) to increase state contracting opportunities with small businesses having their principal place of business within the Commonwealth of Massachusetts. Pursuant to the SBPP, it is the intention of the issuing department to award this Small Procurement to one or more SBPP participating business(es) as described below.

SBPP Award Preference. While all businesses, no matter the size or principal place of business, may submit responses to this solicitation, should an SBPP participant respond and meet the best value criteria described in this solicitation, the SBPP participant shall be awarded the contract. The Strategic Sourcing Services Team (SST) will not evaluate submissions from non-SBPP participants unless no SBPP Bidder meets the SST's best value evaluation criteria.

SBPP Participation Eligibility. To be eligible to participate in this procurement as an SBPP participant, an entity must meet the following criteria, and be marked as an SBPP-registered business in [COMMBUYS](#):

1. Have its principal place of business in the Commonwealth of Massachusetts;
2. Been in business for at least one year;
3. Employ a combined total of 50 or fewer full-time equivalent employees in all locations, or employees work less than a combined total of 26,000 hours per quarter; and
4. Have gross revenues, as reported on appropriate tax forms, of \$15 million or less, based on a three-year average.

Non-profit firms also must be registered as a non-profit or charitable organization with the MA Attorney General's Office and be up to date with all filings required by that office and be tax exempt under Section 501(c) of the Internal Revenue Code.

SBPP Compliance Requirements. It is the responsibility of the Bidder to ensure that their SBPP status is current at the time of submitting a response and throughout the life of any resulting contract. Misrepresentation of SBPP status will result in disqualification from consideration, and may result in debarment, contract termination, and other actions. To learn more about the SBPP, including how to apply, visit the SBPP webpage, <http://www.mass.gov/sbpp>.

Program Resources and Assistance. Bidders and Contractors seeking assistance regarding SBPP may visit the [SBPP Webpage](#), or contact the SBPP Help Desk at sbpp@mass.gov.

7. Supplier Diversity Program (SDP)

Program Background. Pursuant to [Executive Order 599](#), the Commonwealth's [Supplier Diversity Program](#) (SDP) promotes business-to-business relationships between awarded Contractors and diverse businesses and non-profit organizations ("SDP Partners") certified or recognized (see below for more information) by the [Supplier Diversity Office \(SDO\)](#).

All Bidders and Contractors are strongly encouraged to create a profile on the SDO's Supplier Diversity Hub to access the Commonwealth's supplier diversity resources and tools.

Financial Commitment Requirements. All Bidders responding to this solicitation are required to make a significant financial commitment ("SDP Commitment") to partnering with one or more SDO-certified or recognized diverse business enterprise(s) or non-profit organization(s). This SDP Commitment must be expressed as a percentage of contract sales resulting from this solicitation that would be spent with the SDP Partner(s).

After contract award (if any), the Total SDP Commitment shall become a contractual requirement to be met annually on a Massachusetts fiscal year basis (July 1 – June 30) for the duration of the contract. The minimum acceptable Total SDP Commitment in response to this solicitation shall be 1%. Bidders shall be awarded additional evaluation points for higher SDP Commitments.

No contract shall be awarded to a Bidder without an SDP Commitment that meets the requirements stated herein. This requirement extends to all Bidders regardless of their own supplier diversity certification.

Eligible SDP Partner Certification Categories

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SDP Partners must be business enterprises and/or non-profit organizations certified or recognized by the SDO in one or more of the following certification categories:

- Minority-Owned Business Enterprise (MBE)
- Minority Non-Profit Organization (M/NPO)
- Women-Owned Business Enterprise (WBE)
- Women Non-Profit Organization (W/NPO)
- Veteran-Owned Business Enterprise (VBE)
- Service-Disabled Veteran-Owned Business Enterprise (SDVOBE)
- Disability-Owned Business Enterprise (DOBE)
- Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual, and Transgender Business Enterprise (LBGTBE)

Eligible Types of Business-to-Business Relationships. Bidders and Contractors may engage SDP Partners as follows:

- **Subcontracting**, defined as a partnership in which the SDP partner is involved in the provision of products and/or services to the Commonwealth.
- **Ancillary Products and Services**, defined as a business relationship in which the SDP partner provides products or services that are not directly related to the Contractor's contract with the Commonwealth but may be related to the Contractor's own operational needs. These may include but are not limited to the following examples: professional services (e.g., IT, legal, advertising, HR, accounting etc.), maintenance services (e.g., cleaning, landscaping, tradespersons services, etc.), office expenses (e.g., office supplies, furniture, IT supplies, etc.). Anything declared as a business expense in which a certified vendor is used would qualify.

Other types of business-to-business relationships are not acceptable under this contract. If subcontracting is proposed, it must meet all the subcontracting provisions (if any) listed in this RFR.

Program Flexibility. The SDP encompasses the following provisions to support Bidders in establishing and maintaining sustainable business-to-business relationships meeting their needs:

- SDP Partners are **not** required to be subcontractors.
- SDP Partners are **not** required to be Massachusetts-based businesses.
- SDP Partners **may be changed or added** during the term of the contract, provided the Contractor continues to meet its SDP Commitment.

SDP Plan Form Requirements. All Bidders must complete the SDP Plan Form included in this solicitation and attach it to their bid response. In addition to proposing an SDP Commitment, each Bidder must propose one or more SDP Partner(s) to utilize to meet its SDP Commitment. Certified diverse Bidders may not list their own companies, their subsidiaries, or affiliates as SDP Partners and may not meet their SDP Commitment by spending funds internally or with their own subsidiaries or affiliates.

Bidders may propose SDP Partners that are:

- **Certified or recognized by the SDO:** Such partners appear in the [SDO Directory of Certified Businesses](#) or in the [SBA Veteran Small Business Certification \(VetCert\)](#) directory. After contract award (if any), spending with such partners will contribute to meeting the Contractor's SDP Commitment.
- **Certified by one of SDO's recognized third-party certification bodies but not yet listed in the SDO Directory of Certified Businesses:** Such partners must be certified in eligible categories by one of SDO's recognized third-party certification bodies, which include the [City of Boston](#), the [Greater New England Minority Supplier Development Council \(GNEMSDC\)](#), the [Center for Women & Enterprise \(CWE\)](#), [Disability: IN](#), [National LGBT Chamber of Commerce \(NGLCC\)](#), or the [National Veteran Owned Business Association \(NaVOBA\)](#) but have not yet opted to be listed in the SDO Directory of Certified Businesses. In order to opt into SDO's Directory of Certified Businesses, the SDP partner must follow the applicable expedited instructions on SDO's Apply for Recognition as a Third-Party Certified Business webpage. Self-certification is not acceptable. While Bidders may list such proposed SDP Partners on their SDP Plans, spending with such partners will not contribute to meeting the Contractor's SDP Commitment unless they apply for and are granted SDO supplier diversity certification or recognition. If proposed SDP Partners do not receive SDO supplier diversity certification or recognition, the Contractor must find alternative SDP Partners to meet the SDP Commitment.
- **Not yet certified or recognized by the SDO or one of SDO's recognized third-party certification bodies:** Such partners must be certified in eligible categories by other third-party certification bodies that are not yet recognized by the SDO, such as another city or state supplier diversity certification office, the [National Minority Supplier Development Council](#), or the [Women Business Enterprise National Council](#), but are not listed in the above-mentioned directories. Self-certification is not acceptable. While Bidders may list such

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proposed SDP Partners on their SDP Plans, spending with such partners will not contribute to meeting the Contractor's SDP Commitment unless they apply for and are granted SDO supplier diversity certification or recognition. If proposed SDP Partners do not receive SDO supplier diversity certification or recognition, the Contractor must find alternative SDP Partners to meet the SDP Commitment.

It is the responsibility of the Contractor to ensure that their proposed SDP Partners obtain such certification or recognition by the SDO after contract award (if any). The issuing department and the SDO will not conduct outreach to proposed SDP Partners to ensure their certification. Furthermore, no guarantee may be made that a proposed SDP Partner will be certified, or regarding the time it may take to process a proposed SDP Partner certification. Contractors may direct partners to the SDO's homepage, www.mass.gov/sdo and the [Certification Self-Assessment Tool](#) for guidance on applying for certification.

It is **desirable** for Bidders to provide a description of supplier diversity businesses practices. Specifically, listing contact information for the individual or unit responsible for establishing and maintaining supplier diversity relationships, and including a written policy for establishing and maintaining supplier diversity relationships.

It also is **desirable** for Bidders to use the SDP Plan Form to describe additional creative initiatives (if any) related to engaging, buying from, and/or collaborating with diverse businesses. Such initiatives may include but not be limited to:

- Serving as a mentor in a mentor-protégé relationship.
- Technical and financial assistance provided to diverse businesses.
- Participation in joint ventures between nondiverse and diverse businesses.
- Voluntary assistance programs by which nondiverse business employees are loaned to diverse businesses or by which diverse business employees are taken into viable business ventures to acquire training and experience in managing business affairs.

Evaluation of SDP Forms. To encourage Bidders to develop substantial supplier diversity initiatives and commitments as measures valuable to the Commonwealth, at least 25% of the total available evaluation points for this bid solicitation shall be allocated to the evaluation of the SDP Plan submissions. Because the purpose of the SDP is to promote business-to-business partnerships, the Bidders' workforce diversity initiatives will not be considered in the evaluation.

SDP Spending Reports. After contract award, Contractors must submit reports at least annually to demonstrate compliance with the agreed-upon SDP Commitment. To submit SDP spending reports using the Hub, Contractors must first create a profile in the Hub. Once registered, awarded contractors must report information such as, but not limited to, SDO or SDO-recognized SDP partner(s), spend with SDO partner(s), and total contract sales. Contractors must follow report submission instructions from the issuing department and the SDO.

SDP Spending Compliance. Only spending with SDP Partners that appear in the [SDO Directory of Certified Businesses](#) or in the [SBA Veteran Small Business Certification \(VetCert\)](#) directory shall be counted toward a Contractor's compliance with their SDP Commitment. Spending with SDP Partners that do not appear in the directories above shall not be counted toward meeting a Contractor's SDP Commitment.

It is the responsibility of the Contractor to ensure they meet their SDP Commitment, and the SDO and the issuing department assume no responsibility for any Contractor's failure to meet its SDP Commitment.

SDP Spending Verification. The SDO and the contracting department reserve the right to contact SDP Partners at any time to request that they attest to the amounts reported to have been paid to them by the Contractor.

Program Resources and Assistance. Contractors seeking assistance in the development of their SDP Plans or identification of potential SDP Partners may visit the SDP webpage, www.mass.gov/sdp, or contact the SDP Help Desk at sdp@mass.gov.

8. Agricultural Products Preference (only applicable if this is a procurement for Agricultural Products). Chapter 123 of the Acts of 2006 directs the State Purchasing Agent to grant a preference to products of agriculture grown or produced using locally grown products. Such locally grown or produced products shall be purchased unless the price of the goods exceeds the price of products of agriculture from outside the Commonwealth by more than 10%. For purposes of this preference, products of agriculture are defined to include any agricultural, aquacultural, floricultural, or horticultural commodities; the growing and harvesting of forest products; the raising of livestock, including horses; raising of domesticated animals, bees, and/or fur-bearing animals; and any forestry or lumbering operations.

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9. Best Value Selection and Negotiation. The Strategic Sourcing Services Team or SSST may select the response(s) which demonstrates the best value overall, including proposed alternatives that will achieve the procurement goals of the department. The SSST and a selected bidder, or a contractor, may negotiate a change in any element of contract performance or cost identified in the original RFR or the selected bidder's or contractor's response which results in lower costs or a more cost effective or better value than was presented in the selected bidder's or contractor's original response.

10. Bidder Communication. Bidders are prohibited from communicating directly with any employee of the procuring department or any member of the SSST regarding this RFR except as specified in this RFR, and no other individual Commonwealth employee or representative is authorized to provide any information or respond to any question or inquiry concerning this RFR. Bidders may contact the contact person for this RFR in the event this RFR is incomplete or the bidder is having trouble obtaining any required attachments electronically through COMMBUYS.

11. Contract Expansion. If additional funds become available during the contract duration period, the department reserves the right to increase the maximum obligation to some or all contracts executed as a result of this RFR or to execute contracts with contractors not funded in the initial selection process, subject to available funding, satisfactory contract performance and service or commodity need.

12. Costs. Costs which are not specifically identified in the bidder's response and accepted by a department as part of a contract will not be compensated under any contract awarded pursuant to this RFR. The Commonwealth will not be responsible for any costs or expenses incurred by bidders responding to this RFR.

13. Electronic Communication/Update of Bidder's/Contractor's Contact Information. It is the responsibility of the prospective bidder and awarded contractor to keep current on COMMBUYS the email address of the bidder's contact person and prospective contract manager, if awarded a contract, and to monitor that email inbox for communications from the SSST, including requests for clarification. The SSST and the Commonwealth assume no responsibility if a prospective bidder's/awarded contractor's designated email address is not current, or if technical problems, including those with the prospective bidder's/awarded contractor's computer, network, or internet service provider (ISP) cause email communications sent to/from the prospective bidder/awarded contractor and the SSST to be lost or rejected by any means including email or spam filtering.

14. Electronic Funds Transfer (EFT). All bidders responding to this RFR must agree to participate in the Commonwealth Electronic Funds Transfer (EFT) program for receiving payments, unless the bidder is able to provide compelling proof that it would be unduly burdensome. EFT is a benefit to both contractors and the Commonwealth because it ensures fast, safe, and reliable payment directly to contractors and saves both parties the cost of processing checks. Contractors may track and verify payments made electronically through the Comptroller's [Vendor Web system](#). A link to the EFT application may be found on the [OSD Forms](#) page (www.mass.gov/lists/osd-forms). Additional information about EFT is available on the [VendorWeb](#) site (www.mass.gov/osc). Click on MASSfinance.

Successful bidders, upon notification of contract award, will be required to enroll in EFT as a contract requirement by completing and submitting the *Authorization for Electronic Funds Payment Form* to this department for review, approval, and forwarding to the Office of the Comptroller. If the bidder already is enrolled in the program, it may so indicate in its response. Because the *Authorization for Electronic Funds Payment Form* contains banking information, this form, and all information contained on this form, shall not be considered a public record and shall not be subject to public disclosure through a public records request.

The requirement to use EFT may be waived by the SSST on a case-by-case basis if participation in the program would be unduly burdensome on the bidder. If a bidder is claiming that this requirement is a hardship or unduly burdensome, the specific reason must be documented in its response. The SSST will consider such requests on a case-by-case basis and communicate the findings to the bidder.

15. Executive Order 509, Establishing Nutrition Standards for Food Purchased and Served by State Agencies. Food purchased and served by state agencies must be in compliance with Executive Order 509, issued in January 2009. Under this Executive Order, all contracts resulting from procurements posted after July 1, 2009, that involve the purchase and provision of food must comply with nutrition guidelines established by the Department of Public Health (DPH). The nutrition guidelines are available at the Department's website: [Tools and Resources for Implementation of Executive Order 509](#).

16. HIPAA: Business Associate Contractual Obligations. Bidders are notified that any department meeting the definition of a Covered Entity under the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act of 1996 (HIPAA) will

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include in the RFR and resulting contract sufficient language establishing the successful bidder's contractual obligations, if any, that the department will require in order for the department to comply with HIPAA and the privacy and security regulations promulgated thereunder (45 CFR Parts 160, 162, and 164) (the Privacy and Security Rules). For example, if the department determines that the successful bidder is a business associate performing functions or activities involving protected health information, as such terms are used in the Privacy and Security Rules, then the department will include in the RFR and resulting contract a sufficient description of business associate's contractual obligations regarding the privacy and security of the protected health information, as listed in 45 CFR 164.314 and 164.504 (e), including, but not limited to, the bidder's obligation to: implement administrative, physical, and technical safeguards that reasonably and appropriately protect the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of the protected health information (in whatever form it is maintained or used, including verbal communications); provide individuals access to their records; and strictly limit use and disclosure of the protected health information for only those purposes approved by the department. Further, the department reserves the right to add any requirement during the course of the contract that it determines it must include in the contract in order for the department to comply with the Privacy and Security Rules. Please see other sections of the RFR for any further HIPAA details, if applicable.

17. Minimum Quote (Bid Response) Duration. Bidders Quotes made in response to this Bid must remain in effect for at least 90 days from the date of quote submission.

18. Prompt Payment Discounts (PPD). All bidders responding to this procurement must agree to offer discounts through participation in the Commonwealth's Prompt Payment Discount (PPD) initiative for receiving early and/or on-time payments, unless the bidder provides compelling proof that it would be unduly burdensome. PPD benefits both contractors and the Commonwealth. Contractors benefit by increased, usable cash flow as a result of fast and efficient payments for commodities or services rendered. Participation in the Electronic Funds Transfer (EFT) initiative further maximizes the benefits with payments directed to designated accounts, thus eliminating the impact of check clearance policies and traditional mail lead time or delays. The Commonwealth benefits because contractors reduce the cost of products and services through the applied discount. Payments that are processed electronically may be tracked and verified through the Comptroller's Vendor Web system. The PPD form may be found as an attachment for this Bid on [COMMBUYS](#).

Bidders must submit agreeable terms for Prompt Payment Discount using the PPD form within their proposal, unless otherwise specified by the SSST. The SSST will review, negotiate, or reject the offering as deemed in the best interest of the Commonwealth.

The requirement to use PPD offerings may be waived by the SSST on a case-by-case basis if participation in the program would be unduly burdensome on the bidder. If a bidder is claiming that this requirement is a hardship or unduly burdensome, the specific reason must be documented in or attached to the PPD form.

19. Public Records. All responses and information submitted in response to this RFR are subject to the Massachusetts Public Records Law, M.G.L., c. 66, s. 10, and to c. 4, s. 7, ss. 26. Any statements in submitted responses that are inconsistent with these statutes, including marking by bidders of information as confidential during the quote submission process in COMMBUYS, shall be disregarded.

20. Reasonable Accommodation. Bidders with disabilities or hardships that seek reasonable accommodation, which may include the receipt of RFR information in an alternative format, must communicate such requests in writing to the contact person. Requests for accommodation will be addressed on a case by case basis. A bidder requesting accommodation must submit a written statement which describes the bidder's disability and the requested accommodation to the contact person for the RFR. The SSST reserves the right to reject unreasonable requests.

21. Restriction on the Use of the Commonwealth Seal. Bidders and contractors are not allowed to display the Commonwealth of Massachusetts Seal in their bid package or subsequent marketing materials if they are awarded a contract because use of the coat of arms and the Great Seal of the Commonwealth for advertising or commercial purposes is prohibited by law.

22. Subcontracting Policies. Prior approval of the department is required for any subcontracted service of the contract. Contractors are responsible for the satisfactory performance and adequate oversight of its subcontractors. Human and social service subcontractors are also required to meet the same state and federal financial and program reporting requirements and are held to the same reimbursable cost standards as contractors.

23. Acceptable Forms of Signature

Effective June 15, 2021, for all 1) CTR forms, including the Standard Contract Form, W-9s, Electronic Funds Transfer

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(EFT) forms, ISAs, and other CTR-issued documents and forms, or 2) documents related to state finance and within the statutory area of authority or control of CTR (i.e. contracts, payrolls, and related supporting documentation), CTR will accept signatures executed by an authorized signatory in any of the following ways: 1. Traditional “wet signature” (ink on paper); 2. Electronic signature that is either: a. Hand drawn using a mouse or finger if working from a touch screen device; or Page 2 b. An uploaded picture of the signatory’s hand drawn signature 3. Electronic signatures affixed using a digital tool such as Adobe Sign or DocuSign. If using an electronic signature, the signature must be visible, include the signatory’s name and title, and must be accompanied by a signature date. Please be advised that typed text of a name not generated by a digital tool such as Adobe Sign or DocuSign, even in computer-generated cursive script, or an electronic symbol, are not acceptable forms of electronic signature.

ATTACHMENT A

FOOD SECURITY INFRASTRUCTURE GRANT (FSIG) FY27 RESPONSE FORM

Project Overview

ORGANIZATION OR BUSINESS NAME:	FSIG ID: FSIG27045
Public Schools of Brookline	
PROJECT TITLE	
Brookline High School and Lincoln Cafeteria Expansion and Food Distribution Enhancement	
PROJECT TYPE (select one)	
Noncommercial food access and availability	
PROJECT OVERVIEW: A project overview is a summary of three sentences or less, suitable for dissemination to the public. It should be a very brief description of your project, the expected deliverables/outcomes, and a description of the general tasks/activities to be completed during the project period.	
The Public Schools of Brookline plan to expand the kitchen infrastructure and serving capacity at Brookline High School (BHS) Greenough Campus and Lincoln School to improve access to nutritious and culturally appropriate meals for students. This initiative will support scratch cooking, plant-based options, and accommodate various dietary needs while replacing outdated equipment with modern, energy-efficient systems. This project also includes acquiring a refrigerated vehicle to enhance the distribution of locally sourced foods across the district's 15 schools. Currently, local vendors can only deliver to one location, but the refrigerated van will allow for more efficient and equitable distribution. Additionally, this vehicle will help expand Summer Eats programming. Although the district has successfully operated three Summer Eats sites in Boston, the new van will enable the district to serve more sites and provide nutritious meals during the summer months, when food insecurity is most acute. Overall, these investments will improve efficiency, reduce energy costs, strengthen local food connections, and ensure diverse students have year-round access to healthy meals.	
PARTNER ORGANIZATIONS: If there are any partner organizations contributing to the project, please list them.	
Brookline Public Schools Facilities/Building Department, Town of Brookline Building Department, Red's Best, New Entry Food Hub, Boston Food Hub, Commonwealth Kitchen, World Farmers, Mayflowers Poultry (Halal Chicken) The Public Schools of Brookline Food Services Department will collaborate with several key partners to successfully implement this project. Internal partners include the Brookline Public Schools Facilities/Building Department and the Town of Brookline Building Department, which will provide critical support for project planning, permitting, and installation of kitchen infrastructure and equipment upgrades. The district will also partner with Massachusetts-based food system organizations to expand local procurement and distribution, including Red's Best, New Entry Food Hub, Boston Food Hub, Commonwealth Kitchen, and World Farmers, Mayflower Poultry... These partners will support the sourcing of locally produced seafood, meat, produce, and value-added products. Together, these partnerships strengthen the project's implementation capacity, expand access to local foods, and support a more resilient regional food system.	
TOTAL PROJECT BUDGET	REQUESTED AMOUNT
\$576,131	\$460,904

Applicant Information

MAIN CONTACT (FIRST NAME)	MAIN CONTACT (LAST NAME)
Sasha	Palmer
TITLE/ROLE:	
Food Service Director	
MAILING ADDRESS	CITY, STATE, ZIP
490 Heath St -	Brookline, Massachusetts, 02467
COUNTY	LEGAL STRUCTURE
Norfolk	Government
PHONE NUMBER	
(617) 730-2499	
E-MAIL	WEBSITE (optional)
sasha_palmer@psbma.org	https://publicschoolsofbrooklineschoolnutrition.com/
SITE ADDRESS (if different)	SITE CITY, STATE, ZIP
Have you received any of the MDAR grants listed below in the past five years? List them:	

Operation Background/Context

PRIMARY OPERATION TYPE

School K-12

OPERATION ENTITY

Public

OPERATION'S PRIMARY SUPPLY CHAIN ROLE

Markets/retail

MISSION STATEMENT (optional)

The Public Schools of Brookline Food Services Department is committed to providing nutritious, high-quality meals that support student health, academic success, and equitable access to food for all students.

Provide a brief (2-3 sentences) overview of your operation and its role in the Commonwealth's food system:

The Food Services program of the Public Schools of Brookline provides thousands of meals daily across a diverse urban-suburban district. This program is essential for ensuring that students have access to nutritious meals through the National School Lunch Program. It promotes food security, student wellness, and culturally responsive meal services throughout the district.

The Food Services Department operates a comprehensive school meal program that serves students at 15 different sites, offering healthy breakfast and lunch options through the National School Lunch Program. This initiative plays a crucial role in the Commonwealth's food system by ensuring consistent access to nutritious, culturally inclusive meals while also supporting local and regional food sourcing. Through partnerships with Massachusetts-based producers and participation in programs like Summer Eats, the department not only contributes to food security but also strengthens connections between educational institutions and the local food economy.

YEARS IN OPERATION

183

ANNUAL OPERATING BUDGET/REVENUE (2025)

\$4,058,054

ESTIMATED FOOD SALES IN 2025 (if applicable):

\$500,000+

ESTIMATED FOOD PURCHASES IN 2025 (if applicable):

\$500,000+

TOTAL FULL TIME STAFF/PART TIME STAFF

55 Full time/ 1 part time

LIST ANY LOANS OR OTHER DEBT, TO WHOM MONEY IS OWED, AND \$ AMOUNTS:

None

Is the site address for the proposed project leased?

Yes

If Yes, when does the lease end?

The following questions are only for operations that primarily buy/source food products (such as retail outlets, food service providers, emergency food providers, etc.). Please complete the section as best as you can and provide estimates when necessary. This will help us better understand where food products are being bought/sourced from.

Does your operation buy/source food products: We buy/source food products

What is the current breakdown of food products bought/sourced locally, regionally, nationally, and internationally:

12.64	%	Massachusetts	75.85	%	Nationally
9.4	%	Regionally (nearby states)	2.1	%	Internationally

How many people do you provide food for annually?

7,000+

Describe how your proposed project will change or improve your local food buying/sourcing habits.

The proposed project aims to greatly enhance the Public Schools of Brookline's ability to purchase and utilize locally sourced foods by addressing critical distribution and infrastructure challenges. Currently, many small and mid-sized vendors in Massachusetts are limited to a single delivery location, which restricts the district's ability to procure local products for its 15 school sites. By adding a refrigerated vehicle, the district will be able to consolidate deliveries at a central location and distribute the products internally. This will ensure consistent and equitable access to local foods across all schools.

With improved distribution capacity, along with upgraded kitchen equipment that boosts production efficiency, the district will be able to increase its use of fresh, locally sourced ingredients in daily meal preparation. Consequently, the district anticipates a significant rise in local purchasing, including a projected 500% increase in local meat and a 400% increase in local produce.

Project Information

Capital infrastructure included in budget (check all that apply):

☐ Construction/renovation to a new or existing facility	☐	☐	☐
☐ Food storage nonperishable	☐ Food storage perishable	☐ Food safety improvement equipment	☐
☐ Kitchen/cooking equipment	☐	☐	☐
☐ Transportation vehicle	☐	☐	☐

Market or direct to consumer improvements (carts, counters, baskets, shelving, serving stands, tables, etc.)

Stage of food supply chain the **proposed project** will most directly impact (refers to specific project, not entire operation):

Markets/retail

Project Need & Alignment

Describe the problem or capacity gap your project addresses and explain why your proposed project is the right solution. Be sure to show clear alignment with the selected project type (Section B1) and identify who will benefit from the project.

The Public Schools of Brookline Food Services Department serves a diverse student population across 15 school sites, yet faces significant infrastructure and operational barriers that limit equitable access to school meals. At the Brookline High School (BHS) Greenough Campus, approximately 1,654 students are enrolled, but only about 500 students currently participate in daily meal service, demonstrating a substantial gap in access. This gap is driven in part by limited serving capacity, inefficient kitchen layout, and outdated equipment that restrict the program's ability to serve more students within short lunch periods.

At both BHS and Lincoln School, critical kitchen equipment is aging, frequently breaking down, and in some cases is no longer repairable. The district has incurred over \$10,000 in repair costs, yet these ongoing expenses do not resolve persistent performance issues. Equipment failures disrupt service, reduce production capacity, and limit the ability to expand scratch cooking, plant-based offerings, and culturally inclusive meals, including halal options.

In addition, the district faces a key supply chain constraint in procuring local food. Many small and mid-sized Massachusetts vendors lack the capacity to deliver to multiple locations and are currently limited to a single drop-off site. With 15 school sites across the district, this distribution barrier significantly limits the district's ability to scale local food purchasing and ensure equitable access to fresh, locally sourced products across all schools.

This project addresses these challenges through a comprehensive infrastructure investment: expanding serving line capacity and replacing failing equipment at BHS, upgrading unrepairable equipment at Lincoln School to increase production capacity, and purchasing a refrigerated vehicle to enable district-wide aggregation and distribution of local foods. The vehicle will allow the district to receive deliveries from local vendors at a central location and efficiently distribute products across all school sites, removing a critical barrier to local procurement.

The refrigerated vehicle will also support the district's ability to operate and expand Summer Eats meal sites, including in neighboring Boston communities, enabling multi-site meal distribution during the summer months when food insecurity often increases.

Together, these investments will significantly increase meal participation, improve production efficiency, expand access to culturally appropriate meals, and strengthen connections to Massachusetts-based food producers while building a more resilient and equitable school food system.

If applicable, describe how the project is incorporating, or will allow, multi-sector collaborations/partnerships, and how the collaborations/partnerships will strengthen the Massachusetts food system.

This project incorporates multiple partnerships that strengthen the Massachusetts food system by improving procurement, distribution, and educational alignment. The Public Schools of Brookline collaborates with regional and local food vendors, including Massachusetts-based farms, distributors, and food hubs that supply fresh produce, dairy, and value-added products for school meals.

The addition of a refrigerated transport vehicle will strengthen these partnerships by enabling more reliable aggregation and distribution of local foods, reducing logistical barriers that currently limit the volume of locally sourced products we can efficiently receive and store.

The district also collaborates with nutrition education partners, student wellness initiatives, and local community organizations that support food security and culturally inclusive meal programming. These partnerships ensure that infrastructure investments translate directly into improved meal access and increased utilization of local and regional food systems.

Together, these collaborations strengthen mid-scale supply chain capacity, increase institutional purchasing of local foods, and support Massachusetts producers by expanding stable, school-based markets.

What goals that have been identified in [Massachusetts Local Food Plan](#) does your project align with? Check all that apply.

Goal 1:	Goal 1: Increase production, sales and consumption of Massachusetts-grown foods.
Goal 2:	Goal 2: Create jobs and economic opportunity in food and farming, and improve the wages and skills of food system workers.
Goal 3:	Goal 3: Protect the land and water needed to produce food, maximize environmental benefits from agriculture and fishing, and ensure food safety.
Goal 4:	Goal 4: Reduce hunger and food insecurity, increase the availability of healthy food to all residents, and reduce food waste.

FOOD SECURITY OUTCOMES & IMPACTS

Clearly identify (by indicator number and description title) 2-5 expected performance outcomes (see Attachment C) that best align with the proposed project. Describe how the project will achieve each expected outcome measure within 1-3 years of project completion and provide realistic, project appropriate estimated metrics expressed as whole numbers. Reasonable estimates may be used when baseline data is unavailable.

Indicator 1: Increased participation in school meal programs

Within 1–3 years of project completion, expanded serving line capacity and improved serving capacity and equipment reliability, BHS is projected to increase daily participation from 500 to 800–1,000 students, significantly expanding access to nutritious meals.

Indicator 2: Increased access to culturally and diet-appropriate meals.

The project will expand the availability of kosher, halal, plant-based, and culturally inclusive meal options. The district anticipates offering 3–5 additional culturally specific menu items per cycle, improving dietary accommodation for an estimated 300–500 students daily with specific dietary needs.

Indicator 3: Increased procurement and distribution of local/regional foods

With refrigerated transport capacity, the district expects to increase local and regional food purchases by 10–15%, expanding from baseline procurement levels and improving integration with Massachusetts-based suppliers, such as New Entry, Boston Food Hub, Red's Best...

Indicator 4: Reduced energy consumption and operational inefficiencies.

Replacement of outdated kitchen equipment with energy-efficient systems is expected to reduce kitchen energy usage by approximately 10–25%, lowering long-term operational costs and greenhouse gas emissions.

Indicator 5: Improved food safety and cold chain integrity

The addition of refrigerated transportation and upgraded cold storage systems will reduce temperature compliance risks, achieving near 100% compliance in safe food transport standards across district deliveries.

Indicator 6: Expanded summer meal access (Summer Eats)

The addition of a refrigerated vehicle will enable the district to support multiple Summer Eats sites, including locations in Boston, increasing the number of meals served during the summer months. Within 1–3 years, the district anticipates expanding to 2–4 additional summer sites, serving an estimated 200–400 additional meals per day during peak summer operations.

Demonstrate how the project will increase equitable access to nutritious—preferably local and culturally relevant—food for under-resourced and underserved residents of the Commonwealth. For the purposes of this Program, under-resourced and underserved refers to communities or populations that face persistent barriers to accessing sufficient, affordable, nutritious, and culturally appropriate food due to limited financial, infrastructural, geographical, or institutional resources, as well as constraints related to food availability, distribution, transportation, or local food system capacity. Applicants are strongly encouraged to review community-level data and research, which is referenced in Section 4E of the RFR.

To receive full consideration, applicant should:

- Reference relevant community-level data and research to document need.
- Describe key characteristics of the population served (e.g., income, socioeconomic conditions, food access, English isolation).
- Explain the geographic relationship between the community served and the project site.
- Describe how the project will reach the intended population(s) and provide evidence of that pathway (e.g., distribution plans, partner commitments, service area descriptions, procurement agreements, or program participation data).

Applicants could also share if their organization or business itself will have any direct benefits for groups such as [historically underserved farmers and/or ranchers](#) and middle-of-the-supply chain small businesses owned by [socially disadvantaged individuals](#) (as defined by the Small Business Administration). Please provide information about any barriers you have faced accessing funding if applicable.

The Public Schools of Brookline serve a diverse student population. Brookline's student population reflects an increasing cultural and dietary diversity, including families requiring halal, kosher, vegetarian, vegan, and allergen-sensitive meal options. However, existing infrastructure limitations have constrained the district's ability to consistently meet this demand at scale.

This project directly improves equitable access by expanding serving capacity, reducing wait times, and increasing the availability of culturally appropriate meals. The infrastructure upgrades ensure that all students, regardless of income, language, or cultural background, have reliable access to nutritious meals that meet their dietary needs and preferences.

The refrigerated transportation component strengthens equity further by enabling the district to more efficiently distribute fresh and locally sourced foods across all schools. Currently, schools are limited by vendor delivery capacity, which can result in inconsistent availability of high-quality, local, and culturally relevant ingredients across sites.

By centralizing delivery and distributing food internally, the district will ensure that students across all 15 school sites benefit equally from improved food quality, expanded menu options, and increased access to local products.

The ability to support multiple Summer Eats sites, including in neighboring Boston communities, extends the impact of this project beyond the school year and beyond district boundaries. These sites often serve communities with higher rates of food insecurity, where access to free, nutritious meals is critical during the summer.

By enabling multi-site distribution, the project helps ensure that under-resourced children and families continue to receive consistent, culturally appropriate meals year-round, reducing seasonal gaps in food access.

If applicable, describe how the project incorporates resilience measures (e.g., backup power, flood protection, waste reduction) that protect food access during disruptions. If the project aligns with any of the objectives outlined in [ResilientMass](#), please demonstrate.

The addition of a refrigerated vehicle addresses a critical supply chain gap: many small and local farms lack the capacity to deliver to multiple school locations. The vehicle will enable the district to aggregate, transport, and distribute locally sourced products efficiently, increasing procurement from Massachusetts producers while ensuring safe, reliable delivery during vendor delays, supply chain disruptions, and extreme weather events.

Energy-efficient kitchen equipment will replace outdated systems that are prone to failure, improving operational reliability, reducing downtime, and ensuring continuity of meal service during peak demand periods.

Upgraded cold storage and expanded production capacity will allow for increased inventory buffering and safer food storage, enabling the district to maintain consistent meal availability during supply interruptions or emergency situations.

A distributed production model across Brookline High School and Lincoln School reduces single-point-of-failure risk by decentralizing meal preparation, increasing flexibility, and allowing sites to support one another during localized disruptions.

Additionally, improved production efficiency and storage capacity will contribute to waste reduction by enhancing inventory management, extending product usability, and minimizing spoilage.

The refrigerated vehicle also strengthens seasonal resilience by enabling the district to maintain meal distribution during the summer months through participation in the Summer Eats program. This expands the district's role in regional food access efforts and ensures continuity of service during periods when school-based infrastructure is not fully operational.

These investments align with ResilientMass objectives by strengthening local and regional food supply chains, improving infrastructure reliability, enhancing emergency preparedness, and ensuring continuity of critical food access services for students during climate-related and other disruptions.

FEASIBILITY OF PROJECT PLAN

Describe your operations' capacity and ability to administer the project. Please include details about key personnel, their responsibilities, and qualifications.

The Public Schools of Brookline Food Services Department has extensive experience managing large-scale food service operations, capital projects, and federally funded nutrition programs. The department currently serves thousands of meals daily across multiple school sites and maintains compliance with USDA National School Lunch Program requirements.

Key personnel include:

Food Service Director (Project Lead): Oversees project implementation, vendor coordination, and operational integration.

Assistant Directors and District Managers: Support procurement, scheduling, and school-level coordination.

Facilities and Maintenance Department: Provides technical oversight for installation, utilities, and equipment integration.

Finance Department: Manages budgeting, match documentation, and reimbursement submission.

The district has successfully completed prior infrastructure upgrades and is fully capable of administering procurement, installation, compliance tracking, and reporting requirements associated with FSIG funding.

Provide a comprehensive timeline of the tasks/activities associated with the project, including any local or state permitting required. Be sure to demonstrate that the project can be completed within the grant period time frame.

Month 1–2:

Finalize procurement specifications

Issue vendor solicitations and obtain bids

Select vendors and finalize contracts

Month 3–5:

Order kitchen equipment and refrigerated vehicle

Begin permitting and installation planning with facilities department

Month 6–9:

Equipment delivery and installation at BHS Greenough Campus

Installation of upgraded equipment at Lincoln School

Vehicle procurement and delivery

Month 10–12:

Staff training on new equipment and workflows

System testing and operational optimization

Project closeout reporting and evaluation

All activities are designed to be completed within the FSIG grant performance period.

This is a reimbursement grant program with a 20% cash match component. Describe how the project will be funded up-front and how a cash match will be provided.

The required 20% cash match (\$115,130.61) will be funded through the Public Schools of Brookline Food Services operating budget and approved capital reserve allocations. The district maintains sufficient financial capacity to front project costs before reimbursement.

Initial project expenditures will be covered through the district revolving account and capital planning funds. The Finance Department will manage cash flow to ensure compliance with reimbursement timelines and grant requirements.

SUSTAINABILITY & MAINTENANCE

Demonstrate how the investment will be maintained and continue to provide benefits beyond the contract period. Response should describe who will maintain the equipment/infrastructure, how ongoing costs will be covered, and how benefits (food access, distribution, or resilience outcomes) will be sustained over time.

The investments made through this project will be sustained through the Public Schools of Brookline Food Services annual operating budget and ongoing capital maintenance planning.

All kitchen equipment will be maintained by district facilities staff in coordination with vendor service agreements and preventative maintenance schedules. The refrigerated vehicle will be incorporated into the district's transportation maintenance program, including routine servicing, refrigeration system checks, and lifecycle replacement planning.

The refrigerated vehicle will become a permanent part of the district's food distribution system, supporting ongoing local procurement and efficient delivery across all school sites. By reducing reliance on vendor delivery capacity, the district will be able to maintain and expand relationships with local producers over time.

The vehicle will support year-round operations, including the Summer Eats program, maximizing its utilization and long-term value. By expanding summer meal service capacity, the district will increase participation in federally reimbursable programs, further supporting the financial sustainability of the food service program.

Combined with reduced repair costs and improved energy efficiency from new equipment, these investments will create a more sustainable, cost-effective, and resilient food service operation that continues to expand access to nutritious, locally sourced meals beyond the grant period.

Operational savings from reduced energy consumption and improved efficiency will help offset ongoing maintenance and utility costs. Increased meal participation and improved production efficiency will further strengthen the program's financial sustainability.

The expanded infrastructure will continue to support scratch cooking, culturally inclusive meals, and local food procurement beyond the grant period, ensuring long-term improvements in food access, quality, and system resilience.

Previous Funding

If your operation received any funding from the Food Security Infrastructure Grant before, provide the total amount of funding received and a brief (2-3 sentences) summary of the project's impact.

Total amount of funding received: No:

Project Impacts:

ATTESTATION

By signing this application, you attest all statements herein are accurate and true. By signing this application, you give permission to have a site visit by MDAR staff which may be necessary before a funding decision is made. All site visits will be arranged with you in advance.

Signature: Electronically Signed

Date: **5/4/2026 3:44:46 PM**

Print Name: **Irvett Perrin**



INSTRUCTIONS

The following Instructions, Contractor Certifications and the applicable Commonwealth Terms and Conditions are incorporated by reference into an executed Standard Contract Form. Instructions are provided to assist with completion of the Standard Contract Form. Additional terms are incorporated by reference. Links to legal citations are to unofficial versions and Departments and Contractors should consult with their legal counsel to ensure compliance with all legal requirements. Please note that not all applicable laws have been cited.

Contractor Legal Name (and D/B/A)

Enter the **Full Legal Name** of the Contractor's business as it appears on the Contractor's Form W-9 or Form W-4 (Contract Employees only) and the applicable Commonwealth Terms and Conditions. If Contractor also has a "doing business as" (d/b/a) name, BOTH the legal name and the "d/b/a" name must appear in this section.

Contractor Legal Address

Enter the Legal Address of the Contractor as it appears on the Contractor's Form W-9 or Form W-4 (Contract Employees only) which must match the legal address on the 1099I table in MMARS (or the Legal Address in HR/CMS for a Contract Employee).

Contractor Contract Manager

Enter the authorized Contract Manager who will be responsible for managing the Contract. The Contract Manager should be an Authorized Signatory, or, at a minimum, a person designated by the Contractor to represent the Contractor, receive legal notices and negotiate ongoing Contract issues. The Contract Manager is considered "Key Personnel" and may not be changed without the prior written approval of the Department. If the Contract is posted on COMMBUYS, the name of the Contract Manager must be included in the Contract on COMMBUYS.

Contractor Email Address/Phone/Fax

Enter the email address, phone and fax number of the Contractor Contract Manager. This information must be kept current by the Contractor to ensure that the Department can contact the Contractor and provide any required legal notices. Notice received by the Contract Manager (with confirmation of actual receipt) through the listed address, fax number(s) or email address will meet any written legal notice requirements.

Contractor Vendor Code

The Department must enter the MMARS Vendor Code assigned by the Commonwealth. If a Vendor Code has not yet been assigned, leave this space blank and the Department will complete this section when a Vendor Code has been assigned. The Department is responsible under the [Vendor File and Form W-9s Policy](#) for verifying with authorized signatories of the Contractor, as part of contract execution, that the legal name, address and Federal Tax Identification Number (TIN) in the Contract documents match the state accounting system.

Vendor Code Address ID

(e.g., "AD001") The Department must enter the MMARS Vendor Code Address ID identifying the payment remittance address for Contract payments, which **MUST** be set up for Electronic Funds Transfer (EFT) payments PRIOR to the first payment under the Contract in accordance with the [Bill Payments](#) and [Vendor/Customer File and Form W-9](#) Policies.

Commonwealth Department Name

Enter the full Department name with the authority to obligate funds encumbered for the Contract.

Commonwealth MMARS Alpha Department Code

Enter the three (3) letter MMARS Code assigned to this Commonwealth Department in the state accounting system.

Department Business Mailing Address

Enter the address where all formal correspondence to the Department must be sent. Unless otherwise specified in the Contract, legal notice sent or received by the Department's Contract Manager (with confirmation of actual receipt) through the listed address, fax number(s) or email address for the Contract Manager will meet any requirements for legal notice.

Department Billing Address

Enter the Billing Address or email address if invoices must be sent to a different location. Billing, confirmation of delivery or performance issues should be resolved through the listed Contract Managers.

Department Contract Manager

Identify the authorized Contract Manager who will be responsible for managing the Contract, who should be an authorized signatory, or an employee designated by the Department to represent the Department to receive legal notices and negotiate ongoing Contract issues.

Department Email Address/Phone/Fax

Enter the email address, phone and fax number of the Department Contract Manager. Unless otherwise specified in the Contract, legal

notice sent or received by the Contract Manager (with confirmation of actual receipt) through the listed address, fax number(s) or e-mail address will meet any requirements for written notice under the Contract.

MMARS Document ID(s)

Enter the MMARS 20-character encumbrance transaction number associated with this Contract, which must remain the same for the life of the Contract. If multiple numbers exist for this Contract, identify all Document IDs.

RFR/Procurement or Other ID Number or Name

Enter the Request for Response (RFR) or other Procurement Reference number, Contract ID Number or other reference or tracking number for this Contract or Amendment which will be entered into the Board Award Field in the MMARS encumbrance transaction for this Contract.

NEW CONTRACTS (Left Side of Form)

Complete this section ONLY if this Contract is brand new, or to enter into an Interim Contract with a new Contractor when a current Contractor is unable to complete full performance under a Contract. (Complete the **CONTRACT AMENDMENT** section for any material changes to an existing or an expired Contract, to enter into an Interim Contract with a current Contractor, and for exercising options to renew or annual contracts under a multi-year procurement or grant program.)

Procurement or Exception Type

Check the appropriate type of procurement or exception for this Contract. Only one option can be selected. See the Office of the Comptroller Guidance for Vendors Policies (State Finance Law and General Requirements, Acquisition Policy and Fixed Assets) and the Operational Services Division Conducting Best Value Procurements Handbook for details.

Statewide Contract (OSD or an OSD-designated Department)

Check this option for a Statewide Contract under the Operational Services Division (OSD), or by an OSD-designated Department.

Collective Purchase approved by OSD

Check this option for Contracts approved by the Operational Services Division (OSD) for collective purchases through federal, state, or local government or other entities.

Department Procurement

Check this option for a Department contract procurement including state grants and federal sub-grants under [815 CMR 2.00](#) and State Grants and Federal Subgrants Policy, Departmental Master Agreements (MA). If this is a multi-Department user Contract, state that multi-Department use is allowable in the section labeled "Brief Description."

Emergency Contract

Check this option when the Department has determined that an unforeseen crisis or incident has arisen which requires or mandates immediate purchases to avoid substantial harm to the functioning of government, the provision of necessary or mandated services, or where the health, welfare or safety of clients or other persons or serious damage to property is threatened.

Contract Employee

Check this option when the Department requires the performance of an Individual Contractor, and when the planned Contract performance with an Individual has been classified using the Employment Status Form (prior to the Contractor's selection) as work of a Contract Employee and not that of an Independent Contractor.

Interim Contracts

Check this option for an Interim Contract with a new Contractor whenever an existing Contract has been or will be terminated or suspended for any reason or whenever a current Contractor is unable to complete full performance under a Contract. An Interim Contract may be offered to the bidder that offered the next Best Value response under the original procurement and under the same terms and prices offered in that bidder's original response. The duration of an Interim Contract shall be limited to the remaining time available under the duration stated in the original RFR, including any options to renew. If the Department is unable to negotiate a Contract with any of the original bidders who submitted responses, in their original rank order according to Best Value, and under the same terms as offered in their original response, the Department will be required to conduct a new competitive procurement.

Other Procurement Exception

Check this option when another procurement exception exists, such as legislation with specific language naming the Contractor as a recipient of a grant or contract, an existing legal obligation, a prohibition or other circumstance that exempts or prohibits a Contract from being competitively procured, or identify any other procurement exception not already listed.

Legislative "earmarks" exempt the Contract solely from procurement requirements; all other Contract and state finance laws and policies apply. Supporting documentation must be attached to explain and justify the exemption.

CONTRACT AMENDMENT (Right Side of Form)

Complete this section for any Contract being renewed or amended or to enter into an Interim Contract with a current Contractor when a new procurement will not be completed prior to the expiration of the current Contract. All Contracts with available options to renew must be amended referencing the original procurement and Contract Document IDs, since all continuing contracts must be maintained in the same Contract file (even if the underlying appropriation changes each fiscal year). See "Amendments, Suspensions, and Termination Policy."

Enter Current Contract End Date

Enter the termination date of the Current Contract being amended, even if this date has already passed. (Note: Current Start Date is not requested since this date does not change and is already recorded in MMARS.)

Enter Amendment Amount

Enter the amount of the Amendment increase or decrease to a Maximum Obligation Contract. Enter "no change" for Rate Contracts or if there is no change.

Amendment Type

Identify the type of Amendment being made. Documentation supporting the updates to performance and budget must be attached.

Amendment to Date, Scope or Budget

Check this option when renewing a Contract or executing an Amendment ("material change" in Contract terms) even if the Contract has lapsed. The parties may negotiate a change in any element of Contract performance or cost identified in the RFR or the Contractor's response which results in lower costs, or a more cost-effective or better value performance than was presented in the original selected response, provided the negotiation results in a better value within the scope of the RFR than what was proposed by the Contractor in the original selected response. Any "material change" in the Contract terms must be memorialized in a formal Amendment even if a corresponding MMARS transaction is not needed to support the change.

Additional negotiated terms will take precedence over the relevant terms in the RFR and the Contractor's Response only if made using the process outlined in [801 CMR 21.07](#), incorporated herein, provided that any amended RFR or Response terms result in best value, lower costs, or a more cost effective Contract.

Interim Contracts

Check this option for an Interim Contract with a current Contractor when a new competitive procurement has been commenced, but due to an unanticipated delay, has not been completed prior to the end of the duration available under the current Contract, as specified in that Contract's original RFR. An Interim Contract may be used to extend the current Contract under the same terms and conditions only for the period necessary to complete the competitive procurement, including the execution of new Contracts.

Contract Employee

Check this option when the Department requires a renewal or other amendment to the performance of a Contract Employee.

Other Procurement Exception

Check this option when another procurement exception exists, such as legislation with specific language naming the Contractor as a recipient of a grant or contract; an existing legal obligation; a prohibition or other circumstance that exempts or prohibits a Contract from being competitively procured, or identify any other procurement exception not already listed. Legislative "earmarks" exempt the Contract solely from procurement requirements, and all other Contract and state finance laws and policies apply. Attach Supporting documentation to explain and justify the exemption and whether Contractor selection has been publicly posted.

COMMONWEALTH TERMS AND CONDITIONS

Identify which version of the Commonwealth Terms and Conditions is incorporated by reference into this Contract: the [Commonwealth Terms and Conditions](#), the [Commonwealth IT Terms and Conditions](#), or the [Commonwealth Terms and Conditions for Human and Social Services](#). The [Expenditure Classification Handbook](#) identifies the applicable Commonwealth Terms and Conditions based upon the object code for the contract.

COMPENSATION

Identify if the Contract is a **Rate Contract** (with no stated Maximum Obligation) or a **Maximum Obligation Contract** (with a stated Maximum Obligation) and identify the Maximum Obligation. If the Contract is being amended, enter the new Maximum Obligation based upon the increase or decrease to the Maximum Obligation. The Total Maximum Obligation must reflect the total funding for the dates of service under the contract, including the Amendment amount if the Contract is being amended. The Maximum Obligation must match the MMARS encumbrance. Funding and allotments must be verified as available and encumbered prior to incurring obligations. If a Contract includes both a Maximum Obligation component and Rate Contract component, check off both. Specific Maximum Obligation amounts or amended amounts and Attachments must clearly outline the Contract breakdown to match the encumbrance.

PROMPT PAY DISCOUNTS

Payments are processed within a 45-day payment cycle through Electronic Funds Transfer (EFT), in accordance with the Commonwealth [Bill Payments Policy](#) for investment and cash flow purposes. Departments may NOT negotiate accelerated payments and Payees are NOT entitled to accelerated payments UNLESS a Prompt Payment Discount (PPD) is provided to support the Commonwealth's loss of investment earnings for this earlier payment, or unless a payment is legally mandated to be made in less than 45 days (e.g., construction contracts, Ready Payments under [M.G.L. c. 29, § 23A](#)). See [Prompt Pay Discounts Policy](#). PPD are identified as a percentage discount which will be automatically deducted when an accelerated payment is made. Reduced contracts rates may not be negotiated to replace a PPD. If PPD fields are left blank, please identify that the Contractor agrees to the standard 45 day cycle, a statutory/legal exemption such as Ready Payments ([M.G.L. c. 29, § 23A](#)), or only an initial accelerated payment for reimbursements or startup costs for a grant, with subsequent payments scheduled to support standard EFT 45 day payment cycle. Financial hardship is not a sufficient justification to accelerate cash flow for *all* payments under a Contract. Initial grant or contract payments may be accelerated for the *first* invoice or initial grant installment, but subsequent periodic installments or invoice payments should be scheduled to support the Payee cash flow needs and the standard 45-day EFT payment cycle, in accordance with the [Bill Payments Policy](#). Any accelerated payment that does not provide for a PPD must have a legal justification in the Contract file for audit purposes explaining why accelerated payments were allowable without a PPD.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF CONTRACT PERFORMANCE

Enter a brief description of the Contract performance, project name or other identifying information for the Contract to specifically identify the Contract performance, match the Contract with attachments, determine the appropriate expenditure code (as listed in the [Expenditure Classification Handbook](#)) or to identify or clarify important information related to the Contract such as the Fiscal Year(s) of performance (ex. "FY2025" or "FY2025-27"). Identify settlements or other exceptions and attach more detailed justification and supporting documents. Enter "Multi-Department Use" if other Departments can access the procurement. For Amendments, identify the purpose and what items are being amended. Merely stating "see attached" or referencing attachments without a narrative description of performance is insufficient.

SUPPLIER DIVERSITY PROGRAM (SDP) PLAN

Check "YES" if the contract is subject to the requirements of the Supplier Diversity Program (SDP) as described in the [Diverse and Small Business Program Policies for Goods and Services Procurements](#) (and, as applicable, the [SDP Policy for Purchase of Service \(POS\) Procurements and Contracts Policy Overview](#)). Also check "YES" if the contracting department has voluntarily included SDP terms in the procurement. Generally, goods and services contracts with an estimated annual value of \$250,000 or more, averaged over the life of the contract, executed by Executive Departments as defined by [M.G.L. c. 6A, § 2](#), are subject to these policies. Check "NO" if the contract is not subject to these policies and no SDP terms were included voluntarily. If YES, enter the Contractor's annual SDP commitment. This commitment is a percentage of sales from the resulting contract to be spent with Certified Partner(s), which must be at least 1%. If the contract will be for the purchase of human and social services (referred to as Purchase of Service or POS) covering a variety of client health care, medical, and non-health care services, then enter the dollar amount commitment for the organization. If NO, and the Department is an Executive Department, enter the appropriate exemption from the "Procurements and Contracts Exempt from this Policy" section of the [Diverse and Small Business Program Policies for Goods and Services Procurements](#) to explain why the SDP is not applicable to this contract.

ANTICIPATED START DATE

The Department and Contractor must certify when obligations under this Contract/Amendment may be incurred. Option 1 is the default option when performance may begin as of the Effective Date (latest signature date and any required approvals). If the parties want a new Contract or renewal to begin as of the upcoming fiscal year, then list the fiscal year(s) (ex. "FY2025" or "FY2025-27") in the Brief Description section. Performance starts and encumbrances reflect the default Effective Date (if no Fiscal Year is listed) or the later Fiscal Year start date (if a Fiscal Year is listed). Use Option 2 only when the Contract will be signed well in advance of the start date and identify a specific future start date. Do not use Option 2 for a fiscal year start unless it is certain that the Contract will be signed prior to the fiscal year. Option 3 is used in lieu of the Settlement and Release Form when the Contract/Amendment is signed late, and obligations are incurred by the Contractor prior to the Effective Date, which the Department has either requested, accepted, or deemed legally eligible for reimbursement, and the Contract includes supporting documents justifying the performance or proof of eligibility and approximate costs. Any obligations incurred outside the scope of the Effective Date under any Option listed, even if the incorrect Option is selected, shall be automatically deemed a settlement included under the terms of the Contract and upon payment to the Contractor will release the Commonwealth from further obligations for the identified performance. All settlement payments require justification and must be under the same encumbrance and object codes as the Contract payments. Performance dates are subject to [M.G.L. c. 4, § 9](#).

CONTRACT END DATE

The Department must enter the date that Contract performance will terminate. **If the Contract is being amended and the Contract End Date is not changing, this date must be entered again here.** A Contract must be signed for at least the initial duration but not longer than the period of procurement listed in the RFR, or other solicitation document (if applicable). No new performance is allowable beyond

the end date without an amendment, but the Department may allow a Contractor to complete minimal close out performance obligations if substantial performance has been made prior to the termination date of the Contract and prior to the end of the fiscal year in which payments are appropriated, provided that close out performance is subject to appropriation and funding limits under state finance law, and the Office of the Comptroller may adjust encumbrances and payments in the state accounting system to enable final close out payments. Performance dates are subject to [M.G.L. c. 4, § 9](#).

CONTRACTOR AUTHORIZED SIGNATORIES FOR EXECUTION

See the Office of the Comptroller [Department Head Signature Authorization](#) and [Contractor Authorized Signatory Listing](#) Policies for guidance.

Authorizing Signature for Contractor/Date

The Authorized Contractor Signatory must sign and enter the date the Contract is signed. See section above under “Anticipated Contract Start Date.” **Rubber stamps are not acceptable.** Acceptance of payment by the Contractor shall waive any right of the Contractor to claim the Contract/Amendment is not valid and the Contractor may not void the Contract. Proof of signature authorization on a **Contractor Authorized Signatory Listing** may be required by the Department if not already on file. See [Contract and ISA Execution after the COVID-19 State of Emergency](#).

Contractor Name/Title

The Contractor Authorized Signatory’s name and title must appear legibly as it appears on the **Contractor Authorized Signatory Listing**.

Authorizing Signature For Commonwealth/Date

The Authorized Department Signatory must sign and enter the date the Contract is signed. See section above under “Anticipated Start Date.” **Rubber stamps are not acceptable.** The Authorized Signatory must be an employee within the Department legally responsible for the Contract. See Department Head Signature Authorization. The Department must have the legislative funding appropriated for all the costs of this Contract or funding allocated under an approved Interdepartmental Service Agreement (ISA). A Department may not contract for performance to be delivered to or by another state department without specific legislative authorization (unless this Contract is a Statewide Contract). For Contracts requiring Secretariat signoff, evidence of Secretariat signoff must be included in the Contract file.

Department Name/Title

Legibly enter Authorized Signatory’s name and title.

CONTRACTOR CERTIFICATIONS AND LEGAL REFERENCES

Notwithstanding verbal or other representations by the parties, the “Effective Date” of this Contract or Amendment shall be the latest date that this Contract or Amendment has been executed by an authorized signatory of the Contractor, the Department, or a later Contract or Amendment Start Date specified, subject to any required approvals. The Contractor makes all certifications required under this Contract under the pains and penalties of perjury and agrees to provide any required documentation upon request to support compliance, and agrees that all terms governing performance of this Contract and doing business in Massachusetts are attached or incorporated by reference herein.

Commonwealth and Contractor Ownership Rights

The Contractor certifies and agrees that the Commonwealth is entitled to ownership and possession of all “deliverables” purchased or developed with Contract funds. A Department may not relinquish Commonwealth rights to deliverables nor may Contractors sell products developed with Commonwealth resources without just compensation. The Contract should detail all Commonwealth deliverables and ownership rights and any Contractor proprietary rights.

Qualifications

The Contractor certifies that it is qualified and shall at all times remain qualified to perform this Contract, and that performance shall be timely and meet or exceed industry standards for the performance required, which includes obtaining requisite licenses, registrations, permits, resources for performance, and sufficient professional, liability, and other appropriate insurance to cover the performance. If the Contractor is a business, the Contractor certifies that it is listed under the Secretary of State’s website as licensed to do business in Massachusetts, as required by law.

Laws and Regulations Prohibiting Discrimination and Human Trafficking

Contractors acknowledge and certify as a condition of this Contract that they are responsible for complying fully with all state and federal laws prohibiting discrimination, human trafficking, and forced labor, including but not limited to [M.G.L. c. 265 §§ 49-57](#).

Business Ethics and Fraud, Waste and Abuse Prevention

The Contractor certifies that performance under this Contract, in addition to meeting the terms of the Contract, will be made using ethical business standards and good stewardship of taxpayer and other public funding and resources to prevent fraud, waste and abuse.

Collusion

The Contractor certifies that this Contract has been offered in good faith and without collusion, fraud, or unfair trade practices with any other person, and that any actions to avoid or frustrate fair and open competition are prohibited by law and shall be grounds for rejection or disqualification of a Response or termination of this Contract.

Public Records and Access

The Contractor shall provide full access to records related to performance and compliance to the Department and officials listed under [Executive Order 195](#) and [M.G.L. c. 11, § 12](#) for six (6) years beginning on the first day after the final payment under this Contract or such longer period as necessary for the resolution of any litigation, claim, negotiation, audit or other inquiry involving this Contract. Access to view Contractor records related to any breach or allegation of fraud, waste and/or abuse may not be denied and Contractor cannot claim confidentiality or trade secret protections solely for viewing but not retaining documents. Routine Contract performance compliance reports or documents related to any alleged breach or allegation of non-compliance, fraud, waste, abuse or collusion may be provided electronically and shall be provided at Contractor's own expense. Reasonable costs for copies of non-routine Contract related records shall not exceed the rates for public records under [950 CMR 32.00](#).

Debarment

The Contractor certifies that neither it nor any of its subcontractors are currently debarred or suspended by the federal or state government under any law or regulation including [Executive Order 147](#); [M.G.L. c. 29, § 29F](#); [M.G.L. c. 30, § 39R](#); [M.G.L. c. 149 §§ 27C, 44C](#) and [148B](#); and [M.G.L. c. 152, § 25C](#).

Applicable Laws

The Contractor shall comply with all applicable state laws and regulations including, but not limited to, the Massachusetts General Laws; the Official Code of Massachusetts Regulations; Code of Massachusetts Regulations (unofficial); [801 CMR 21.00](#) (Procurement of Commodity and Service Procurements, Including Human and Social Services); [815 CMR 2.00](#) (Grants and Subsidies); [808 CMR 1.00](#) (Compliance, Reporting and Auditing for Human And Social Services); AICPA Standards; confidentiality of Department records under [M.G.L. c. 66A](#); and the [Massachusetts Constitution Article XVIII](#), if applicable.

Invoices

The Contractor must submit invoices in accordance with the terms of the Contract and the Commonwealth [Bill Payments](#) Policy. Contractors must be able to reconcile and properly attribute concurrent payments from multiple Departments. Final invoices in any fiscal year must be submitted no later than August 15 for performance made and received (goods delivered, services completed) prior to June 30, in order to make payment for that performance prior to the close of the fiscal year to prevent reversion of appropriated funds. Failure to submit timely invoices by August 15 or other date listed in the Contract shall authorize the Department to issue an estimated payment based upon the Department's determination of performance delivered and accepted. The Contractor's acceptance of an estimated payment releases the Commonwealth from further claims for these invoices. **If budgetary funds revert due to the Contractor's failure to submit timely final invoices, or for disputing an estimated payment, the Department may deduct a penalty of up to 10% from any final payment in the next fiscal year for failure to submit timely invoices.**

Payments Subject To Appropriation

Pursuant to [M.G.L. c. 29 §§ 26, 27](#) and [29](#), Departments are required to expend funds only for the purposes set forth by the Legislature and within the funding limits established through appropriation, allotment and subsidiary, including mandated allotment reductions triggered by [M.G.L. c. 29, § 9C](#). A Department cannot authorize or accept performance in excess of an existing appropriation and allotment, or sufficient non-appropriated available funds. Any oral or written representations, commitments, or assurances made by the Department or any other Commonwealth representative are not binding. The Commonwealth has no legal obligation to compensate a Contractor for performance that is not requested and is intentionally delivered by a Contractor outside the scope of a Contract. Contractors should verify funding prior to beginning performance.

Intercept

Contractors may be registered as Customers in the Vendor file if the Contractor owes a Commonwealth debt. Unresolved and undisputed debts, and overpayments of Contract payments that are not reimbursed timely shall be subject to intercept pursuant to [M.G.L. c. 7A, § 3](#) and [815 CMR 9.00](#). Contract overpayments will be subject to immediate intercept or payment offset. The Contractor may not penalize any state Department or assess late fees, cancel a Contract or other services if amounts are intercepted or offset due to recoupment of an overpayment, outstanding taxes, child support, other overdue debts or Contract overpayments.

Tax Law Compliance

The Contractor certifies under the pains and penalties of perjury: (1) tax compliance with federal tax laws; (2) tax compliance with state tax laws including, but not limited to, [M.G.L. c. 62C, § 49A](#), reporting of employees and contractors, withholding and remitting of tax withholdings and child support; and (3) Contractor is in good standing with respect to all state taxes and returns due, reporting of employees and contractors under [M.G.L. c. 62E](#), withholding and remitting child support including [M.G.L. c. 119A, § 12](#), [TIR 05-11, New Independent Contractor Provisions](#), and applicable TIRs.

Bankruptcy, Judgments, Potential Structural Changes, Pending Legal Matters and Conflicts

The Contractor certifies it has not been in bankruptcy or receivership within the last three calendar years which would negatively impact Contractor's ability to fulfill the terms of this Contract or Amendment. Contractor certifies that it will immediately notify the Department, in writing, of any filing for bankruptcy and/or receivership, any potential structural change in its organization, or if there is **any risk** to the solvency of the Contractor that may impact the Contractor's ability to timely fulfill the terms of this Contract or Amendment. The Commonwealth reserves the right to request additional information regarding the financial viability of the Contractor and its ability to perform. The Contractor certifies that at any time during the period of the Contract the Contractor is required to affirmatively disclose in writing to the Department Contract Manager the details of any judgment, criminal conviction, investigation or litigation pending against the Contractor or any of its officers, directors, employees, agents, or subcontractors, including any potential conflicts of interest of which the Contractor has knowledge, or learns of during the Contract term. Law firms or Attorneys providing legal services are required to identify any potential conflict with representation of any Department client in accordance with Massachusetts Board of Bar Overseers (BBO) rules.

Federal Anti-Lobbying and Other Federal Requirements

If receiving federal funds, the Contractor certifies compliance with federal anti-lobbying requirements including 31 USC § 1352; other federal requirements; Federal Executive Order 11246; Air Pollution Act; Federal Water Pollution Control Act and Federal Employment Laws.

Protection of Commonwealth Data, Personal Data and Information

The Contractor certifies that all steps will be taken to ensure the security and confidentiality of all Commonwealth data for which the Contractor becomes a holder, either as part of performance or inadvertently during performance, with special attention to restricting access, use and disbursement of personal data and information under [M.G.L. c. 93H](#) and [c. 66A](#) and other applicable state and federal privacy requirements. The Contractor shall comply with [M.G.L. c. 93I](#) for the proper disposal of all paper and electronic media, backups or systems containing personal data and information. The Contractor shall also ensure that any personal data or information transmitted electronically or through a portable device is properly encrypted using (at a minimum) the Commonwealth's "Cryptographic Management Standard" set forth in the Enterprise Information Security Policies and Standards published by the Executive Office for Technology, Services and Security (EOTSS), or a comparable Standard prescribed by the Department. Contractors with access to credit card or banking information of Commonwealth customers certify that the Contractor is PCI compliant in accordance with the Payment Card Industry Council Standards and shall provide confirmation of compliance during the Contract. The Contractor shall immediately notify the Department in the event of any security breach, including the unauthorized access, disbursement, use or disposal of personal data or information and, in the event of a security breach, the Contractor shall cooperate fully with the Commonwealth and provide access to any information necessary for the Commonwealth to respond to the security breach and shall be fully responsible for any damages associated with the Contractor's breach including, but not limited to, damages under [M.G.L. c. 214, § 3B](#).

For all Contracts involving the Contractor's access to personal information, as defined in [M.G.L. c. 93H](#), and personal data, as defined in [M.G.L. c. 66A](#), or access to Department systems containing such information or data, Contractor certifies under the pains and penalties of perjury that the Contractor: (1) has read [M.G.L. c. 93H](#) and [c. 66A](#) and agrees to protect any and all personal information and personal data; and (2) has reviewed all of the Enterprise Information Security Policies and Standards published by the Executive Office for Technology, Services and Security (EOTSS), or stricter standards prescribed by the Department. Notwithstanding any contractual provision to the contrary, in connection with the Contractor's performance under this Contract, for all Departments, including all offices, boards, commissions, agencies, departments, divisions, councils, bureaus, and offices, now existing and hereafter established, the Contractor shall: (1) obtain a copy, review, and comply with any pertinent security guidelines, standards, and policies; (2) comply with the Enterprise Information Security Policies and Standards published by the Executive Office for Technology Services and Security (EOTSS), or a comparable set of policies and standards ("Information Security Policy") as prescribed by the Department; (3) communicate and enforce such security guidelines, standards, policies and the applicable Information Security Policy among all employees (whether such employees are direct or contracted) and subcontractors; (4) implement and maintain any other reasonable appropriate security procedures and practices necessary to protect personal information and data to which the Contractor is given access by the contracting Department from the unauthorized access, destruction, use, modification, disclosure or loss; (5) be responsible for the full or partial breach of any of these terms by its employees (whether such employees are direct or contracted) or subcontractors during or after the term of this Contract, and any breach of these terms may be regarded as a material breach of this Contract; (6) in the event of any unauthorized access, destruction, use, modification, disclosure or loss of the personal information or personal data (collectively referred to as the "unauthorized use"): (a) immediately notify the contracting Department if the Contractor becomes aware of the unauthorized use; (b) provide full cooperation and access to information necessary for the contracting Department to determine the scope of the unauthorized use; and (c) provide full cooperation and access to information necessary for the contracting Department and the Contractor to fulfill any notification requirements. Breach of these terms may be regarded as a material breach of this Contract, such that the Commonwealth may exercise any and all contractual rights and remedies, including, without limitation, indemnification, withholding of payments, Contract suspension, or termination, pursuant to the [Commonwealth's Terms and Conditions](#), the [Commonwealth IT Terms and Conditions](#), or the [Commonwealth Terms and Conditions for Human and Social Services](#). In addition, the Contractor may be subject to applicable statutory or regulatory penalties, including, and without limitation, those imposed pursuant to [M.G.L. c. 93H](#) and under [M.G.L. c. 214, § 3B](#) for violations under [M.G.L. c. 66A](#).

Corporate and Business Filings and Reports

The Contractor certifies compliance with all certification, filing, reporting and service of process requirements of the Secretary of the Commonwealth, the Office of the Attorney General or other Departments related to its conduct of business in the Commonwealth, and with relevant requirements of its incorporating state (or foreign entity).

Employer Requirements

Contractors that are employers certify compliance with applicable state and federal employment laws and regulations, including but not limited to prevailing wage laws at [M.G.L. c. 149, §§ 26-27D](#) (public construction work); [M.G.L. c. 149, § 27F](#) (use of trucks, vehicles and other equipment to perform public works functions); [M.G.L. c. 149, § 27G](#) (moving office furniture and fixtures); [M.G.L. c. 149, § 27H](#) (cleaning state office buildings or buildings leased by the state); [M.G.L. c. 6C, § 44](#) (MassDOT relocation of utilities or utility facility); [M.G.L. c. 7, § 22](#) (contracts for meat products and clothing and apparel); [M.G.L. c. 71, § 7A](#) (transportation of students to public schools); [Chapter 195 of the Acts of 2014](#) (MA Convention Center Authority security guard services); minimum wage and overtime law and regulations ([M.G.L. c. 151](#) and [454 CMR 27.00](#)); child labor laws ([M.G.L. c. 149, §§ 56-105](#)); all payment of wages, payroll and timekeeping records, earned sick time, meal breaks, domestic violence leave, temporary worker rights, domestic worker rights and anti-retaliation laws at [M.G.L. c. 149](#) (Labor and Industries); [M.G.L. c. 151A](#) (unemployment insurance and contributions); [M.G.L. c. 152](#) (workers compensation and insurance); [M.G.L. c. 150A](#) (Labor Relations); [M.G.L. c. 153](#) (liability for injuries); 29 U.S.C. c. 8 (Federal Fair Labor Standards); 29 U.S.C. c. 28 (Federal Family and Medical Leave Act); [M.G.L. c. 6, § 171A](#) (applicant criminal record information); [M.G.L. c. 149, § 105A](#) (MA Equal Pay Act); and [M.G.L. c. 175M](#) (Paid Family Medical Leave Act).

Federal And State Laws And Regulations Prohibiting Discrimination

Contractors certify compliance with applicable state and federal anti-discrimination laws, including but not limited to the Federal Equal Employment (EEO) Laws; the Americans with Disabilities Act; 42 U.S.C § 12101, et seq., the Rehabilitation Act, 29 U.S.C. § 794; 29 U.S.C. § 701; 29 U.S.C. § 623; 42 U.S.C. c. 45; (Federal Fair Housing Act); [M.G.L. c. 151B](#) (Unlawful Discrimination); [M.G.L. c. 151E](#) (Business Discrimination); the Public Accommodations Law [M.G.L. c. 272, § 92A](#); [M.G.L. c. 272, §§ 98 and 98A](#), [Massachusetts Constitution Article CXIV](#) and [M.G.L. c. 93, § 103](#); 47 USC § 255 (Telecommunication Act); [M.G.L. c. 149, § 105D](#), [M.G.L. c. 151C](#), [M.G.L. c. 272, §§ 92A, 98 and 98A](#), and [M.G.L. c. 111, § 199A](#), and Massachusetts Disability-Based Non-Discrimination Standards For Executive Branch Entities, and related Standards and Guidance, authorized under Massachusetts Executive Order or any disability-based protection arising from state or federal law or precedent. See also Massachusetts Commission Against Discrimination (MCAD) and MCAD links and resources.

Small Business Purchasing Program (SBPP)

A Contractor may be eligible to participate in the SBPP, pursuant to [Executive Order 599](#), and [M.G.L. c. 7 § 58](#) if so qualified.

Limitation of Liability

Contracts may not use the following limitation of liability language unless approved by legal staff at the Office of the Comptroller or Operational Services Division, and it may not be used if a Department is utilizing the Commonwealth IT Terms and Conditions. The term "other damages" in Section 11 of the Commonwealth Terms and Conditions, "Indemnification," shall include, but shall not be limited to, the reasonable costs the Commonwealth incurs to repair, return, replace or seek cover (purchase comparable substitute commodities and services) under a Contract. "Other damages" shall not include damages to the Commonwealth as a result of third-party claims, provided, that this in no way limits the Commonwealth's right of recovery for personal injury or property damages or patent and copyright infringement under Section 11 or the Commonwealth's ability to join the contractor as a third-party defendant. Further, the term "other damages" shall not include, and in no event shall the contractor be liable for, damages for the Commonwealth's use of contractor provided products or services, loss of Commonwealth records, or data (or other intangible property), loss of use of equipment, lost revenue, lost savings or lost profits of the Commonwealth. In no event shall "other damages" exceed the greater of \$100,000, or two times the value of the product or service (as defined in the Contract scope of work) that is the subject of the claim. Section 11 sets forth the Contractor's entire liability under a Contract. Nothing in this section shall limit the Commonwealth's ability to negotiate higher limitations of liability in a particular Contract, provided that any such limitation must specifically reference Section 11 of the Commonwealth Terms and Conditions. In the event the limitation of liability conflicts with auditing standards which mandate that there can be no cap of damages, the limitation shall be considered waived for that audit engagement. The terms in this Clarification may not be modified.

Northern Ireland Certification

Pursuant to [M.G.L. c. 7, § 22C](#), for state agencies, state authorities, the state House of Representatives or the state Senate, by signing this Contract the Contractor certifies that it does not employ ten or more employees in an office or other facility in Northern Ireland or if the Contractor employs ten or more employees in an office or other facility located in Northern Ireland the Contractor certifies that it does not discriminate in employment, compensation, or the terms, conditions and privileges of employment on account of religious or political belief, and certifies that it promotes religious tolerance within the work place, and the eradication of any manifestations of religious and other illegal discrimination; and the Contractor is not engaged in the manufacture, distribution or sale of firearms, munitions, including rubber or plastic bullets, tear gas, armored vehicles or military aircraft for use or deployment in any activity in Northern Ireland.

Pandemic, Disaster or Emergency Performance

In the event of a serious emergency, pandemic or disaster outside the control of the Department, the Department may negotiate emergency performance from the Contractor to address the immediate needs of the Commonwealth even if not contemplated under the original Contract or procurement. Payments are subject to appropriation and other payment terms.

Attorneys

Attorneys or firms providing legal services or representing Commonwealth Departments may be subject to [M.G.L. c. 30, § 65](#), and if providing litigation services must be approved by the Office of the Attorney General to appear on behalf of a Department, and shall have a continuing obligation to notify the Commonwealth of any conflicts of interest arising under the Contract.

Subcontractor Performance

The Contractor certifies full responsibility for Contract performance, including subcontractors, and that comparable Contract terms will be included in subcontracts, and that the Department will not be required to directly or indirectly manage subcontractors or have any payment obligations to subcontractors.

EXECUTIVE ORDERS

For covered Executive Departments, the Contractor certifies compliance with applicable Massachusetts Executive Orders including, but not limited to, the specific orders listed below. A breach during the period of a Contract may be considered a material breach and subject Contractor to appropriate monetary or Contract sanctions.

Executive Order 481. Prohibiting the Use of Undocumented Workers on State Contracts

For all state agencies in the Executive Branch, including all executive offices, boards, commissions, agencies, Departments, divisions, councils, bureaus, and offices, now existing and hereafter established, by signing this Contract the Contractor certifies under the pains and penalties of perjury that they shall not knowingly use undocumented workers in connection with the performance of this Contract; that, pursuant to federal requirements, they shall verify the immigration status of workers assigned to a Contract without engaging in unlawful discrimination; and shall not knowingly or recklessly alter, falsify, or accept altered or falsified documents from any such worker.

Executive Order 130. Anti-Boycott

The Contractor warrants, represents and agrees that during the time this Contract is in effect, neither it nor any affiliated company, as hereafter defined, participates in or cooperates with an international boycott (See IRC § 999(b)(3)-(4), and IRS Audit Guidelines Boycotts) or engages in conduct declared to be unlawful by [M.G.L. c. 151E, § 2](#). If there is a breach in the warranty, representation, and agreement contained in this paragraph, without limiting such other rights as it may have, the Commonwealth may rescind this Contract. As used herein, an affiliated company shall be a business entity of which at least 51% of the ownership interests are directly or indirectly owned by the Contractor or by a person or persons or business entity or entities directly or indirectly owning at least 51% of the ownership interests of the Contractor, or which directly or indirectly owns at least 51% of the ownership interests of the Contractor.

Executive Order 346. Hiring of State Employees By State Contractors

Contractor certifies compliance with both the conflict of interest law, including [M.G.L. c. 268A, § 5\(f\)](#) and this Order, which includes limitations regarding the hiring of state employees by private companies contracting with the Commonwealth. A privatization contract shall be deemed to include a specific prohibition against the hiring at any time during the term of Contract, and for any position in the Contractor's company, of a state management employee who is, was, or will be involved in the preparation of the RFP, the negotiations leading to the awarding of the Contract, the decision to award the Contract, and/or the supervision or oversight of performance under the Contract.

Executive Order 444. Disclosure of Family Relationships With Other State Employees

Each person applying for employment (including Contract work) within the Executive Branch under the Governor must disclose in writing the names of all immediate family as well as persons related to immediate family by marriage who serve as employees or elected officials of the Commonwealth. All disclosures made by applicants hired by the Executive Branch under the Governor shall be made available for public inspection to the extent permissible by law by the official with whom such disclosure has been filed. Executive Orders 592 and 599. [Executive Order 592 \(Advancing Workforce Diversity, Inclusion, Equal Opportunity, Non-Discrimination, and Affirmative Action\)](#). [Executive Order 599 \(Reaffirming Programs to Ensure Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion for Diverse and Small Massachusetts Businesses in State Procurement and Contracting\)](#). All programs, activities, and services provided, performed, licensed, chartered, funded, regulated, or contracted for by the state shall be conducted without unlawful discrimination based on race, color, age, gender, ethnicity, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, religion, creed, ancestry, national origin, disability, veteran's status (including Vietnam-era veterans), or background. The Contractor and any subcontractors may not engage in discriminatory employment practices. The Contractor certifies compliance with applicable federal and state laws, rules, and regulations governing fair labor and employment practices. The Contractor also commits to purchase supplies and services from certified minority, women, veteran, service-disabled veteran, LGBT or disability-owned businesses, small businesses, or businesses owned by socially or economically disadvantaged persons; and Contractor commits to comply with any Applicable Department contractual requirements pertaining to the employment of persons with disabilities pursuant to [M.G.L. c. 7 § 61\(u\)](#). These provisions shall be enforced through the contracting Department, the Operational Services Division, and/or the Massachusetts Commission Against Discrimination. Any breach shall be regarded as a material breach of the contract that may subject the contractor to appropriate sanction.



COMMONWEALTH TERMS AND CONDITIONS

This Commonwealth Terms and Conditions form is jointly issued by the Executive Office for Administration and Finance (ANF), the Office of the Comptroller (CTR) and the Operational Services Division (OSD) for use by all Commonwealth of Massachusetts ("State") Departments and Contractors. ***Any changes or electronic alterations by either the Department or the Contractor to the official version of this form, as jointly published by ANF, CTR and OSD, shall be void.*** Upon execution of the Standard Contract Form these Commonwealth Terms and Conditions will be incorporated by reference. Performance shall include services rendered, obligations due, costs incurred, commodities and deliverables provided and accepted by the Department, programs provided or other commitments authorized under a Contract. A deliverable shall include any tangible product to be delivered as an element of performance under a Contract. The Commonwealth is entitled to ownership and possession of all deliverables purchased or developed with State funds. Contract shall mean the Standard Contract Form issued jointly by ANF, CTR and OSD.

1. Contract Effective Start Date. Notwithstanding verbal or other representations by the parties, the effective start date of performance under a Contract shall be the later of the date the Contract was executed by an authorized signatory of the Contractor, the date the Contract was executed by an authorized signatory of the Department, the date specified in the Contract, or the date of any approvals required by law or regulation.

2. Payments And Compensation. The Contractor shall only be compensated for performance delivered and accepted by the Department in accordance with the specific terms and conditions of a Contract. All Contract payments are subject to appropriation pursuant to [M.G.L. c. 29, § 26](#), or the availability of sufficient non-appropriated funds for the purposes of a Contract, and shall be subject to intercept pursuant to [M.G.L. c. 7A, § 3](#) and [815 CMR 9.00](#). Overpayments shall be reimbursed by the Contractor or may be offset by the Department from future payments in accordance with state finance law. Acceptance by the Contractor of any payment or partial payment, without any written objection by the Contractor, shall in each instance operate as a release and discharge of the State from all claims, liabilities or other obligations relating to the performance of a Contract.

3. Contractor Payment Mechanism. All Contractors will be paid using the Comptroller's payment system unless a different payment mechanism is required. The Contractor shall timely submit invoices and supporting documentation as prescribed in a Contract. The Department shall review and return rejected invoices within fifteen (15) days of receipt with a written explanation for rejection. Payments shall be made in accordance with the bill paying policy issued by the Office of the Comptroller and [815 CMR 4.00](#), provided that payment periods listed in a Contract of less than forty-five (45) days from the date of receipt of an invoice shall be effective only to enable a Department to take advantage of early payment incentives and shall not subject any payment made within the forty-five (45) day period to a penalty. The Contractor Payroll System shall be used only for Individual Contractors who have been determined to be Contract Employees as a result of the Department's completion of an Internal Revenue Service SS-8 form in accordance with the Omnibus Budget Reconciliation Act (OBRA) 1990, and shall automatically process all state and federal mandated payroll, tax and retirement deductions.

4. Contract Termination Or Suspension. A Contract shall terminate on the date specified in a Contract, unless this date is properly amended in accordance with all applicable laws and regulations prior to this date, or unless terminated or suspended under this Section upon prior written notice to the Contractor. The Department may terminate a Contract without cause and without penalty, or may terminate or suspend a Contract if the Contractor breaches any material term or condition or fails to perform or fulfill any material obligation required by a Contract, or in the event of an elimination of an appropriation or availability of sufficient funds for the purposes of a Contract, or in the event of an unforeseen

public emergency mandating immediate Department action. Upon immediate notification to the other party, neither the Department nor the Contractor shall be deemed to be in breach for failure or delay in performance due to Acts of God or other causes factually beyond their control and without their fault or negligence. Subcontractor failure to perform or price increases due to market fluctuations or product availability will not be deemed factually beyond the Contractor's control.

5. Written Notice. Any notice shall be deemed delivered and received when submitted in writing in person or when delivered by any other appropriate method evidencing actual receipt by the Department or the Contractor. Any written notice of termination or suspension delivered to the Contractor shall state the effective date and period of the notice, the reasons for the termination or suspension, if applicable, any alleged breach or failure to perform, a reasonable period to cure any alleged breach or failure to perform, if applicable, and any instructions or restrictions concerning allowable activities, costs or expenditures by the Contractor during the notice period.

6. Confidentiality. The Contractor shall comply with [M.G.L. c. 66A](#) if the Contractor becomes a "holder" of "personal data". The Contractor shall also protect the physical security and restrict any access to personal or other Department data in the Contractor's possession, or used by the Contractor in the performance of a Contract, which shall include, but is not limited to, the Department's public records, documents, files, software, equipment or systems.

7. Record-keeping And Retention, Inspection Of Records. The Contractor shall maintain records, books, files and other data as specified in a Contract and in such detail as shall properly substantiate claims for payment under a Contract, for a minimum retention period of six (6) years beginning on the first day after the final payment under a Contract, or such longer period as is necessary for the resolution of any litigation, claim, negotiation, audit or other inquiry involving a Contract. The Department shall have access, as well as any parties identified under [Executive Order 195](#), during the Contractor's regular business hours and upon reasonable prior notice, to such records, including on-site reviews and reproduction of such records at a reasonable expense.

8. Assignment. The Contractor may not assign or delegate, in whole or in part, or otherwise transfer any liability, responsibility, obligation, duty or interest under a Contract, with the exception that the Contractor shall be authorized to assign present and prospective claims for money due to the Contractor pursuant to a Contract in accordance with [M.G.L. c. 106, § 9-318](#). The Contractor must provide sufficient notice of assignment and supporting documentation to enable the Department to verify and implement the assignment. Payments to third party assignees will be processed as if such payments were being made directly to the Contractor and these payments will be subject to intercept, offset, counter claims or any other Department rights which are available to the Department or the State against the Contractor.

9. Subcontracting By Contractor. Any subcontract entered into by the Contractor for the purposes of fulfilling the obligations under a Contract must be in writing, authorized in advance by the Department and shall be consistent with and subject to the provisions of these Commonwealth Terms and Conditions and a Contract. Subcontracts will not relieve or discharge the Contractor from any duty, obligation, responsibility or liability arising under a Contract. The Department is entitled to copies of all subcontracts and shall not be bound by any provisions contained in a subcontract to which it is not a party.

10. Affirmative Action, Non-Discrimination In Hiring And Employment. The Contractor shall comply with all federal and state laws, rules and regulations promoting fair employment practices or prohibiting employment discrimination and unfair labor practices and shall not discriminate in the hiring of any applicant for employment nor shall any qualified employee be demoted, discharged or otherwise subject to discrimination in the tenure, position, promotional opportunities, wages, benefits or terms and conditions of their employment because of race, color, national origin, ancestry, age, sex, religion, disability,



COMMONWEALTH TERMS AND CONDITIONS

handicap, sexual orientation or for exercising any rights afforded by law. The Contractor commits to purchasing supplies and services from certified minority or women-owned businesses, small businesses or businesses owned by socially or economically disadvantaged persons or persons with disabilities.

11. Indemnification. Unless otherwise exempted by law, the Contractor shall indemnify and hold harmless the State, including the Department, its agents, officers and employees against any and all claims, liabilities and costs for any personal injury or property damages, patent or copyright infringement or other damages that the State may sustain which arise out of or in connection with the Contractor's performance of a Contract, including but not limited to the negligence, reckless or intentional conduct of the Contractor, its agents, officers, employees or subcontractors. The Contractor shall at no time be considered an agent or representative of the Department or the State. After prompt notification of a claim by the State, the Contractor shall have an opportunity to participate in the defense of such claim and any negotiated settlement agreement or judgment. The State shall not be liable for any costs incurred by the Contractor arising under this paragraph. Any indemnification of the Contractor shall be subject to appropriation and applicable law.

12. Waivers. Forbearance or indulgence in any form or manner by a party shall not be construed as a waiver, nor in any way limit the legal or equitable remedies available to that party. No waiver by either party of any default or breach shall constitute a waiver of any subsequent default or breach.

13. Risk Of Loss. The Contractor shall bear the risk of loss for any Contractor materials used for a Contract and for all deliverables, Department personal or other data which is in the possession of the Contractor or used by the Contractor in the performance of a Contract, until possession, ownership and full legal title to the deliverables are transferred to and accepted by the Department.

14. Forum, Choice of Law And Mediation. Any actions arising out of a Contract shall be governed by the laws of Massachusetts, and shall be brought and maintained in a state or federal court in Massachusetts which shall have exclusive jurisdiction thereof. The Department, with the approval of the Attorney General's Office, and the Contractor may agree to voluntary mediation through the Massachusetts Office of Dispute Resolution (MODR) of any Contract dispute and will share the costs of such mediation. No legal or equitable rights of the parties shall be limited by this Section.

15. Contract Boilerplate Interpretation, Severability, Conflicts With Law, Integration. Any amendment or attachment to any Contract which contains conflicting language or has the effect of a deleting, replacing or modifying any printed language of these Commonwealth Terms and Conditions, as officially published by ANF, CTR and OSD, shall be interpreted as superseded by the official printed language. If any provision of a Contract is found to be superseded by state or federal law or regulation, in whole or in part, then both parties shall be relieved of all obligations under that provision only to the extent necessary to comply with the superseding law; provided however, that the remaining provisions of the Contract, or portions thereof, shall be enforced to the fullest extent permitted by law. All amendments must be executed by the parties in accordance with Section 1 of these Commonwealth Terms and Conditions and filed with the original record copy of a Contract as prescribed by CTR. The printed language of the Standard Contract Form, as officially published by ANF, CTR and OSD, which incorporates by reference these Commonwealth Terms and Conditions, shall supersede any conflicting verbal or written agreements relating to the performance of a Contract, or attached thereto, including contract forms, purchase orders or invoices of the Contractor. The order of priority of documents to interpret a Contract shall be as follows: the printed language of the Commonwealth Terms and Conditions, the Standard Contract Form, the Department's Request for Response (RFR) solicitation document and the Contractor's Response to the RFR solicitation, excluding any language stricken by a Department as unacceptable and including any negotiated terms and conditions allowable pursuant to law or regulation.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, the Contractor certifies under the pains and penalties of perjury that it shall comply with these Commonwealth Terms and Conditions for any applicable Contract executed with the Commonwealth as certified by their authorized signatory signing the Standard Contract Form.

Superintendent's Report

September 16, 2026
School Committee

New PSB Leaders:

Aaron Osborne: Deputy Superintendent of Finance & Administration

Eris Dunn: Principal of Runkle School

Jill Seaman-Chandler: Coordinator of Health Services

Julie Cullinane: Director of Human Resources

Kendall Jones: Director of Steps to Success

McKenna Bush: Director of Data & Information Systems

A few new things starting this year

Seal of Biliteracy

New High School Schedule

DECALS: Developing Character + Leadership in Sport

Parent Square – cash-free and two way communication

Grade 9 – Phones Off and Away

New Information Manager: Mark Cheffro

Town Hall welcomes Scott Moore : -)

Pre-start meetings

Civil Rights Protocols and Policy Training for all potential investigators

All Admin (60+) orientation to the priorities for the 2026-27 School Year

Framed by the 2026-27 Superintendent's Goals (August 28)

Orientation for paraprofessionals

Orientation for new teachers

Curriculum Coordinators

Special Education Directors

SLT and Principals

Opening Day!

Superintendent Goals & The Bridge Plan

SLG: Decrease disproportionality for PSB students (MTSS), DESE, DRR, EP

PLG: 100% evaluation of Unit A, Unit B, and unaligned administrators to sustain high quality instruction, implement an evaluation system for paraprofessionals. DRR

DIP: Evaluate grade configurations to improve scheduling and staffing equity across K-8 schools. MOU, EP

DIP: Establish an equity leadership team and develop a strategic equity plan. DESE Regs

DIP: Address concerns identified by the District Review Report. DRR

DIP: Complete evaluation for procedures related to use of facilities, maintenance and repairs, work order systems, emergency response, security and safety, and transportation practices. MOU, Safety, Operations

Superintendent Goals & The Bridge Plan

We have an opportunity to focus more fully on teaching and learning. We have the talent and capacity to support our students to do much better. I am very excited by what we can do given the opportunity to learn from each other.

This year we will construct the scaffolding necessary to facilitate our ability to work together to support equitable academic and social and emotional outcomes for all students within a culture of belonging.

High quality instruction embedded in a culture of belonging will result in high and equitable outcomes for all our students.

The Big Pieces

Incorporating the DESE District Review Report (2026)

- MTSS – facilitating the use of student data to inform interventions
- Supervision and Evaluation – improve quality and consistency
- Professional Development Plan
- Equity Plan
- Belonging

Darnisa Amante-Jackson



Deepen Instructional Practice: Supervision and Evaluation

Taking a Focused Approach

Standard I: Curriculum, Planning & Assessment

I-A Curriculum and Planning (I-A-1)
I-B Assessment (I-B-1)
I-C Analysis (I-C-2)

Standard II: Teaching All Students

II A Instruction (II-A-1 • II-A-2 • II-A-3)
II-B Learning Environment (II-B-1 • II-B-2)

Standard III: Family and Community Engagement

III-A Communication (III-A-1)

Standard IV: Professional Culture

IV-A Reflection & Professional Growth (IV-A-1 • IV-A-2)

The focus indicators and elements are intended to:

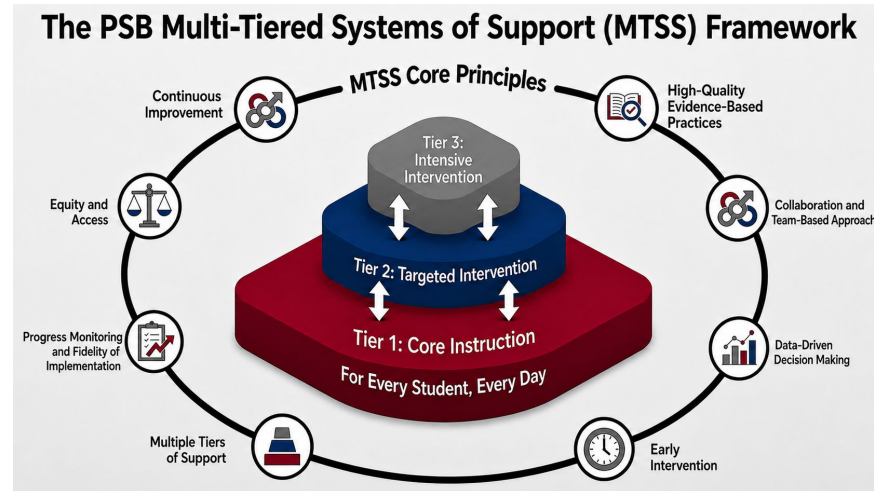
- Identify areas of emphasis in the new rubric connected to our focused work as a district; e.g., MTSS
- Reinforce a common lens for instruction and feedback
- Starting small is intentional as we transition to a new rubric so we can practice and learn together.
- Make the rubric digestible for educators and evaluators

MTSS Focus 2026-2027: From Framework to Practice

This year, we move from developing our MTSS framework to **putting the structures, systems, and practices into action**.

To accomplish this goal, this year we will focus on three interconnected parts of our system:

- **High-Quality Instructional Practices**
- **Collaboration and Teaming**
- **Data-Driven Decision Making**



Our Priorities for 2026-2027

High Quality Instructional Practices	Collaboration and Teaming	Data Driven Decision Making
Strengthen Tier 1 Instruction Develop a shared understanding of instructional tiers in and outside of the classroom	Establish school-based MTSS teams Strengthen structures for multi-disciplinary collaborative problem-solving.	Use curriculum assessments to shape day-day instruction Use the universal data protocol with DIBELS, STAR (K-8) and Panorama Data (K-12) Consistently engage in data-review processes to identify student strengths, needs, and next steps.
These three priorities will guide our MTSS work throughout the year.		

Data Team



Director of Data & Information Systems

McKenna Bush

- Data Governance
- Student Data Analysis
- Data Dashboards
- Website Administration
- Survey Management

✉ McKenna_Bush@psbma.org



Information Systems Manager

Mark Cheffro

- Google Administrator
- User Account Management
- TeachPoint, Canvas
- Implementations
- DESE Directory Admin

✉ Mark_Cheffro@@psbma.org



Sr. Data Systems Manager

Charles Chang

- Aspen Database Administrator
- Aspen Account Management
- Supports: Destiny, Blackboard, Food Service
- DESE Data Collection
- End of Year Rollover

✉ Charles_Chang@psbma.org



Sr. Application Support Specialist*

Joanne Shaughnessy

- Aspen calendar and schedules
- Aspen user support
- DESE Data Collection
- PEBT, CRDC reporting
- Data pulls for users

✉ Joanne_Shaughnessy@psbma.org

Data & MTSS

Combining robust data systems with professional expertise to support every student.



2. How our team will support our MTSS Work

1

Defining the Right Measures

Collaborating directly with you to identify high-leverage indicators that truly reflect student needs and systemic growth—not just tracking data for tracking's sake.

2

Building Collection Systems & Dashboards

Engineering user-friendly, centralized data infrastructure that simplifies progress monitoring, streamlines intervention tracking, and saves educators time.

3

Evaluating Efficacy & Progress

Creating feedback loops to evaluate instructional practices, monitor growth over time, and ensure district-wide instruction yields real results.



Our goal is to equip our educators with clear, reliable systems so that professional judgment can be applied where it matters most!

Darnisa Amante-Jackson



	k	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	
Baker	17.3	19.3	15.8	21	19.3	20.5	21.5	18.8	17.8	
Sections	3	3	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	34
Total										651
Driscoll	15.3	16	18.7	14.7	18.8	18.3	19	20.7	20.3	
Sections	3	3	3	3	4	3	4	3	3	29
Total										523
Hayes	14.5	18.5	19.5	20	20.5	21.5	23.5	13.3	16.7	
Sections	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	3	3	20
Total										366
Lawrence	15.5	20.3	18	23	21.8	18.3	17.8	20	19.7	
Sections	4	4	3	3	4	3	4	3	3	31
Total										598
Lincoln	14.7	16.7	20.3	19.3	18.7	22.5	20.3	19	21.5	
Sections	3	3	3	3	3	2	3	3	2	25
Total										475
Pierce	16.7	19.7	19.3	20	18	16.8	18	17	17	
Sections	3	3	3	3	3	4	4	4	4	31
Total										556
Pierce Guidance	22	22	22	22	20	19	20	18	20	
FRR	20.8	17	19.4	23.5	20.4	18.8	23.3	23	21.8	
Sections	4	5	5	4	5	5	4	4	4	40
Total										827
Runkle	15	16	18.7	23	18	18.7	19	19.7	20	
Sections	3	3	3	2	3	3	2	3	3	25
Total										462
Guidance	22	22	22	25	25	25	25	25	25	
Ave CI Size	17	18	19	21	20	20	21	19	20	
No classes over	guidance									
All District										6889
	BEEP 2	BEEP 3	BEEP 4							
	30	98	129		Total 252					
BHS	9	10	11	12 SP						
	531	508	543	584	11	Total 2177				

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FY28 CIP Recommendation

	Projects	FY28	FY29	FY30	FY31	FY32	FY33	Total	Notes
PSB	BEEP Leases (Classroom Capacity)	\$859,689	\$913,173	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	\$1,772,862	Beacon Lease Expires FY30, Putterham in FY29
	Lawrence Cafeteria Expansion - Feasibility Study	\$75,000	-	-	-	-	-	\$75,000	
	Deferred Maintenance	\$897,500	\$1,167,500	\$360,000	\$300,000	\$300,000	\$150,000	\$3,175,000	
	Climate Control	\$650,000	\$240,000	\$100,000	\$350,000	-	-	\$1,340,000	
	Gender Inclusion	-	\$150,000	\$150,000	\$150,000	-	-	\$450,000	
	Kitchen Renovation	\$40,000	-	-	-	-	-	\$40,000	
	Baker School - Feasibility Study	-	-	\$2,600,000	-	-	-	\$2,600,000	
	Baker School - Construction	-	-	-	TBD	TBD	TBD	-	
PSB Subtotal		\$2,522,189	\$2,470,673	\$3,210,000	\$800,000	\$300,000	\$150,000	\$9,452,862	

Note: New requests are pending feasibility from the Town and are not yet included in above. These total \$4,185,000 and are on the FY28 New Requests Sheet

FY28 New CIP Requests

Location	Project Description	Type	Estimate	Notes
	AC in Auditorium/Reconnect Fans	CIP Project	\$480,000	40 Ton HP Full Cooling
	Paint Classrooms, Front Lobby, Bridge Hallway, Library, Hallway, Elevator Lobby First Floor, Stairwell Railings, Exterior Aux Gym/Back Wall	Deferred Maint.	\$225,000	17 Classrooms (104, 113, 116, 117, 202 thru 206, 208, 227 thru 231, 302, 307), Front Lobby, Bridge Hallway, Library (especially yellow walls), Hallway area near 208
Baker	Replace 70 Window Shades	Deferred Maint.	\$30,000	Areas to replace are Classrooms 100, 102, 104, 107, 206, 208, 227, 229, 231, 301, 302, 305, 307, 309.
	Repair/Replace Flooring in area on Bridge across PE Office, MPR (Small Gym) Entrance, Teacher Lounge, Redo Pod Rooms 218 & 219, Remove Carpet/Replace with VCT, Refinish Gym Floors	Deferred Maint.	\$200,000	Redo Pod Rooms 218 & 219, Remove Carpet/Replace with VCT in 207, 208 & 209, Replace flooring in Room 309.
	Build Out Wellness/Nursing Room	Deferred Maint.	\$100,000	Location TBD by Principal, Initial Space to Complex & Expensive
BHS	Upgrade/Add/Install to Existing A/C System in 115 Greenough	CIP Project	\$1,300,000	Includes classrooms, Auditorium, Cafeteria. Note that Grants will Partially Pay (\$70k) for Rooms 235,237,239,244,247,347
	Remove Wallpaper & Install Cork Board Material School-Wide	Deferred Maint.	\$400,000	Library area priority. Note first floor started.
Lawrence	Relocate/Install New Lockers on 2nd Floor	Deferred Maint.	\$150,000	Install new on 2nd Floor in Hallway near Auditorium
	Redo Flooring in Main Vestibule, Replace Flooring with LVT in Main & RN Offices, Refurbish Stairwells	Deferred Maint.	\$350,000	Some areas will be completed by 9/1/26.
	Auditorium Renovations (Paint, Flooring, Stage, HVAC, Lighting)	Deferred Maint.	\$950,000	Paint, Refinish Stage Flooring, Remove Carpet/Replace with LVT, Install HVAC, & Fix/Upgrade Track Lighting
TOTALS			\$4,185,000	

Color Key	
FY25 Deferred Maintenance Request	
FY26 Deferred Maintenance Request	
FY27 Deferred Maintenance Request	
FY28 New Requests	

BEEP Leases (FY28-FY30)				
Organization	FY28	FY29	FY30	<i>Last Option Yr</i>
Temple Emeth (Putterham)	\$479,149	\$507,898	TBD	8/31/2029
Temple Ohabei Shalom (Beacon)	\$380,540	\$405,275	TBD	7/31/2030
Total	\$859,689	\$913,173	TBD	

Bella Wong
Superintendent of Schools
bella_wong@psbma.org
(617) 730-2401

**PUBLIC SCHOOLS of
BROOKLINE**
Office of Administration & Finance
333 Washington Street, Brookline, MA 02445

Aaron Osborne
Deputy Superintendent, OAF
aaron_osborne@psbma.org
(617) 730-2425

MEMORANDUM

Date: August 19, 2026
To: The Public Schools Of Brookline School Committee
Budget & Finance Subcommittee
From: Aaron Osborne, Deputy Superintendent, Office of Administration & Finance
Re: Request for Revolving Fund

The school district requests the establishment of a new revolving fund for the purpose of collecting student tuition payments for career technical education programs with colleges and other accredited organizations providing these programs. This account will be effectively a “zero balance account” whereby student tuitions are accepted and then paid in the aggregate to the providing institution in a short period of time.

At present, there is a specific need to establish this fund to support our Healthcare Career Technical Education program at Brookline High School to allow students to participate in the Massachusetts Bay Community College (MassBay) [Emergency Medical Technician \(EMT\) certification program](#). With this revolving fund established, we would look to provide students with additional valuable career technical education and certification opportunities through MassBay and others.

The adoption of this revolving fund is authorized by [Massachusetts General Law Chapter 74, Section 14b](#) as a Vocational Education Revolving Fund in accordance with the attached table of Revolving Funds For School Department Programs provided by the MA Division of Local Services (DLS).

Recommendation:

That the School Committee authorizes the school district to work with the Town of Brookline toward the establishment of a Vocational Education Revolving Fund.

PUBLIC SCHOOLS of **BROOKLINE**

FY28 Budget Development Dates

Approved by the School Committee on 9.16.26

February 3, 2027

FY28 Initial Budget Request presented with Budget Overview

February 10, 2027

School Committee Public Hearing on the FY28 Initial Budget Request,
and School Committee Vote to Send the Initial Budget Request to the Town
Administrator

March 3, 2027

School Committee Budget Deliberation and Public Comment

March 10, 2027

Finance Subcommittee Budget Deliberation and Public Comment

March 17, 2027

School Committee Budget Deliberation and Possible Vote

Erin Chute
Public Works Commissioner

Milee Pradhan
Parks & Open Space Director



Town Hall, 4th Floor
333 Washington St.
Brookline, MA 02245
617-730-2156

August 18, 2026

Dear Friends, Neighbors, and Families of the Lincoln School,

We are excited to announce the start of the Design Review Committee (DRC) process for the Lincoln School Grounds Renovation Project. The Lincoln School grounds, built in 1994, have been an integral part of our community for more than thirty years. After three decades of daily use, the grounds have reached the end of their useful life, and the play equipment, pathways, drainage, and landscape are due for renovation and replacement. This project will renovate the entire school grounds as funding allows. Planned improvements include new playground equipment for all ages with resilient safety surfacing, accessible pathways throughout the grounds, an improved natural grass field, upgraded parking areas, improved drainage and planting, and new site furnishings. A consultant team will lead the design work and support the Town's public design review process.

As a first step in the public design review process, the Design Review Committee will be formed. The committee will include two members of the School Committee, two members of the Park and Recreation Commission, one member of school staff, and two members of the general public. The Design Review Committee will help guide the design process and ensure that the renovations reflect the needs of the school community, preserve the character of the site, and serve Brookline residents for generations to come.

If you are interested in serving on the Design Review Committee for the Lincoln School Grounds Renovation Project, please complete the Design Review Committee Application of Interest available online at <https://www.brooklinema.gov/4099/Lincoln-School-Grounds-Renovation> or by scanning the QR code below. All applications of interest must be submitted to parks@brooklinema.gov by **September 9th, 2026**. Additionally, we request all applicants to complete an abutter's disclosure form as part of the application; this form can be found on the same page as the application. The School Committee will review all applications and will appoint two members of the public to serve on the Design Review Committee.

Scan the QR Code at right
to access the project webpage
for the application and
disclosure form.



Members of the DRC are expected to attend the public meetings, offer input on the design, and recommend a final concept plan, which will be presented to the School Committee for their review and final vote. The dates for the DRC meetings have not been set but they are anticipated to begin in October. The DRC meetings serve as a vital platform for gathering input from the community to inform the design. All meetings will be held via Zoom. Meeting notices will be posted on the Town's website, emailed to all committee members, and mailed to all abutters, providing reminders of the dates and details on how to attend.

We encourage all members of the public to participate in the Lincoln School grounds design review process, even if you are not selected as a member of the Design Review Committee. If you would like further information on this project or the review process, please scan the QR code for the project webpage, which will be regularly updated throughout the process.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in dark ink, appearing to read "Milee Pradhan", with a horizontal line underneath.

Milee Pradhan
Director, Parks and Open Space Division

The Town of Brookline does not discriminate in its admission to, access to, or operations of programs or activities on the basis of disability or any other characteristic protected under applicable federal, state, or local law. Individuals who are in need of auxiliary aids for effective communication in Town programs or activities may make their needs known by contacting the Town's ADA Compliance Officer at

617-730-2345. Assistive Listening Devices are available at the Public Safety Building for public use at Town of Brookline meetings and events. Those who need effective communication services should dial 711 and ask the operator to dial the Town's ADA Compliance

Sarah Pagliaccio:

Site Council member, and Green Team Chair, I have been actively involved in advocating for this renovation. Through my work with the school gardens and pollinator gardens, I have seen firsthand how thoughtfully designed outdoor spaces enrich learning experiences and foster strong relationships. I have watched how the kids use the grounds during the school day and after school, at different ages and developmental stages, and across seasons. I am especially interested in creating adaptive and accessible spaces that support play and learning, wider community use, and the sustainable, resilient long-term stewardship of the site for decades to come.

I am Faculty and Co-Director of the User Experience Center at Bentley University, where I teach and practice user-centered design. My expertise includes accessibility, inclusive design, research, wayfinding, and evaluating how people interact with physical and digital environments. Through surveys, focus groups, and field observations, I help identify needs, balance competing priorities, and translate diverse perspectives into practical design recommendations that are technically feasible while meeting regulatory requirements. I would bring those skills to the design review process while contributing the perspective of a long-time Brookline resident, parent, and active school volunteer.

Sandra Wesemann:

I was a parent at Lincoln School for 17 years, with all four of my children attending and graduating from the school. My youngest graduated in 2025. During the last 13 of those years, I led the Lincoln Landscape committee (now called the Lincoln Green Team), running the school garden program and overseeing or teaching edible gardening projects in grades k-5. We also supported the middle school science teachers with their garden projects and

organized community "Lincoln Blooms" days. I also acted as liaison with the town's parks and open spaces division especially during Erin Gallentine and Alexandra Vecchio's respective terms, alerting the town of issues on the school grounds and advocating for this renovation for many years.

I am a certified Master Gardener, going through the training in a prior state before moving to Massachusetts. I am an educator, having taught high school science courses for several years before I had children. I have taught gardening classes at Lincoln school in every grade resulting in every student having multiple opportunities through their time at Lincoln to plant, water, harvest and then eat what they have grown. My most valuable contribution could be how well I know every corner of the Lincoln school grounds, in all seasons, as well as the history of the landscape. I've spent countless hours working the soil, problem solving for the short-term and dreaming of the day when Lincoln would have its turn for a redesigned landscape.

School Committee Communication Norms

As we begin the new school year, we thought it would be helpful for us to spend some time aligning on a few working norms for the Committee. These aren't intended to restrict how members engage or participate, but rather to help us work efficiently, communicate well with one another and the administration, and make the best use of everyone's time. We'd like to walk through them, hear everyone's feedback, and see whether we can establish some shared expectations for how we work together this year.

1. Making our SC Meetings More Effective

- Work toward having meeting materials available in advance whenever possible.
- Submit SC questions in advance, whenever possible
- Keep presentations concise, ideally 8-10 slides or approximately 20 minutes, with a goal of preserving at least 15 minutes for Committee discussion.
 - Use pre-reads, appendices, and supporting materials for additional detail
 - Longer presentations when the subject warrants it, such as budget

2. Communication Between Meetings

- The Chair leads the work of the School Committee, just as the Superintendent leads the work of the District. As a general practice, Committee members should begin questions, requests, or concerns with the Chair, who can coordinate with the Superintendent as appropriate.
- Members are always encouraged to raise questions and seek information. The norm is to start with the Chair, allowing the Chair and Superintendent to determine the most appropriate path for follow-up.
- The goal is not to limit communication, but to ensure that both the Committee and Superintendent have appropriate visibility into requests, avoid duplication or conflicting direction, and respect established governance and administrative roles.
- For questions or issues that clearly fall within a subcommittee's portfolio –i.e. Policy, Finance & Capital, or Curriculum, DEIJ or Negotiations – Subcommittee Chair should generally serve as the first point of contact and coordinate with the appropriate Senior Leadership Team counterpart.
- Subcommittee Chairs should work directly with their designated Senior Leadership Team counterparts on matters within the scope of their committees.

3. Managing Committee business

- Use New Business to identify potential topics for future agendas rather than beginning substantive discussion. Betsy maintains a running list of requested items so members know their requests have been captured and are welcome to check in on anticipated timing.